

2025 RULEBOOK



.org

VISIT FANSHOP.USASWIMMING.ORG TO SHOP OFFICIAL LICENSED MERCHANDISE



USA SWIMMING

Fan Favorites



MAJOR LEGISLATION AND RULE CHANGES FOR 2025

(currently effective except as otherwise noted)

1. The composition of the House of Delegates was approved. (Corporate Bylaws 6.1)
2. The rules for starting procedures were amended to allow Starters the ability to use any "stand" command when relieving athletes from their starting positions. (Articles 101.1.2, 101.2.3, and 102.12)
3. The rules surrounding Mixed Gender Relays were changed to allow lead-off times to count for relays with compositions other than two male and two female athletes. (Article 101.7.3)
4. The list of recognized events for 13-14 athletes was amended to include the 50s of Butterfly, Backstroke, and Breaststroke. (Article 102.1.2)
5. The rules regarding the Zone Senior Program were amended to allow each Zone to govern the conduct of the competition as they see fit. (Article 205.7) [Effective January 1, 2025]
6. The Code of Conduct was amended to include national origin as a class protected from Discrimination in violation of the Amateur Sports Act. (Article 304.3.2)
7. The rules surrounding the Coach Advisory Council were amended to grant the CAC the authority to appoint the coach members of multiple national committees which have required spots for coach members. (Article 501.1)
8. The rule regarding the distribution of rulebooks was amended to clarify that non-athlete members were entitled to a printed copy of the rulebook, but must make a request for the physical rulebook, should they desire one. (Article 503.2) [Effective January 1, 2025]
9. The rules surrounding the wearing of wetsuits were amended to give more flexibility to Meet Directors to allow the use of wetsuits in Open Water competition. (Articles 701.1 and 701.4)
10. The rules surrounding which meets are considered qualifying competitions for Open Water Junior National and National Championships were amended to allow additional qualifying competitions. (Article 705, multiple locations)
11. The Required LSC Bylaws Template was amended to update the name of World Aquatics and to utilize gender neutral pronouns. (Required LSC Bylaws Template, multiple locations)
12. The annual registration fee for existing clubs was increased to \$225 per year and the registration fee for new clubs was increased to \$750 for their first year. (Resolution of the HOD) [Effective September 1, 2025, for the 2026 registration year]

DOPING CONTROL

MEMBERSHIP ANTI-DOPING OBLIGATIONS.

It is the duty of individual members of USA Swimming, including athletes, athlete support personnel, and other persons to comply with all anti-doping rules of the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA), World Aquatics, the USOPC, including the USOPC National Anti-Doping Policy, and the U.S. Anti-Doping Agency (USADA), including the USADA Protocol for Olympic and Paralympic Movement Testing (USADA Protocol), and all other policies and rules adopted by WADA, World Aquatics, the USOPC and USADA. Athlete members agree to submit to drug testing by World Aquatics and/or USADA or their designees at any time and understand that the use of methods or substances prohibited by the applicable anti-doping rules make them subject to penalties including, but not limited to, disqualification and suspension. If it is determined that an individual member may have committed a doping violation, the member agrees to submit to the results management authority and processes of USADA, including arbitration under the USADA Protocol, or to the results management authority of World Aquatics, if applicable or referred by USADA.

To comply with the World Anti-Doping Code, World Aquatics, USOPC and USADA have all amended their anti-doping rules. The rules are available at the offices of USA Swimming or may be found online at the following websites:

WADA	www.wada-ama.org
World Aquatics	www.worldaquatics.com
USOPC	www.teamusa.org
USADA	www.usada.org/resources/publications-and-policies/ Visit the Athlete Handbook and the policies/protocol listed below.

All members of USA Swimming should familiarize themselves with the following:

USADA Protocol for Olympic Movement Testing
https://www.usada.org/wp-content/uploads/USADA_protocol.pdf
USOPC Anti-Doping Policies
USOPC-NADP.pdf (usada.org)

The 2025 List of Prohibited Substances and Methods is available on the websites listed above and at www.usaswimming.org. **This List will take effect on January 1, 2025.**

All athletes should check the status of all medications they plan to take PRIOR to taking them. This includes over-the-counter and prescription medications. It is the responsibility of the athlete to ensure that no prohibited substance enters his/her system.

The United States Anti-Doping Agency (USADA) offers a Drug Reference Line (719-785-2000, option 2) and a Drug Reference Online (www.globaldro.com) where athletes, coaches, athlete support personnel, parents and medical professionals may check to ensure that proper documentation is on file for their medications and that they are consuming medications that are permitted.

Dietary supplements are considered "Take at Your Own Risk" as claims made by the manufacturers/distributors of dietary supplements regarding the effectiveness or contents of their products are not strictly regulated by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration. Any commercial dietary supplement is susceptible to containing substances that may appear on the Prohibited Substance list(s) of World Aquatics and/or the World Anti-Doping Agency. These substances may not be listed on the ingredients label of the product.

Athletes and Athlete Support Personnel should visit USADA's Supplement Connect website for detailed information regarding the supplement industry (including a high-risk list): <https://www.usada.org/athletes/substances/supplement-connect/>. Athletes are also strongly encouraged to check every ingredient of every product they plan to consume as prohibited substances may be listed as ingredients.

U.S. CENTER FOR SAFESPORT

The U.S. Center for SafeSport helpline and resources may be found online at www.uscenterforsafesport.org.

USA SWIMMING POLICY MANUAL

The USA Swimming Policy Manual is available on USA Swimming's Website: usaswimming.org. (Member Resources/Governance & LSCs/Policies & Bylaws).

2025 USA Swimming *Rules and Regulations*

Published by:

USA SWIMMING, INC.

1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO 80909
719.866.4578 o
719.866.4669 f
usaswimming.org

The *2025 Rules and Regulations* is an official publication of USA Swimming, the National Governing Body for swimming in the U.S. Review of legislated changes for correct application provided by Taylor Rogers and Herb Schwab.

Cover Photo: Mike Lewis; Ola Vista Photography
Copyright 2025 by USA Swimming, Inc.

PART ONE ▼

Technical Rules

PART TWO ▼

*Administrative
Regulations
of Competition*

PART THREE ▼

*Rights, Privileges,
Code of Conduct*

PART FOUR ▼

Hearings and Appeals

PART FIVE ▼

*Matters of the
House of Delegates*

PART SIX ▼

*Local Swimming
Committees,
Zones and Regions*

PART SEVEN ▼

Open Water Swimming

MASTERS ▼

*U.S. Masters Technical
Rules Differences*

BYLAWS ▼

*Corporate Bylaws
of USA Swimming*

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

M

B

USA SWIMMING'S HEADQUARTERS STAFF

EXECUTIVE

Shana Ferguson

Chief Operating Officer/Interim CEO
sferguson@usaswimming.org

Paula D'Amico

Executive Administrative Assistant
pdamico@usaswimming.org

BUSINESS AFFAIRS

Michelle Steinfeld

Secretary/General Counsel
msteinfeld@usaswimming.org

Derek Paul

Associate General Counsel
dpaul@usaswimming.org

Ellery Parish

Manager, Business Affairs
eparish@usaswimming.org

Rebecca Chafin

Paralegal
rchafin@usaswimming.org

Human Resources

Ashley Anderton

Senior Manager, Human Resources,
Payroll & Benefits
aanderton@usaswimming.org

Deborah Brown

Coordinator, Payroll & Benefits
dbrown@usaswimming.org

COMMERCIAL

Shana Ferguson

Chief Operating Officer
sferguson@usaswimming.org

Jake Grosser

Managing Director, Marketing
& Communications
jgrosser@usaswimming.org

Communications

Nikki Warner

Director, Communications
nwarner@usaswimming.org

Kyle Sagendorph

Manager, Digital Communications
ksagendorph@usaswimming.org

Devonie Pitre

Manager, Communications
dpitre@usaswimming.org

Marketing

Mollie Albert

Manager, Marketing
malbert@usaswimming.org

Wendy Bartlett

Manager, Athlete Marketing
wbartlett@usaswimming.org

Mariah Carnahan

Front End Developer
mcarnahan@usaswimming.org

Creative

Matt Lupton

Senior Director, Creative
& Productions
mlupton@usaswimming.org

Natalie Elzinga

Manager, Studio
nelzinga@usaswimming.org

Will Brethauer

Producer
wbrethauer@usaswimming.org

David Gardner

Coordinator, Graphic Design
dgardner@usaswimming.org

Partnerships

Jim Fox

Director, Partnership Marketing
jfox@usaswimming.org

Ellison Elledge

Senior Manager,
Partnership Marketing
eelledge@usaswimming.org

Caitlin Whiteside

Manager, Partnership Marketing
cwhiteside@usaswimming.org

FINANCE & OPERATIONS

Eric Skufca

Chief Financial Officer
eskufca@usaswimming.org

Tami Bock

Director, Accounting
tbock@usaswimming.org

Sophie Graf

Accounting Manager
sgraf@usaswimming.org

William Poff

Senior Accountant, Revenue & Fp&A
wpoff@usaswimming.org

Rosalind Medina

Coordinator, Accounts Payable
rmedinal@usaswimming.org

Facilities

Mike Wilkinson

Senior Manager, Purchasing
& Facilities
mwilkinson@usaswimming.org

Tom Vanatta

Coordinator, Shipping
& Receiving
tvannatta@usaswimming.org

Information Technology

Chris Detert

Director, Information Technology
cdetert@usaswimming.org

Dan Becker

Quality Assurance and
Application Support
dbecker@usaswimming.org

David Mueller

IT Technician II
dmueller@usaswimming.org

Risk Management

Rachel Olson

Program Director, Risk Management
rolson@usaswimming.org

TECHNICAL SPORT/EVENTS

National Events**Macie McNichols**

Senior Manager, National Events
mmcnichols@usaswimming.org

Kristin Alfano

Manager, National Events
kalfano@usaswimming.org

Trey Freeman

Coordinator, National Events
tfreeman@usaswimming.org

Katie Trace

Coordinator, Events & Data
ktrace@usaswimming.org

NATIONAL TEAM

Brendan Hansen

Director, National Junior Team
bhansen@usaswimming.org

Bryce Elser

Director, National Team, Open Water
belser@usaswimming.org

Keenan Robinson

Director, Sports Medicine & Science
krobinson@usaswimming.org

Athlete Performance

Matt Barbini

Director, Performance
mbarbini@usaswimming.org

Kirk Grand

Specialist, National Team
High Performance
kgrand@usaswimming.org

Curtis Goss

Specialist, National Team
High Performance
cgoss@usaswimming.org

International Games

Carlann Brashier

Director, International
Games Operations
cbrashier@usaswimming.org

Support & Services

Stacy Michael-Miller

Director, National Team Support
& Services
smichael@usaswimming.org

Emily Klueh

Manager, Psychological Services
eklueh@usaswimming.org

Jennifer Thomas
Coordinator, National Team Services
jthomas@usaswimming.org

Kimberly Robb
*Administrative Coordinator,
National Team Services*
krobb@usaswimming.org

SPORT DEVELOPMENT

Joel Shinofield
*Managing Director,
Sport Development*
jshinofield@usaswimming.org

Safe Sport

Liz Hahn
Director, Safe Sport
ehahn@usaswimming.org

Cha'Vera Jackson
Manager, Safe Sport
cjackson@usaswimming.org

Michael Mares
*Specialist, Case Management
& Education*
mmares@usaswimming.org

Trish Hughes
*Coordinator, Background Check &
Administrative Assistant*
thughes@usaswimming.org

Data Analytics

Patrick Murphy
*Senior Director, Member Data
and Products*
pmurphy@usaswimming.org

Mitch Gold
Senior Advisor, Product
mgold@usaswimming.org

Robb Hinds
Applications Programmer
rhinds@usaswimming.org

Michael Carr
Applications Programmer
mcarr@usaswimming.org

Ellen Woytowitz
Applications Developer
ewoytowitz@usaswimming.org

Eduardo Yzcaray
Applications Developer
eyzcaray@usaswimming.org

Ty Gibbs
Data Fellowship
tgibbs@usaswimming.org

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

Leland Brown, III
*Program Director, Diversity, Equity,
and Inclusion*
lbrown@usaswimming.org

Hilary Perez
*Manager, Diversity, Equity,
and Inclusion*
hperez@usaswimming.org

Education & Programs

Dan McCarthy
Director, Coach Education
dmccarthy@usaswimming.org

Maggie Vail
*Program Director, Education
& Curriculum*
mvail@usaswimming.org

Kirsten Victor
Coordinator, Education & Curriculum
kvictor@usaswimming.org

Mirely Cordova
Lead Instructional Designer
mcordova@usaswimming.org

Kimberly Herb
Instructional Designer I
kherb@usaswimming.org

Shaun Anderson
*Senior Advisor, Community Outreach
& Engagement*
shaun.anderson@usaswimming.org

Membership Affairs

Karin Dinsdale
Director, Member Success
kolmsted@usaswimming.org

Eric Stimson
*Senior Advisor, Membership & Data
Services*
estimson@usaswimming.org

Denise Thomas
Manager, Membership Affairs
denise.thomas@usaswimming.org

Team Services

Mariejo (MJ) Truex
*Senior Director, Team Services,
Coach & Athlete Development*
mtruex@usaswimming.org

Beth Winkowski
Senior Advisor, Team Services
bwinkowski@usaswimming.org

Jane Grosser
Senior Advisor, Team Services
jane.grosser@usaswimming.org

Terry Jones
Senior Advisor, Team Services
tjones@usaswimming.org

Dana Skelton
Advisor, Team Services
dskelton@usaswimming.org

Nate Chessey
Advisor, Team Services
nchessey@usaswimming.org

Jay Chambers
Senior Advisor, Team Services
jchambers@usaswimming.org

USA SWIMMING FOUNDATION

Eric Skufca
Chief Financial Officer
eskuca@usaswimming.org

Elaine Calip
Executive Director of The Foundation
ecalip@usaswimming.org

Tom Luchsinger
Director, Development
tluchsinger@usaswimming.org

Jill Johnson
Senior Manager, Development
jjohnson@usaswimming.org

Nick Gold
Manager, Donor Relations
ngold@usaswimming.org

Kelcie O'Donnell
Coordinator, Development
ko'donnell@usaswimming.org

USA SWIMMING'S 2024 - 2025 BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Board Chair

Chris Brearton
201 24th Street
Hermosa Beach, CA 90254
(E) cbrearton@
usaswimming.org
(O) (310) 449-3315
(C) (310) 489-8013

Board Chair- Elect

Natalie Hall
c/o USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO
80909-5770
(E) ncoughlinhall@
usaswimming.org
(O) (719) 866-4578

Immediate Past Chair

Bob Vincent
9043 Bevington Lane
Orlando, FL 32827-7058
(E) bvincent@
usaswimming.org
(C) (703) 608-9769

Vice Chair Fiscal Oversight

Kenneth Chung
1107 Crockett Ct
Southlake, TX 76092-5914
(E) kchung@
usaswimming.org
(C) (617) 417-5544

Katy Arris-Wilson

3900 Old Shell Road
Virginia Beach, VA 23452
(E) katyarriswilson@
gmail.com
(C) (757) 679-5954

Kathy Fish

9825 Cunningham Rd.
Cincinnati, OH 45243
(E) kfish@usaswimming.org
(H) 513-315-9488

Bruce Gemmell

12725 Lincolnshire Drive
Potomac, MD 20854-2364
(E) bgemmell@
usaswimming.org
(C) (302) 494-2259

Clark Hammond

2729 Old Tree
Mountain Brk, AL 35243
(E) chammond@
usaswimming.org
(H) (205) 967-9727
(C) (205) 910-5390
(O) (205) 874-0331

Ira Klein

5123 Kestral Park Place
Sarasota, FL 34231
(E) iklein@usaswimming.org
(C) (941) 928-7946

Sabir Muhammad

c/o USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO
80909-5770
(E) smuhammad@
usaswimming.org
(C) (404) 597-7033

Kathleen K. Prindle

745 SE 31st Street
Boca Raton, FL 33432
(E) PerformanceAQ
@gmail.com
(C) (561) 212-7175

Athlete Representative

Maya Andrews

c/o USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO
80909-5770
(E) mdiradoandrews@
usaswimming.org
(O) (719) 866-4578

Tony Ervin

c/o USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO
80909-5770
(E) aervin@usaswimming.org
(O) (719) 866-4578

Nic Fink

c/o USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO
80909-5770
(E) nfink@usaswimming.org
(O) (719) 866-4578

Ashley Twichell

c/o USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO
80909-5770
(E) atwichell@
usaswimming.org
(O) (719) 866-4578

Ex-Officio - Secretary &

General Counsel
Michelle Steinfeld
USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO
80909-5770
(E) msteinfeld@
usaswimming.org
(O) (719) 866-4578

Ex-Officio - Interim

President & Chief
Executive Officer
Shana Ferguson
USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO
80909-5770
(E) sferguson@
usaswimming.org
(O) (719) 866-4578

RULES AND REGULATIONS COMMITTEE CHAIR

Taylor Rogers

c/o USA Swimming
1 Olympic Plaza
Colorado Springs, CO 80909-5770
(W) 719-866-4578
(M) 207-404-3119
(E) usasrulesandregs@gmail.com

USA Swimming's Calendar of Events

(calendar tentative and subject to change)

Date	Event	City
2025		
March 5-8	TYR Pro Swim Series	Westmont, IL
April 2-5	TYR Pro Swim Series	Sacramento, CA
April 4-6	Open Water National and Junior National Championships	Sarasota, FL
April 30 - May 3	TYR Pro Swim Series	Fort Lauderdale, FL
June 3-7	National Championships	Indianapolis, IN
July 23-26	Futures Championships	Greensboro, NC; Justin, TX; Madison, WI; Ocala, FL; Sacramento, CA
July 30 - August 3	Speedo Junior National Championships	Irvine, CA
August 5-8	TYR Pro Championships	Irvine, CA
December 3-6	Toyota U.S. Open	Austin, TX
December 10-13	Speedo Winter Junior Championships	TBD

TABLE OF CONTENTS

USA Swimming Rules and Regulations — 2025

U.S. Masters Swimming (USMS) Rules are not printed in this book. The differences between USA Swimming and USMS Rules are outlined beginning on page 123.

GLOSSARY	15
-----------------------	----

PART ONE — Technical Rules

ARTICLE 101 — Individual Strokes and Relays	21
101.1 Starts	21
101.2 Breaststroke	22
101.3 Butterfly	23
101.4 Backstroke	24
101.5 Freestyle	24
101.6 Individual Medley	24
101.7 Relays	25
101.8 Long Distance Swimming - Pool Events	26
ARTICLE 102 — Conduct and Officiating of All Swimming Competition	26
102.1 Events	26
102.2 General Rules	28
102.3 Relays	28
102.4 Scratch Procedures	29
102.5 Seeding, Lane Assignments, Swim-Offs, and Order of Heats	29
102.6 Counters	31
102.7 Postponements and Changes in Program	32
102.8 Swimwear	33
102.9 Meet Director	35
102.10 Officials	35
102.11 Referee	36
102.12 Starter	37
102.13 Judges	37
102.14 Administrative Official	38
102.15 Scorers	39
102.16 Timing Personnel and Their Duties	39
102.17 Press Steward	40
102.18 Marshals	40
102.19 Clerk of Course	40
102.20 Announcer	40
102.21 Disqualifications	40
102.22 Protests	41
102.23 Timing Rules	41
102.24 Scoring	44
102.25 Awards	45
102.26 Meet Results	45

Appendix to Article 102

Appendix 1 Example of Heat Malfunction	46
---	----

ARTICLE 103 — Facilities Standards	47
103.1 Definitions	47
103.2 Water Depth	47
103.3 Racing Course Dimensions	48
103.4 Racing Course Walls	48
103.5 Pool and Bulkhead Markings	48
103.6 Overflow Recirculation System	49
103.7 Water and Air Temperature	49
103.8 Ladders	49
103.9 Other Deck Equipment	49
103.10 Lighting	49
103.11 Tobacco Products	49
103.12 Alcoholic Beverages	49
103.13 Drones	50
103.14 Starting Platforms	50
103.15 Backstroke Ledge	50
103.16 Floating Lane Dividers and Markings	50
103.17 Backstroke Flags and Lines	51
103.18 Loudspeaker Start System	51
103.19 Recall Device	51
103.20 Pace Clocks	51
103.21 Automatic Officiating Equipment	51
103.22 Electrical Safety	52
ARTICLE 104 — Rules for Swimming Records	53
104.1 World Records	53
104.2 USA Swimming Records	53
ARTICLE 105 — Guidelines for Officiating Swimmers with a Disability in USA Swimming Meets	56
105.1 General	56
105.2 Blind and Vision Loss	57
105.3 Deaf or Hard of Hearing	58
105.4 Cognitively Disabled	58
105.5 Physical Disabilities	59
 PART TWO — Administrative Regulations of Competition	
ARTICLE 201 — Classes of Competition	61
201.1 Competitive Classifications	61
ARTICLE 202 — Sanctions and Approvals	61
202.1 Jurisdiction	61
202.2 Sanction and Approval Procedure	61
202.3 Procedure for Appeal	62
202.4 Requirements for Sanction	62
202.5 Conditions of Sanction	64
202.6 Requirements for Approval	65
202.7 Requirements for NCAA Meets	67
202.8 Requirements for Observed Swims	67
202.9 International Events	68
202.10 Swim-a-thons	69
ARTICLE 203 — Representation	69
ARTICLE 204 — Senior Program	71

204.1	Objectives	71
204.2	Eligibility	71
204.3	Events and Programs	71
204.4	Dual Meets	71
204.5	Entry Fees	71
204.6	Awards	71
204.7	LSC Senior Championship Meet	71
204.8	Regional Meets	71
204.9	Sectional Championships	71
204.10	USA Swimming Futures Championships	72
ARTICLE 205 — Age Group Program		72
205.1	Age Group Swimming Objectives	72
205.2	Eligibility	73
205.3	Program and Events	73
205.4	Entry Fees	74
205.5	Awards	74
205.6	Zone Age Group Program	74
205.7	Zone Senior Program	74
205.8	LSC Age Group Championship Meets	74
205.9	National Age Group Recognition Program	75
205.10	Swimwear in Age Group Competition	75
205.11	Development Competition Program	75
ARTICLE 206 — Awarding USA Swimming Championships and International Competitions		75
206.1	General	75
206.2	Facilities	75
206.3	Award of Events	76
206.4	Dates	76
206.5	Method of Granting Award	76
ARTICLE 207 — USA Swimming Championships		76
207.1	General	76
207.2	USA Swimming U.S. Open Championships	76
207.3	USA Swimming National Championships and Open Water Championships	77
207.4	USA Swimming Junior National Championships and Junior National Open Water Championships	77
207.5	Trials Class Meets	77
207.6	Qualifying Time Standards	77
207.7	Proof of Entered Time	78
207.8	Meet Announcement	78
207.9	Entries	78
207.10	Programs	79
207.11	Administrative Conduct of USA Swimming Championships	80
207.12	Awards	83
Appendix to Part Two		
Appendix 2 2025 Championship Meet Sites and Dates		85
 PART THREE — Rights, Privileges, Code of Conduct		
ARTICLE 301 — Member Rights		87
ARTICLE 302 — Athlete Registration		88
ARTICLE 303 — Eligibility		88
ARTICLE 304 — Code of Conduct		89

ARTICLE 305 — Minor Athlete Abuse Prevention Policies	91
ARTICLE 306 — Child Abuse Reporting Requirements	91
ARTICLE 307 — Prohibitions Against Retaliation for Good Faith Reporting of Abuse ...	92

PART FOUR — Hearings and Appeals

ARTICLE 401 — Full Faith and Credit	93
---	----

PART FIVE — Matters of the House of Delegates

ARTICLE 501 — Operating Committees and Councils	95
ARTICLE 502 — Amendments	98
ARTICLE 503 — Rulebook	100

PART SIX — Local Swimming Committees, Zones and Regions

ARTICLE 601 — General	101
ARTICLE 602 — LSC Bylaws	101
ARTICLE 603 — Names and Jurisdictional Boundaries	102
ARTICLE 604 — LSC Redistricting Procedures	107
ARTICLE 605 — Zones	108
ARTICLE 606 — Regional Competition	109
ARTICLE 607 — Appeals and Review	109

PART SEVEN — Open Water Swimming

ARTICLE 701 — Conduct and Officiating of the Competition	111
ARTICLE 702 — Venue Standards	118
ARTICLE 703 — Records	120
ARTICLE 704 — Zone Open Water Championships	121
ARTICLE 705 — USA Swimming Open Water National Championships	121
Differences Between USA Swimming and USMS Rules	123
Dual-Sanctioned Events	129
Corporate Bylaws of USA Swimming	131

OFFICIAL GLOSSARY

Swimming Words and Terms

10-YEAR ATHLETE — an athlete who has represented the United States in a Delegation Event, World Championships, or another event designated by the USOPC (together with the USOPC Athletes' Advisory Council) and USA Swimming (together with USA Swimming's Athletes' Advisory Council) as an elite-level event for purposes of this definition, within the previous 10 years.

10-YEAR+ ATHLETE — an athlete who has represented the United States in a Delegation Event, World Championships, or another event designated by the USOPC (together with the USOPC Athletes' Advisory Council) and USA Swimming (together with USA Swimming's Athletes' Advisory Council) as an elite-level event for purposes of this definition, but not within the previous 10 years.

2-YEAR ATHLETE — an athlete who has been actively engaged within the 24 months prior to election/selection in a USA Swimming-sanctioned competition (as defined by the USA Swimming Athletes' Advisory Council and approved by the USA Swimming Athlete Representation Working Group [as defined in the USOPC Bylaws]), which may include events that categorize entrants in age restricted classifications.

ABANDONMENT — termination of an open water event prior to its completion due to safety considerations.

ACTIVELY ENGAGED ATHLETE REPRESENTATIVE — an athlete who qualifies as a 10-Year or 10-Year+ Athlete representative, or who has been actively engaged in 24 months prior to election/selection in a USA Swimming-sanctioned competition (as defined by the USA Swimming Athletes' Advisory Council and approved by the USA Swimming Athlete Representation Working Group [as defined in the USOPC Bylaws]), which may include events that categorize entrants in age-restricted classifications.

ADMINISTRATIVE REFEREE — Referee who performs the duties of an Administrative Official under 102.14 at a prelims-finals meet. The Administrative Referee should have the experience and knowledge to be able to assume the role of the Meet Referee any time during the meet, if necessary.

AGGREGATE TIME — times achieved by four individuals in separate starts which are added together to arrive at a relay time for entry purposes.

ALTERNATING KICK — the alternating movement of the legs, commonly known as the flutter kick, is the up-and-down propulsive motion of the legs where one limb moves in the opposite direction of the other at the same time.

AMATEUR SPORTS ACT — the Ted Stevens Olympic and Amateur Sports Act (1998) (or as applicable, the Amateur Sports Act of 1978), as amended from time to time.

APPRECIABLE — sufficient in extent to be recognized.

APPROVAL — a permit issued by an LSC for meets conducted in conformance with USA Swimming technical rules in which both members and non-members may compete.

ARM — that part of the body that extends from the shoulder to the wrist.

ATTACHED — status of an athlete member who represents a member club in competition after having met the requirements of Article 203.

BOARD OF DIRECTORS — unless otherwise noted, shall mean the USA Swimming Board of Directors.

BODY — the torso, including shoulders and hips.

CLOSED COMPETITION

- Competition exclusively among members of a single club
- Competition or series of competitions within an independent organization open only to members of that organization, such as:

- YMCA competition
- Summer league competition
- Conference competition
- Closed competition does not include representing a group within USA Swimming such as LSC, Zone, Region, or Section, nor does it include dual meets, invitationals, or other meets where only certain clubs are invited to participate.

CLUB — an organization which has been accepted for membership in USA Swimming.

COMPETITION CATEGORY — stated as male or female for the purpose of athlete swimming eligibility, competition, selection and records. An athlete's stated competition category shall be referred to as "gender."

CONFORMING TIME — time achieved in a course that corresponds to the meet competition course.

COURSE — designated distance over which the competition is conducted.

LONG COURSE — 50 meters.

SHORT COURSE — 25 yards or 25 meters.

DECK CHANGE — changing, in whole or in part, into or out of a swimsuit when wearing just one suit in an area other than a permanent or temporary locker room, bathroom, changing room or other space designated for changing purposes.

DECK REFEREE — the deck level Referee who may be assigned by the Meet Referee to perform specific duties as enumerated under 102.11 during a session.

DELEGATION EVENT — individually or collectively as applicable, the Olympic Games, the Olympic Winter Games, the Paralympic Games, the Paralympic Winter Games, the Pan American Games, and the Parapan American Games.

DRAW — random selection by chance.

DUAL COMPETITION — competition between two teams.

END OF COURSE — designated wall for racing turns and finishes.

ESCORT CRAFT — boats or paddle boards used in open water competition for the swimmers' safety and logistical support.

ESCORTED SWIM — an open water event in which each swimmer is required to have an escort craft accompany the swimmer throughout the race.

EVENT — any race or series of races in a given stroke and/or distance. For competitive limits, one event is inclusive of preliminary heat(s) plus its related final(s), or one timed final, or one time trial.

EX-OFFICIO — a member of a board or committee serving by virtue of some other office or position held (whether in USA Swimming, in an Allied or Affiliate Member, or otherwise), or by virtue of an appointment to such committee or board pursuant to the Bylaws of USA Swimming. Ex-officio members have full rights of membership including the right to vote (unless otherwise provided in the Bylaws or Policy Manual). Ex-officio members without the right to vote are not counted to establish a quorum (unless expressly provided otherwise in the Bylaws).

FEED POLE — a mechanical implement used by coaches or support personnel to deliver fluid and/or food to open water swimmers during the race.

FINALS — a session of a meet in which the concluding heats of an event are contested which may include championship, consolation, or bonus finals.

- Championship (A) Final — the fastest heat of swimmers competing in Finals
- Consolation Final(s) — the second fastest and subsequent heats of swimmers competing in Finals for which team selection, scoring points and/or prize money are awarded
- Bonus Final(s) — any finals heat in which no points or placement prizes are awarded

FINISH — the instant that a swimmer touches the wall at the end of the prescribed distance.

FINISH POINT — the physical location where an open water race terminates.

FIRST DAY OF MEET — day on which the first competitive swimming event is conducted.

FOREIGN SWIMMER — an athlete member of a World Aquatics member-country federation, other than USA Swimming, or an athlete member of USA Swimming who is not eligible to represent the United States in international competition due to World Aquatics sports citizenship requirements. (See Sports Citizen)

FORWARD START — an entry made while facing the course.

FOUL — an instance of obstruction, interference, collision, or equipment malfunction which prevents the successful completion of a race.

HEADQUARTERS — USA Swimming's office in Colorado Springs, Colorado.

HEATS — a division of an event in which there are too many swimmers to compete at one time. (See Preliminary Heats and Timed Final Heats)

HORIZONTAL — parallel to the surface of the water.

INITIAL DISTANCE — that first portion of a race for which an official time may be recorded but which is not in itself a completed event.

INTERNATIONAL COMPETITION — any athletic competition between any athlete(s) or member organization(s) of USA Swimming, either individually or as part of a team, and any athlete(s) or member organization(s) (e.g., clubs) representing any foreign country.

INTRA-SQUAD MEET — a competition exclusively among members of a single club.

LANE DIVIDER — continuous floating markers attached to a line stretched from the starting end to the turning end of the course for the purpose of separating each lane.

LEAD BOAT — the boat used as a course guide for open water swimmers.

LENGTH — extent of the course from end to end.

LSC (LOCAL SWIMMING COMMITTEE) — an administrative division of USA Swimming with supervisory responsibilities within certain geographic boundaries designated by USA Swimming.

MANUAL START — the start of any timing device by an individual in response to the same starting signal given to the swimmer(s).

MAY — permissive, not mandatory.

MEET ANNOUNCEMENT — document setting forth information of the meet events, schedule, and procedures.

MEET COMMITTEE — unless otherwise specified in the meet announcement, the Meet Committee shall consist of the Meet Director, Meet Referee, and coach and athlete members as appropriate.

MEET REFEREE (OPEN WATER (OW) COMPETITION) — an experienced OW referee who oversees the operations of the entire OW swim meet and ensures that all safety plans, rules, and regulations are followed, and who makes final decisions on any procedure, modification, dispute, or protest to ensure a safe, fair, and equitable competition.

MEET REFEREE (POOL COMPETITION) — an experienced referee who oversees the entire swim meet and ensures that all rules and regulations are followed by making final decisions on any procedure, modification, dispute, or protest for a fair and equitable competition.

MIXED CLASSIFICATION — meet in which events of Age Group and Junior, Senior, or any other classification are offered.

NATIONAL AGE GROUP (NAG) RECOGNITION TIME — an official time that qualifies as one of the fastest for a given age group as defined in the SWIMS portion of the Operating Policy Manual.

NON-CONFORMING TIME — entry time achieved in a course which does not correspond to the course in which the meet will be conducted.

NOTICE — a written communication notifying about a scheduled meeting of a committee, board or other governing body or group, or other fact or occurrence, required to be made by law, bylaw, rule or regulation. To be considered written, the communication must be addressed, using the last known address on file with the LSC or in SWIMS, to the intended or required recipient(s) and delivered by hand, first class mail, overnight or second day delivery by a national delivery service, facsimile transmission, electronic mail or text message.

OBSERVED SWIM — a swim observed by assigned USA Swimming officials for conformance with USA Swimming technical rules in a meet conducted under other than USA Swimming rules.

OFFICIAL TIME — a time achieved in a USA Swimming sanctioned or approved competition or in an observed swim in accordance with USA Swimming technical rules.

ON THE BACK — position of the body when the shoulders are past vertical towards the back.

ON THE BREAST — position of the body when the shoulders are at or past vertical towards the breast.

OPEN COMPETITION — competition that is not otherwise defined as a closed competition in which any qualified club, organization or individual may enter.

OPEN EVENT — an event in which any qualified individual may compete, regardless of age.

OPEN WATER SWIMMING — any swimming competition that takes place in rivers, lakes, or oceans.

OPERATING POLICY MANUAL — document maintained by the President/CEO that specifies operating policies and procedures not contained in Rules & Regulations. New policies adopted shall be vetted and approved by the Board of Directors and appropriate committee chair.

OUTREACH MEMBERSHIP — a reduced-fee category of athlete membership for under-represented and/or economically disadvantaged swimmers.

PACING — an attempt by a person not participating in an open water race to enter the water with the intent of providing moral support or otherwise assisting a swimmer in setting the tempo of the race.

PADDLER — a person on a paddle board or manually propelled craft who supports an open water swimmer or group of swimmers.

PERSONAL ASSISTANT — an individual who assists an athlete requiring help with activities of daily living and preparation for athletic participation. A Personal Assistant provides support unique to the needs of the athlete(s) in their care. This support may include, but is not limited to, mobility guidance, assistance with transfer, entering/exiting the pool, dressing, showering, toileting, medication administration, and communication. Some athletes require a Personal Assistant to enable successful participation in the sport, while others need help to assure personal safety in practice and meet environments.

PLACE JUDGE — official assigned to record the order of finish of all swimmers by lane in each heat.

PRACTICE — the instruction of swimming techniques, skills, knowledge, conditioning, aptitude and motivation.

PRELIMINARY HEATS OR PRELIMINARIES — competition in which a number of heats are swum to qualify the fastest swimmers for the Finals.

PRESIDENT/CEO — unless otherwise noted, the President and Chief Executive Officer of USA Swimming.

PROGRAM — the order of events, including starting times and intermissions in a meet or portion thereof (See Session), sequentially listed by class of competition, sex, age group, distance, and stroke as set forth in the meet announcement.

PROPULSIVE — having power to propel.

REINSTATEMENT — return of all or limited rights of membership in USA Swimming.

RELAY — a race in which four eligible team members each swim a specified portion of the course.

RELAY LEG — the part of a relay event that is swum by a single team member.

SANCTION — a permit issued by an LSC to a USA Swimming group member to conduct a meet in conformance with all USA Swimming rules in which all participating swimmers are athlete members of USA Swimming, except as provided in Article 202.5.1.

SCISSOR KICK — use of the top of the instep of one foot and the bottom of the other foot in the propulsive part of the kick.

SCRATCH (from an event) — withdraw an entry from competition.

SEASONAL ATHLETE MEMBERSHIP — an individual athlete membership in USA Swimming which may be offered at the option of the LSC for one or two periods of not more than 150 days in a registration year pursuant to the Corporate Bylaws Article 2.4.

SEASONAL CLUB — an organization which has been accepted for membership in USA Swimming and which operates within a period of time specified by the LSC.

SEED — to distribute the swimmers among the required number of heats and/or lanes, according to their submitted or preliminary times.

DECK-SEED — swimmers are required to check in for their events on the day of the meet. After scratches are determined, events are seeded.

PRE-SEED — all entrants are seeded prior to the day of competition.

SEMI-INDEPENDENT — an individual who (prior to the election to the Board of Directors) has not been a member of a House of Delegates at the national level, but who at present or in the past, has/had an obvious connection to swimming as a swimmer, parent of a swimmer, coach, official, etc.

SESSION — any portion of a meet distinctly separated from other portions by locale, time, or type of competition, i.e., preliminaries and finals; morning and evening; Senior and Age Group, etc.

SHALL — mandatory.

SHOULD — recommended but not mandatory.

SIMULTANEOUSLY — occurring at the same time.

SLIPSTREAMING — swimming behind or next to another open water swimmer or support craft for the purpose of taking advantage of the reduced water resistance created by the former's wake.

SPORTS CITIZEN — an athlete who has represented a nation other than the United States in international competition is a sports citizen of that nation and is considered ineligible to represent the United States until World Aquatics requirements for changing sports citizenship (sport nationality) have been met. (See Foreign Swimmer)

SPORTS ORGANIZATION — a corporation, club, federation, union, association, or other group organized in the United States which sponsors or conducts any athletic competition.

SUPPORT PERSONNEL — persons in an open water swimmer's escort craft who provide for feeding, navigating, coaching, and other supporting activities.

SUSPENSION — deprivation of all rights of membership in USA Swimming.

SWIMS (SWIMMING WEB-BASED INTERACTIVE MEMBERSHIP SYSTEM) — a single integrated database system which includes USA Swimming membership data and a databank of achieved times that are considered official and are recognized for proof of entry and recognition programs.

TAPPER — Personal Assistant who uses a pole with a soft-tipped end to tap a blind or visually-impaired swimmer as notification of turns and finish.

TEXTILE MATERIALS — natural and/or synthetic, individual and non-consolidating yarns used to constitute a fabric by weaving, knitting, and/or braiding, or as further defined under current World Aquatics swimwear rules.

TIME STANDARD — the time a swimmer must have previously achieved in order to compete in that event at a designated competition.

TIME TRIAL — an event conducted within or independently of a meet where the swimmer races against the clock to establish an official time.

TIMED FINAL HEATS OR TIMED FINALS — competition in which only heats are swum and final placings are determined by the times achieved in the heats.

TOUCH — contact with the end of the course.

TRYOUT — practices where a swimmer who is not a member of USA Swimming participates with a USA Swimming member club for a period not to exceed thirty (30) consecutive days in a twelve (12) month period to determine the swimmer's interest in becoming a member of USA Swimming.

TURN — a point where the swimmers reverse or change direction.

UNATTACHED — status of a member who does not represent a club or World Aquatics member Federation in competition.

UNESCORTED SWIM — an open water event where swimmers compete without a designated support craft.

USA SWIMMING — USA Swimming, Inc., a Colorado corporation.

VENUE — the area located on the sides and ends of the pool, spectator area, team areas within the pool facility (e.g., portion of the building designated for teams and swimmers, or fenced area around an outdoor pool), locker rooms, and such other areas as may be specifically designated by the host club or organization, meet director, or referee. In open water competition, the geographical area and environs where the meet is conducted.

VERTICAL — perpendicular to the water surface.

VIRTUAL MEET — a competition held at multiple venues.

WALL — vertical portion of the pool, contiguous surfaces of the deck and overflow gutter, the front portion of the starting block or platform, or the touchpad at the end of the course.

WARNING SIGNAL — a bell, whistle, air horn, or other appropriate audible device.

WAVE — at an open water event, a second or subsequent start used if the start area cannot accommodate all contestants at the same time.

WEBSITE — the official site maintained by USA Swimming on the internet (usaswimming.org).

WETSUIT — a swimsuit made of material providing thermal insulation.

Except as otherwise noted, all provisions in this Rulebook are effective immediately. Rules in effect on the first day of a meet shall govern throughout that meet.

PART ONE

TECHNICAL RULES

All competitive swimming events held under USA Swimming sanction shall be conducted in accordance with the following rules that are designed to provide fair and equitable conditions of competition.

It is recommended that the LSC and regional short course and long course championships be held annually and that they be conducted under the rules governing National Championships (Article 207), subject to available facilities and personnel. Events other than such championships may use Article 207 as a guide, subject to local conditions and preferences.

It is not the purpose of the Rules and Regulations of USA Swimming (the National Governing Body) contained herein to set standards of care for the safety of the swimmer. The swimmer, the swim coach, the swim club and the local public entity or pool owner should address safety considerations where events are held.

ARTICLE 101

INDIVIDUAL STROKES AND RELAYS

101.1 STARTS

- .1 **Equipment** — A loudspeaker start system conforming to 103.18, with or without an underwater recall device, and an electronic strobe signal visible to all manual timers for forward and backstroke starts, shall be the preferred starting device.
- .2 **The Start**
 - A Once all swimmers have removed their clothing, except for swimwear, the Referee shall signal the commencement of an event by a short series of whistles inviting them to get ready at the starting end, followed by a long whistle indicating that they should take and maintain their positions on the starting platform, the deck, or in the water. In backstroke and medley relay events, at the Referee's first long whistle, the swimmers shall immediately enter the water and at the second long whistle shall return without undue delay to the starting position.
 - B When the swimmers and officials are ready, the Referee shall signal with an outstretched arm to the Starter that the swimmers are under the Starter's control.
 - C On the Starter's command "take your marks," the swimmers shall immediately assume their starting position, in the forward start, with at least one foot at the front of the starting platform or the deck. Swimmers starting in the water must have at least one hand in contact with the wall or starting platform. When all swimmers are stationary, the Starter shall give the starting signal.

101.1

- D When a swimmer does not respond promptly to the command "take your marks," the Starter shall immediately release all swimmers with a "stand" command upon which the swimmers may stand up or step off the blocks.
- E A swimmer shall not be disqualified for an illegal starting position at the start if the race is permitted to proceed. Enforcement of the correct starting position is the responsibility of the Starter.

.3 False Starts

- A Any swimmer initiating a start before the signal may be disqualified if the Referee independently observes and confirms the Starter's observation that a violation occurred. Swimmers remaining on the starting blocks shall be relieved from their starting positions with a "stand" command and may step off the blocks.
 - B If the starting signal has been given before the disqualification is declared, the race shall continue without recall. If the Referee independently observes and confirms the Starter's observation that a violation occurred, the swimmer or swimmers who have false started shall be disqualified upon completion of the race.
 - C If the recall signal is activated, no swimmer shall be charged with a false start and the Starter shall restart the race upon signal by the Referee.
 - D A swimmer who would otherwise be charged with a false start may be relieved of the charge if the false start was caused by the swimmer's reaction to a "stand" command.
 - E Declared false start: swimmers reporting to the Referee prior to the start of their race and declaring their intent not to compete shall be disqualified except as noted in 207.11.6D(1).
- .4 **Warning Signal** — With the exception of relays, in events 500 yards or longer, the Starter or a designee shall sound a warning signal over the water at the finish end of the lane of the leading swimmer when that swimmer has two lengths plus five yards or five meters to swim. As an alternative, a bell warning signal may be given over each lane by a lane judge or timer for that lane.

.5 Deliberate Delay or Misconduct

- A The Starter shall report a swimmer to the Referee for delaying the start, for willfully disobeying an order or for any other misconduct taking place at the start, but only the Referee may disqualify a swimmer for such delay, willful disobedience or misconduct.
- B The Referee shall disqualify a swimmer who fails to appear at the starting platform ready to swim in time for the initial start of his/her heat.
- C Such disqualification shall not be charged as a false start.

101.2 BREASTSTROKE

- .1 **Start** — The forward start shall be used.
- .2 **Stroke** — After the start and after each turn when the swimmer leaves the wall, the body shall be kept on the breast. It is not permitted to roll onto the back at any time except at the turn after the touch of the wall where it is permissible to turn in any manner as long as the body is on the breast when leaving the wall. Throughout the race the stroke cycle must be one arm stroke and one leg kick in that order.

All movements of the arms shall be simultaneous without alternating movement.

The hands shall be pushed forward together from the breast on, under, or over the water.

The elbows shall be under water except for the final stroke before the turn, during the turn and for the final stroke at the finish. The hands shall be brought back on or under the surface of the water. The hands shall not be brought back beyond the hip line, except during the first stroke after the start and each turn.

During each complete cycle, some part of the swimmer's head shall break the surface of the water. After the start and after each turn, the swimmer may take one arm stroke completely back to the legs. The head must break the surface of the water before the hands turn inward at the widest part of the second stroke.

- .3 **Kick** — After the start and each turn, at any time prior to the first breaststroke kick, a single butterfly kick is permitted. Following which, all movements of the legs shall be simultaneous without alternating movement.

The feet must be turned outwards during the propulsive part of the kick. Scissors, alternating movements or downward butterfly kicks are not permitted except as provided herein. Breaking the surface of the water with the feet is allowed unless followed by a downward butterfly kick.

- .4 **Turns and Finish** — At each turn and at the finish of the race, the touch shall be made with both hands separated and simultaneously at, above, or below the water level. At the last stroke before the turn and at the finish, an arm stroke not followed by a leg kick is permitted. The head may be submerged after the last arm pull prior to the touch, provided it breaks the surface of the water at some point during the last complete or incomplete cycle preceding the touch.

101.3 BUTTERFLY

- .1 **Start** — The forward start shall be used.
- .2 **Stroke** — After the start and after each turn, the swimmer's body must be on the breast. The swimmer is permitted one or more leg kicks, but only one arm pull under water, which must bring the swimmer to the surface. It shall be permissible for a swimmer to be completely submerged for a distance of not more than 15 meters (16.4 yards) after the start and after each turn. By that point, the head must have broken the surface. The swimmer must remain on the surface until the next turn or finish. From the beginning of the first arm pull, the body shall be kept on the breast except at the turn after the touch of the wall where it is permissible to turn in any manner as long as the body is on the breast when leaving the wall. Both arms must be brought forward simultaneously over the water and pulled back simultaneously under the water throughout the race.
- .3 **Kick** — All up and down movements of the legs and feet must be simultaneous. The position of the legs or the feet need not be on the same level, but they shall not alternate in relation to each other. A scissors or breaststroke kicking movement is not permitted.
- .4 **Turns** — At each turn the body shall be on the breast. The touch shall be made with both hands separated and simultaneously at, above, or below the water surface. Once a touch has been made, the swimmer may turn in any manner desired as long as the body is on the breast when leaving the wall.

101.3

- .5 **Finish** — At the finish, the body shall be on the breast and the touch shall be made with both hands separated and simultaneously at, above, or below the water surface.

101.4 BACKSTROKE

- .1 **Start** — The swimmers shall line up in the water facing the starting end, with both hands placed on the gutter or on the starting grips. Standing in or on the gutter, placing the toes above the lip of the gutter, or bending the toes over the lip of the gutter, before or after the start, is prohibited. When using a backstroke ledge at the start, at least one toe of both feet must be in contact with the end wall or face of the touchpad. Bending the toes over the top of the touchpad is prohibited.
- .2 **Stroke** — The swimmer shall push off on his back and continue swimming on the back throughout the race. Some part of the swimmer must break the surface of the water throughout the race, except it is permissible for the swimmer to be completely submerged during the turn and for a distance of not more than 15 meters (16.4 yards) after the start and after each turn. By that point, the head must have broken the surface of the water. Additionally, once some part of the head of the swimmer has passed the final 5-meter mark (long course and short course meters) or 5-yard mark (short course yards), immediately prior to reaching for the finish, the swimmer may be completely submerged prior to the touch.
- .3 **Turns** — Upon completion of each length, some part of the swimmer must touch the wall. During the turn the shoulders may be turned past the vertical toward the breast after which an immediate continuous single arm pull or immediate continuous simultaneous double arm pull may be used to initiate the turn. The swimmer must have returned to a position on the back upon leaving the wall.
- .4 **Finish** — Upon the finish of the race, the swimmer must touch the wall while on the back.

101.5 FREESTYLE

- .1 **Start** — The forward start shall be used.
- .2 **Stroke** — In an event designated freestyle, the swimmer may swim any style, except that in a medley relay or an individual medley event, freestyle means any style other than butterfly, breaststroke or backstroke. Some part of the swimmer must break the surface of the water throughout the race, except it shall be permissible for the swimmer to be completely submerged during the turn and for a distance of not more than 15 meters (16.4 yards) after the start and each turn. By that point the head must have broken the surface.
- .3 **Turns** — Upon completion of each length the swimmer must touch the wall.
- .4 **Finish** — The swimmer shall have finished the race when any part of his person touches the wall after completing the prescribed distance.

101.6 INDIVIDUAL MEDLEY — The swimmer shall swim the prescribed distance in the following order: the first one-fourth, butterfly; the second one-fourth, backstroke; the third one-fourth, breaststroke; and the last one-fourth, freestyle.

- .1 **Start** — The forward start shall be used.
- .2 **Stroke** — The stroke for each one-fourth of the designated distance shall follow the prescribed rules for that stroke, except in the freestyle, the swimmer must be on the breast except when executing a turn.

.3 Turns

- A Intermediate turns within each stroke shall conform to the turn rules for that stroke, except that in the freestyle turn, the swimmer must return to the breast before any kick or stroke.
- B The turns when changing from one stroke to another shall conform to the finish rules for the stroke just completed.

- .4 **Finish** — The swimmer shall have finished the race when any part of his/her person touches the wall after the prescribed distance.

101.7 RELAYS

- .1 **Freestyle Relay** — Four swimmers on each team, each to swim one-fourth of the prescribed distance using any desired stroke(s). Freestyle finish rules apply.
- .2 **Medley Relay** — Four swimmers on each team, each to swim one-fourth of the prescribed distance in the following order: first, backstroke; second, breaststroke; third, butterfly; and fourth, freestyle. Rules pertaining to each stroke used as described in 101.6 (Individual Medley) shall govern where applicable. At the end of each leg, the finish rule for each stroke applies in each case.
- .3 **Mixed Competition Category Relays** — must consist of two (2) males and two (2) females.

Exception: at meets below the LSC championship level, mixed relays consisting of compositions other than two (2) male swimmers and two (2) female swimmers may be permitted if stated in the meet announcement. Times for the mixed relays with compositions other than two (2) males and two (2) females shall not be loaded into the SWIMS database, but eligible lead-off times shall be loaded.

.4 Rules Pertaining to Relay Races

- A No swimmer shall swim more than one leg in any relay event.
- B When automatic relay take-off judging is used, each swimmer must touch the touchplate or pad in his/her lane at the end of the course to have finished his/her leg of the relay race.
- C In relay races a swimmer other than the first swimmer shall not start until his/her teammate has concluded his/her leg.
- D Any relay team member and his/her relay team shall be disqualified from a race if a team member other than the swimmer designated to swim that leg enters the pool in the area where the race is being conducted before all swimmers of all teams have finished the race. Exception: When an in-the-water start is required or such start is approved by the Referee.
- E Each relay team member shall leave the water immediately upon finishing his/her leg, except the last member.
- F In relay races, the team of a swimmer whose feet have lost touch with the starting platform (ground or deck) before his/her preceding teammate touches the wall shall be disqualified.
- G In relay races involving in-the-water starts, the team of a swimmer who has lost touch with the end of the course before his/her preceding teammate touches the wall shall be disqualified, unless the swimmer in default returns to the original starting point at the wall.

- H On relays, the second, third and fourth swimmers are prohibited from starting from the top of the adjustable back plate. A swimmer must have at least part of one foot in contact with the starting platform in front of the adjustable back plate during a relay exchange.

101.8 LONG DISTANCE SWIMMING — POOL EVENTS

- .1 Events 5000y/5000m or greater conducted in a pool will be subject to the following special rules:
 - A It is permissible for a swimmer to leave the water for brief periods because of pool safety and health considerations. When re-entering the water, the swimmer shall resume the event commencing with the last completed length using an in-water start with a push off the wall. A dive re-entry is not permitted.
 - B The swimmer's time includes the period the swimmer is out of the pool.

ARTICLE 102

CONDUCT AND OFFICIATING OF ALL SWIMMING COMPETITION

102.1 EVENTS — Meets should be planned to terminate within a maximum period of eight (8) hours of competitive events for any group of swimmers in any one day and to provide adequate meal and rest breaks and properly supervised sheltered rest areas. Refer to 205.3.1F for additional provisions.

- .1 **SENIOR EVENTS** — The following events for National Championships are recommended for LSC and other championship meets. Eligibility for these championships shall be determined by the LSCs involved.

50, 100, 200, 400m/500y, 800m/1000y, 1500m/1650y freestyle
100, 200 backstroke
100, 200 butterfly
100, 200 breaststroke
200, 400 individual medley
200, 400, 800 freestyle relay
200, 400 medley relay
200, 400, 800 mixed competition category freestyle relay
200, 400 mixed competition category medley relay

- .2 **AGE GROUP EVENTS** — Competitions may be composed of events selected from the following recognized list of events or other such events/meet types as may be sanctioned by the LSC.

10 Years and Younger

50, 100, 200, 400m/500y freestyle
50, 100 backstroke
50, 100 breaststroke
50, 100 butterfly
100, 200 individual medley
200 freestyle relay
200 medley relay
200 mixed competition category freestyle relay
200 mixed competition category medley relay

11, 12 Years

50, 100, 200, 400m/500y, 800m/1000y, 1500m/1650y freestyle
50, 100, 200 backstroke
50, 100, 200 breaststroke
50, 100, 200 butterfly
100, 200, 400 individual medley
200, 400 freestyle relay
200, 400 medley relay
200, 400 mixed competition category freestyle relay
200, 400 mixed competition category medley relay

13, 14 Years

50, 100, 200, 400m/500y, 800m/1000y, 1500m/1650y freestyle
 50, 100, 200 backstroke
 50, 100, 200 breaststroke
 50, 100, 200 butterfly
 200, 400 individual medley
 200, 400, 800 freestyle relay
 200, 400 medley relay
 200, 400, 800 mixed competition category freestyle relay
 200, 400 mixed competition category medley relay

15, 16, 17, 18 Years

50, 100, 200, 400m/500y, 800m/1000y, 1500m/1650y freestyle
 100, 200 backstroke
 100, 200 breaststroke
 100, 200 butterfly
 200, 400 individual medley
 200, 400, 800 freestyle relay
 200, 400 medley relay
 200, 400, 800 mixed competition category freestyle relay
 200, 400 mixed competition category medley relay

- .3 **DEVELOPMENT COMPETITION EVENTS** — Competitions may be composed of events selected from the following recognized list of events:

12 Years and Younger

25, 50, 100 freestyle
 25, 50 backstroke
 25, 50 breaststroke
 25, 50 butterfly
 100 individual medley
 100, 200 freestyle relay
 100, 200 medley relay
 100, 200 mixed competition category freestyle relay
 100, 200 mixed competition category medley relay

- .4 **OPEN WATER AND LONG DISTANCE POOL EVENTS** — The following events are recommended for Sectional, Zone, and LSC competitions. Competitions may be composed of events selected from the following list of events or other such events/meet types as may be sanctioned by the LSC.

10 Years and Younger

1 kilometer open water
 800m/1000y—pool

11, 12 Years

1, 3, 5 kilometer open water
 1600m/2000y—pool

13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18 Years

1, 3, 5, 10 kilometer open water
 2400m/3000y—pool

Senior

5, 10, 25 kilometer open water
 4000m/5000y—pool

- .5 **CONSOLIDATED EVENTS** — As a local option, events may be sanctioned and seeded as a single event, without regard to swimmers' ages or gender, in the order of submitted entry times. Places, awards, and published results for these events may be separate for each age group and gender.
- .6 **TIME TRIALS** — Time trial events may be held in conjunction with a sanctioned, approved, or observed competition if all information about the conduct of the time trials is included in the meet announcement as sanctioned or approved by the LSC. If time trials are held as a separate event, they shall be sanctioned, approved, or observed in compliance with Article 202.

102.1

- .7 **VIRTUAL EVENTS** — A Virtual Meet shall be conducted with the same order of events with all results merged. All venues shall complete their competition within a ten (10) day period. It shall be officiated in accordance with 102.10 at each venue and conducted according to the Virtual Meet guidelines.

102.2 GENERAL RULES

- .1 In order to compete in a meet, a swimmer must be entered in compliance with the event entry requirements stated in the meet announcement.
- .2 In a preliminaries and finals meet, a swimmer may compete in not more than three (3) individual events per day.
- .3 In a timed finals meet, a swimmer may compete in not more than six (6) individual events per day.
- .4 If, due to conditions beyond the meet officials' control (e.g., a thunderstorm), an event or events are postponed to a subsequent day of the meet, such postponed events shall not be included in the above events-per-day limitations.
- .5 In a meet where finals for an event(s) are scheduled to be contested on a day subsequent to preliminaries for that event(s), that finals event(s) shall not be counted in the daily event limitation.
- .6 In a meet where a combination of preliminary and final events and timed finals are scheduled, a swimmer may compete in not more than three (3) individual events per day, unless entered exclusively in timed final events that day.
- .7 The above limitations on individual events apply regardless of the classification mixture or if separate meets or time trials are being conducted. These, and additional limitations on entries which may be established by the LSC's sanction or approval, shall be clearly stated in the meet announcement.
- .8 In a mixed classification meet, a swimmer may enter the same stroke and distance individual event in an age group and any other classification, provided the limit of events per day for the type of meet is not exceeded. The same entry time must be used for all repetitive entries.
- .9 If a meet or an event has no qualifying time standards, a swimmer who has no official time for an event may enter that event with no submitted time. Meet hosts may specify in the meet announcement that swimmers must submit estimated times if they have no official times.

102.3 RELAYS

- .1 Relay teams shall not compete unattached. In all cases, relay teams must be composed of USA Swimming members of the same club, school or organization which is a member of USA Swimming. This requirement does not apply to relay teams representing an LSC at a Zone meet or similar all-star competition sanctioned or approved by USA Swimming. Foreign relays competing in USA Swimming sanctioned meets must consist of members of the same foreign club or may represent their recognized World Aquatics federation if so authorized by that federation.
- .2 Relays may be conducted on a timed final basis or with preliminaries and finals.
- .3 Organizations entering two or more relay teams in an event shall designate them on the entry blank as Team A, Team B, etc.
- .4 The time of each relay team shall be entered on the entry blank for seeding purposes and no change in time will be permitted.

- .5 First and last names of swimmers eligible to compete in relay events shall be entered in accordance with the meet announcement.
- .6 The composition of a relay team may be changed between preliminaries and finals. All members competing on a relay team disqualified during preliminaries shall be barred from further competition in that event.
- .7 Names of eligible relay swimmers and order of swimming shall be submitted to the clerk of course or to the head lane timer. Any changes in names of the competing swimmers or their order of swimming must be declared to the head lane timer prior to the start of the heat in which such relay team is entered. No changes will be permitted thereafter.

102.4 SCRATCH PROCEDURES — Each swimmer shall become informed of the meet starting time and shall report to the proper meet authorities promptly upon call. Meet announcements and advance information shall specify check-in and scratch procedures for individual and relay events and penalties for violation of those procedures.

102.5 SEEDING, LANE ASSIGNMENTS, SWIM-OFFS, AND ORDER OF HEATS

- .1 **Preliminary Heats When Finals Are Scheduled** — Entry times shall be listed by the meet committee with the fastest swimmer first and the slowest swimmer last. Swimmers whose submitted times are identical should be assigned places in the list by draw. Swimmers with no submitted times shall be considered the slowest and shall be placed at the end of the list by draw. Swimmers shall be seeded in lanes under the procedure outlined for finals seeding in 102.5. Swimmers shall be seeded in heats according to submitted times in the following manner:

A Fewer than three heats

- (1) If there is only one heat, it shall be swum as scheduled during the preliminaries and finals.
- (2) If there are two heats, the fastest swimmer shall be seeded in the second heat, next fastest in the first heat, next fastest in the second heat, next in the first heat, next in the second heat, next in the first heat, etc.

- B Three heats** — Except for 400y, 400m/500y, 800m/1000y and 1500m/1650y events, the fastest swimmer shall be placed in the third heat, next fastest in the second, next in the first. The fourth fastest swimmer shall be placed in the third heat, the fifth in the second heat, and the sixth fastest in the first heat, the seventh fastest in the third heat, etc.

- C Four heats or more** — Except for 400y, 400m/500y, 800m/1000y and 1500m/1650y events, the fastest three heats of an event shall be seeded in accordance with B above. The heat preceding the fastest three heats shall consist of the next fastest swimmers; the heat preceding the fastest four heats shall consist of the next fastest swimmers, etc. Lanes shall be assigned in descending order of submitted times within each heat, in accordance with the pattern outlined in 102.5.3.

- D** For 400y, 400m/500y, 800m/1000y and 1500m/1650y events, the fastest two heats of an event shall be seeded in accordance with 102.5.1A(2). The heat preceding the fastest two heats shall consist of the next fastest swimmers; the heat preceding the fastest three heats shall consist of the next fastest swimmers, etc. Lanes shall be assigned in descending order of submitted times within each heat, in accordance with the pattern outlined in 102.5.

- E **Exception** — When there are two or more heats in an event, there shall be a minimum of three swimmers seeded into any one preliminary heat, but subsequent scratches may reduce the number of swimmers in such heat to less than three.
- .2 **Swim-Offs** — A swim-off is considered to be part of the total preliminary process of qualifying for the finals. In no case may a swimmer with a faster time displace another who placed ahead of him within a heat as the result of a decision by the Referee or Place Judges in accordance with 102.23. If this situation results in disputed qualifications, all swimmers having times tied or within the disputed times shall swim-off the event to qualify for the disputed place or places in the final unless the swimmers, coaches, and Referee mutually agree to resolve the tie in an alternative manner, such as coin toss or racing a different distance/event. The swim-off shall be timed and judged in the same manner as the original event unless a subsequent timing system malfunction requires that an adjustment be made. For the seeding of finals, the times used for the swimmers involved shall be the times achieved in their original preliminary heats. This elimination may be held at any time set by the Referee, but not more than 45 minutes after the last heat of any event in which any one of these swimmers is competing in that session. In the case of a disqualification in a swim-off, the swimmer so disqualified is relegated to the lowest qualifying position for which he/she is competing. Disqualification in a swim-off for a qualifying position shall not eliminate a swimmer from eligibility to compete in the accompanying finals, or as an alternate. If disqualifications leave a vacancy for the full complement of finalists, swim-offs shall be continued among the disqualified swimmers until a full complement of finalists is assured.
- Note:** It shall be the swimmer's responsibility to become acquainted with information pertaining to swim-offs, final events and the participants therein.
- .3 **Finals** — In finals, the times to be considered are those times made in preliminary heats. If any qualifying swimmers have the same time, their respective lanes shall be determined by draw. Lane assignments shall be made in descending order of qualifying times by placing the fastest swimmer or team in the center lane in a pool with an odd number of lanes, or in lanes 3, 4, or 5 respectively in pools having 6, 8, or 10 lanes, with the swimmer having the next fastest time in the adjacent lane, then alternating the other swimmer(s) to the right or left in accordance with the submitted times. (See chart below)

Lanes in Pool									
				4	2	1	3	5	5
			6	4	2	1	3	5	6
		6	4	2	1	3	5	7	7
	8	6	4	2	1	3	5	7	8
	8	6	4	2	1	3	5	7	9
10	8	6	4	2	1	3	5	7	9
10	9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1
									< Lane

.4 Timed Finals

A **Heats** — The last heat shall be composed of the swimmers with the fastest submitted times, the next to last heat composed of the next fastest swimmers, etc. Lanes shall be assigned in descending order of submitted times within each heat, in accordance with the pattern outlined in .3 above. When there are two or more heats there shall be a minimum of three swimmers or relay teams seeded into the first heat. The last heat should be a full heat, but the requirement of seeding three swimmers or relay teams into the first heat may result in failure to fill the last heat.

B **Places** — In timed finals, places shall be determined on a time basis, subject to the order of finish within each heat and based upon the ranking system used at the meet. Any ties resulting from the procedure used shall be declared officially tied for awards and points, with no further attempt at resolution.

.5 **Seeding of 50 meter events in a 50 meter course** — 50 meter events swum in a 50 meter course shall be seeded as provided above. If the event is started at the turning end of the course, no change in the lane numbering shall be made, i.e., the lanes shall be numbered the same on both ends of the course.

.6 Order of Heats

A **Preliminary Heats and Timed Finals** — The normal order of heats may be reversed by swimming the fastest heats first. Women's and men's heats may be alternated.

B **Finals** — The order of heats during the finals of a preliminaries and finals meet may be reversed, with the B and C (consolation and bonus) heats, if any, swum following the A (final) heat.

C The order of heats shall be stated in the meet announcement.

.7 **Alternates** — In the event of scratches or athlete(s) failing to report for finals, the empty lanes may be filled by moving the athletes up in order from the slower heats and by using the available alternates to fill lanes in the slowest heat without reseeding the heats.

.8 For heats other than team selection finals where athletes are not provided any recognition other than the opportunity to swim (e.g., scoring points, earning prize money, etc.) alternates may be inserted into empty lanes in any heat regardless of order swum.

102.6 COUNTERS

A A swimmer in the 500/1000/1650 yard or 800/1500 meter freestyle or other long distance pool event (see 102.1.4) may appoint one counter to call lengths or indicate lengths by visual sign.

B Verbal counters shall be limited to one per swimmer and shall be stationed at the end of the course opposite the starting end. They may use watches and signal intermediate times to the swimmer.

C If visual counters are used, they may be stationed at the end or either side of the pool, beyond the halfway point toward the end of the course opposite the starting end. Visual counters may be lowered into the water at the end of the swimmer's lane, provided that, in the opinion of the Referee, they neither physically aid the swimmer nor interfere with another swimmer or present any safety hazard.

D The count may be in ascending or descending order.

E In the event of official or counter error, it is the responsibility of the swimmer to complete the prescribed distance.

102.7 POSTPONEMENTS AND CHANGES IN PROGRAM

- .1 The order of events, as stated in the meet announcement, shall not be changed. The announced arrangement of heats in any event shall not be added to or altered, except by the authority of the Referee, to the extent of consolidating the heats.
- .2 At the Meet Referee's discretion, events may be combined by age, gender, distance, and/or stroke provided there is at least one empty lane between such combined events. The Referee may waive the empty lane requirement with the concurrence of the coaches of the affected swimmers.
- .3 The entry provisions and starting time of any event, meet or portion thereof shall stand as stated in the meet announcement (except as permitted under .4 below) and may not be changed to an earlier time or date unless written notice of such change is delivered to all affected swimmers or their coaches. If mailed, such notice must be postmarked no later than the entry deadline date stated on the meet announcement, and if lack of time prohibits mail notification, all affected swimmers or their coaches must voluntarily agree in writing that they have been notified and are in accord with such change. Any affected swimmer or his or her coach may file a written protest with the Referee prior to running of the event or meet if they do not agree to such change in time or date.
- .4 **Postponement or Cancellation**
 - A If, prior to its commencement, unusual or severe weather or other conditions preclude the possibility of safely and effectively conducting a meet or an event, the meet committee may cancel or postpone it. Meets postponed to a start date within fourteen (14) days from the original start date shall define age as the first day of the original meet. Meets postponed to a date more than fourteen (14) days from the original start date shall define age as the first day of the rescheduled meet.
 - B If, after commencement, conditions preclude the possibility of safely and effectively conducting a meet or an event, the meet committee may cancel or postpone. If postponed to continue within fourteen (14) days of the date of postponement, age of the swimmers shall not change. If postponed to continue at a date beyond fourteen (14) days of the date of postponement, age of the swimmers shall change to the first day of the rescheduled events.
 - C Should a meet or event have actually commenced, and in the judgment of the Referee cannot safely and effectively continue because of weather conditions, or for some other compelling reason, the Referee, in his/her sole discretion, may suspend the meet or event until conditions warrant continuance. If circumstances do not warrant continuance, the Referee may cancel the meet or event, or postpone it to a future date or time, with the approval of the meet committee.
 - D A decision to cancel or postpone shall be final.
 - E Should an event have actually commenced but is terminated prior to an official finish, and is postponed to another time or date, it shall then be conducted between the swimmers who were officially competing in the event at the time of the termination.
 - F Incomplete events will not be awarded or scored; however, times achieved in accordance with 102.23 up to the point of cancellation shall be considered official.
 - G Entry fees for teams or swimmers may be refunded, in whole or part, at the discretion of the meet committee, upon cancellation of a meet or particular event. The decision of

the meet committee on refunding may be appealed to the LSC Administrative Review Board or National Board of Review for hearing under the provisions of Policy 26.0 of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual.

102.8 SWIMWEAR

.1 Design

- A Swimwear shall include only a swimsuit, cap, and goggles. It is not permissible to wear more than two (2) caps. Armbands or leg bands shall not be regarded as parts of the swimsuit and are not allowed.
- B In swimming competitions, the swimmer must wear only one swimsuit in one or two pieces, except as provided in 205.10.1. All swimsuits shall be made from textile materials. For men, the swimsuit shall not extend above the navel nor below the knees, and for women, shall not cover the neck, extend past the shoulder, nor extend below the knee (see 701.4.4 for open water exception).
 - (1) Exemptions to the foregoing restriction may be granted to a swimmer, on a case by case basis, by the Rules & Regulations Chair (or his/her designee). Exemptions will be granted only for conflicts due to the swimmer's verified religious beliefs, verified medical conditions or other reasons deemed appropriate by the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair.
 - (2) Procedures for applying for an exemption will be established by the Rules & Regulations Committee and posted on the USA Swimming website.
 - (3) No exemption to this restriction will be granted for a swimsuit that will give the swimmer a competitive advantage.
 - (4) The decision of the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair may be appealed only to the entire Rules & Regulations Committee, whose decision shall be final and binding on all parties.
- C Only swimsuits complying with World Aquatics swimsuit specifications may be worn in any USA Swimming sanctioned or approved competition.
- D Swimsuits worn for competition must be non-transparent and conform to the current concept of the appropriate.
- E No swimmer is permitted to wear or use any device, substance or swimsuit to help his/her speed, pace, buoyancy or endurance during a race (such as webbed gloves, flippers, fins, power bands, adhesive substances, etc.). The use of technology and automated data collection devices is permissible for the sole purpose of collecting data. Automated devices shall not be utilized to transmit data, sounds, or signals to the swimmer and may not be used to aid their speed. Goggles may be worn, and rubdown oil applied if not considered excessive by the Referee. Therapeutic elastic tape is prohibited. As a consequence of injury, it is permissible to tape not more than two fingers or toes. Any other kind of tape on the body is not permitted unless approved by the Referee.
- F No Technical Suits shall be worn by any 12 & Under athlete in competition at any sanctioned, approved or observed meet.
 - (1) Exceptions to the foregoing restriction are only for Junior Nationals, U.S. Open, National Championships, and Olympic Trials.
 - (2) A Technical Suit is one that has the following components:

- a. Any suit with any bonded or taped seams regardless of its fabric or silhouette;
or
- b. Any suit with woven fabric extending past the hips.

(Note: **WOVEN FABRIC** — A suit with woven fabric and sewn seams that does not extend below the hips is permitted.)

(Note: **KNIT FABRIC** — A suit with knit fabric and sewn seams not extending below the knees is permitted.)

- .2 **Insignia** — Swimmers may wear the insignia and/or name of the club or organization they represent or of which they are a member or the insignia of their World Aquatics National Federation or Organizing Committees for Olympic, World, Continental or Regional Championships, except as otherwise provided in 202.9.3 for international competition and in World Aquatics rules GR5 and GR6. Swimmers shall not be allowed to wear the insignia and/or name of any club or organization which they are not entitled to represent in open competition, if such action is objectionable to that club or organization.

.3 Advertising

- A Advertising means the normal display of the name, designation, trademark, logo, or any other distinctive sign of the manufacturer of the item or any other advertiser permitted in accordance with this rule. World Aquatics labeling and the USA Swimming logo or club logo shall not be considered as advertisements. Logos of the swimwear manufacturer shall be considered as advertising and are included in the limits described in (1) through (3) below. In the competition venue or complex of all events conducted by and under the control of USA Swimming or any LSC or division thereof, advertising appearing on swimwear is allowed as follows:
 - (1) **Swimsuits** — A total of three separate advertising logos of a maximum size of 30 square centimeters (4.65 sq. in.) each, measured as worn, shall be permitted.
 - (2) **Caps** — A total of three separate advertising logos of a maximum size of 20 square centimeters (3.1 sq. in.) each, as measured as applied, shall be permitted. A club logo is not considered as advertising and is not subject to the size limitations.
 - (3) **Goggles** — A total of three separate advertising logos of a maximum size of 6 square centimeters (.9 sq. in.) each, as measured as applied, shall be permitted, but only on the spectacle frame or band.
- B Body advertising in the form of temporary tattoos or other embellishments is not allowed.
- C Advertising for the following shall not be allowed:
 - (1) Products involving tobacco, nicotine, psychoactive cannabinoids, alcohol or pharmaceuticals containing substances banned under IOC or World Aquatics rules;
 - (2) Political statements; and
 - (3) Any products or services that would be counter to the values of the sport or bring disrepute to USA Swimming.
- D Swimmers in violation of the above provisions may be barred from the competition venue until they comply. However, any swimmer who competes in an event wearing swimwear in violation of these advertising provisions shall not be subject to disqualification.

102.9 MEET DIRECTOR — Shall be appointed by the meet host. The Meet Director's responsibilities include, but are not limited to: procuring the awards; obtaining a sanction; preparing the facility; arranging for personnel, equipment (including appropriate timing equipment as specified in 102.23), and supplies necessary for meet operation; processing of entries; printing of programs; arranging for publicity and media coverage; preparing and distributing meet results and filing the LSC report.

102.10 OFFICIALS

- .1 All officials accepting an invitation to officiate at a swimming meet should arrive promptly and report immediately to the Meet Director or Meet Referee.
- .2 All officials acting in the capacity of Referee, Starter, Stroke and Turn Judge, or Administrative Official at a sanctioned or approved USA Swimming meet shall be certified and trained in such position by their LSC to the uniform and consistent standards set by USA Swimming with recommendation from the National Officials Committee in conjunction with the Coach Advisory Council prior to being assigned to officiate in that capacity. LSCs and clubs shall not require any additional certifications. Uncertified trainees may perform the duties of such positions when they are under the direct supervision of a certified official in said position. See Article 202 and the Corporate Bylaws for USA Swimming membership requirements.
- .3 With the exception of development, intra-squad and dual meets, there shall not be fewer than the following officiating positions filled or approved by the LSC in authority for all swim meets and time trials. Officials other than the Referee and Administrative Official may act in more than one officiating capacity only when sufficient qualified officials are not available, but no one may simultaneously time and judge the order of finish. An LSC House of Delegates may establish additional minimum requirements.
 - 1 Referee
 - 1 Starter
 - 3 Timers per lane (one minimum if automatic equipment with touchpads is used)
 - 1 Clerk of Course (if applicable)
 - 1 Place Judge (2 are preferred)
 - 2 Stroke Judges and 2 Turn Judges or 2 Stroke & Turn Judges
 - Relay Take-off Judges (if applicable)
 - 1 Administrative Official
 - 1 Announcer (if applicable)
 - Timing Equipment Operators (as needed)
 - 2 Marshals, with at least one of each gender
- .4 At development, dual, and intra-squad meets, there shall be no fewer than the following officiating positions filled or approved by the LSC in authority for all swim meets and time trials.
 - 1 Referee, who may also act as a stroke and turn judge
 - 1 Starter
 - 1 Other Stroke and Turn Judge (may be the Starter)
 - 1 Announcer (if applicable)
 - 3 Timers per lane (one minimum if automatic timing equipment with touchpads is used)
 - 1 Administrative Official
 - 1 Place Judge
 - Relay Take-off Judges (if applicable)
 - Timing Equipment Operators (as needed)
 - 2 Marshals, with at least one of each gender

.5 Officials for USA Swimming Championships

- A Officials for USA Swimming championship meets shall be assigned by the National Officials Committee Chair with the approval of the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee).
- B The following officials shall be required and assigned for all USA Swimming championships and team selection trials competitions:
 - 1 Referee
 - 1 Starter
 - 1 Administrative Referee
 - 1 Chief Timer
 - 1 Place Judge where overhead video cameras are not used (2 are preferred)
 - 1 Chief Judge
 - 1 Stroke Judge per each side of pool
 - 1 Timer/Relay Take-off Judge per lane (start end)
 - 1 Head Lane Timer per lane (start end)
 - 1 Timer/Turn Judge per lane (start end)
 - 1 Turn Judge per lane (turn end)
 - 4 Relay Take-off Judges — two each side of pool
 - 1 Recall Rope Operator
 - 4 Marshals (minimum)
- C In addition to the officials listed above, assistant referees, assistant chief judges, one additional stroke judge per each side of the pool and relief personnel may be assigned. In the event of insufficient officials, the Referee may modify or combine assignments, subject to the provisions of 102.10.3. Where overhead video cameras are used, the Referee may make further modifications as appropriate.
- D Additional Required Meet Personnel
 - 1 Clerk of Course
 - 1 Announcer
 - 2 Timing Equipment Operators
 - 1 Computer Operator

102.11 REFEREE

- .1 Shall have full authority over all officials and shall assign and instruct them; shall enforce all applicable rules and shall decide all questions relating to the actual conduct of the meet, the final settlement of which is not otherwise assigned by said rules; can overrule any meet official on a point of rule interpretation, or on a judgment decision pertaining to an action which the Referee has personally observed.
- .2 Has the authority to disqualify a swimmer(s) for any violation of the rules that the Referee personally observes and, except for false starts, shall at the same time raise one hand overhead. If the Referee does not make such a signal there shall be no disqualification.
- .3 Shall signal the Starter before each race that all officials are in position, that the course is clear, and that the competition can begin.
- .4 Shall assign marshals with specific instructions.
- .5 Shall give a decision on any point where the opinions of the judges differ; and shall have authority to intercede in a competition at any stage, to ensure that the appropriate racing conditions are observed.
- .6 For LSC and local records only, may assign three (3) additional official timers on request to record a record attempt at initial distances in accordance with 102.23 and Article 104.

- .7 Shall make an immediate investigation when an apparent malfunction of the automatic or semi-automatic timing equipment has occurred, to determine whether the swimmer finished in accordance with the rules and/or if there was an actual equipment malfunction.
- .8 May prohibit the use of any device that disrupts or interferes with the meet, such as a laser pointing device or artificial noisemaker.
- .9 May modify any rule for a competitive swimmer who has a disability. Any such modification shall be in accordance with Article 105 of the USA Swimming Rules and Regulations, shall affect only the current meet, and shall not set a precedent.
- .10 Shall establish the necessary administrative and officiating procedures to conform to Part One of the rules and local conditions when the meet sanction allows conducting the events by starting them from the alternate ends of a 50-meter course.
- .11 Refer to 102.22 concerning protests.

102.12 STARTER

- .1 **Preparation** — The Starter shall stand on the side of the pool within approximately five meters of the starting end of the pool and, upon signal from the Referee, shall assume control of the swimmers until a fair start has been achieved.
- .2 **Optional Instructions** — The Starter may:
 - A Announce the event.
 - B Advise the heat when a swimmer will be attempting to achieve a time at an initial distance.
 - C For backstroke starts, give the command, "Place your feet."
 - D Use a "stand" command in accordance with 101.1.2 D, 101.1.3 A, and 101.1.3 D.

102.13 JUDGES — Shall have jurisdiction over the swimmers immediately after the race has begun.

- .1 **Chief** — An overall "Chief Judge" may assign and supervise the activities of all stroke, turn, place and take-off judges and may report their decisions. If desired, any judging category may have a designated "Chief." Any "Chief" may act as liaison for the judges and may serve simultaneously in one of the judging positions and shall assign those judges within the "Chief's" category.
- .2 **Place Judge** — One or two place judges shall be positioned on the side of the course near the finish and shall judge the order of finish of all swimmers. If two place judges are used, they shall independently record the order of finish of all swimmers. A place judge shall record a tie if a place distinction cannot be made. Judging results shall be used only in accordance with 102.23.5C in determining the order of finish.
- .3 **Stroke Judge** — Shall operate on both sides of the pool, preferably walking slightly behind the swimmers during all strokes except freestyle, during which events they may leave pool-side, at the Referee's discretion; shall ensure that the rules relating to the style of swimming designated for the event are being observed; and shall report any violations to the Referee on signed slips detailing the event, the heat number, the lane number and the infraction.
- .4 **Turn Judge** — Shall operate on both ends of the pool; shall ensure that after the start and when turning or finishing, the swimmer complies with the rules applicable to the stroke used; and shall report any violations to the Referee on signed slips detailing the event, the heat number, lane number and infraction observed.

- .5 **Jurisdiction of Stroke and Turn Judges** — Before the competition begins, the Referee shall determine the respective areas of stroke and turn responsibility and jurisdiction, which may include joint, concurrent, and coordinated responsibility and jurisdiction. The Referee shall insure that all swimmers shall have fair, equitable, and uniform conditions of judging.
- .6 **Relay Take-Off Judges**
- A Relay take-off judges shall be assigned by the Referee and shall stand so that they can clearly see both the feet of the departing swimmer(s) as they leave the starting platform and the touch of the incoming swimmer(s), and shall judge whether the swimmer is in contact with the platform when the incoming swimmer touches the end of the pool.
 - B If dual relay take-off judging is used, the lane and side take-off judges shall independently report infractions in writing without the use of the infraction hand signal. A relay will be disqualified only if the lane take-off judge has reported an infraction and the assigned side take-off judge has confirmed the same infraction.
 - C When automatic relay exchange judging equipment is in use, the system printout will provide the information to judge relay exchanges. Integrated back-up timing cameras may be reviewed by the Referee to confirm the automatic system's results. When backup timing cameras are not available, the Referee will determine the confirmation process.

102.14 ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICIAL

- .1 Shall be responsible to the Referee for the supervision of the following:
- A The entry and registration process
 - B Clerk of Course
 - C Timing Equipment Operator
 - D Scoring personnel
 - E Other administrative personnel
- .2 Shall be responsible to the Referee for:
- A The accurate processing of entries and scratches.
 - B Accurate seeding of preliminary, semi-final and final heats.
 - C Determination and recording of official time.
 - (1) Receiving and reviewing the automatic and/or semi-automatic timing results from the Timing Equipment Operator and comparing primary timing results with the back-up timing results to determine their validity.
 - (2) Receiving the times recorded by the Head Lane Timers from the Chief Timer and the order of finish data from the Place Judges and using that data to the extent needed to determine the official time for each swimmer.
 - (3) Unless otherwise directed, notifying the Referee whenever a time obtained by the primary timing system cannot be used as the Official Time.
 - (4) Recording disqualifications approved by the Referee.
 - D Determination of the official results.
 - E Publication and posting of results and scores.
- .3 Shall perform other duties assigned by the Referee.

102.15 SCORERS — In a scored meet, shall receive from the Administrative Official the results in timed finals, or consolation finals and championship finals for each event. They shall compile team and high-point scores as applicable.

102.16 TIMING PERSONNEL AND THEIR DUTIES

.1 Chief Timer — The Chief Timer shall:

- A Assure the assignment of Lane Timers to lanes and the designation of one timer on each lane to be the Head Lane Timer.
- B On the starting signal, start a watch(es) on every race. The time of this watch shall be used if a Lane Timer's watch fails.
- C Be responsible for delivering all manual watch times, including those of disqualified swimmers, to the Administrative Official.

.2 Head Lane Timer — The Head Lane Timer shall:

- A Determine whether the swimmer or relay team is present and in the correct lane, heat and event, and record the names and order of relay swimmers prior to the start of the race, and determine that the relay swimmers are swimming in the order listed.
- B Determine and record manual watch times or the absence of a swimmer or the relay team seeded in that lane.
- C Assign one timer to time relay splits and initial distance times if requested by the Chief Timer.
- D Report and indicate on the timing recording form if the swimmer has delayed in touching or has missed the touch pad at the finish, or if there is reason to believe the semi-automatic or manual times may be inaccurate.

.3 Lane Timers — Officials assigned as Lane Timers may simultaneously operate two dissimilar devices (one watch and one button) but not two similar devices (two watches or two buttons). It is not within the Lane Timer's jurisdiction to judge if the swimmer's touch conforms to the applicable finish rules or if a relay take-off infraction has occurred unless assigned concurrent responsibility as a Lane Timer and Turn Judge or Relay Take-off Judge. Each timer shall:

- A Be in position at the start to have an unobstructed view and shall start the watch at the instant of observing the visual starting signal. If the visual starting signal is not observed, the watch shall be started upon hearing the starting signal.
- B Stand directly over the assigned lane at the finish to observe a touch above, at, or below the surface of the water and stop the watch and/or push the semi-automatic system button when any part of the swimmer's body touches the wall.
- C Report the watch time to the Head Lane Timer or the designated recorder, report if a late or missed pad touch is observed; and, if requested, present the watch for inspection. Lane Timers shall not clear their watches until a command to "clear watches" is given or the Referee signals that the next heat is ready to start.

.4 Timing Equipment Operator — The Timing Equipment Operator shall be responsible for the automatic or semi-automatic timing equipment, including the electronic starting system and scoreboard (if used), and shall advise the Referee or Administrative Official of any system problems that might affect the accuracy of times or whenever the touchpad is observed to have failed to record the finish when the swimmer completed the race. The timing equipment should be placed so that the operator is able to observe the finish of each race.

102.17 PRESS STEWARD — Shall obtain from the Clerk of Course or the Administrative Official the names of all swimmers in each event, the results of each finish with times or record performances, and keep the press and TV personnel thoroughly informed on all details of the competition during the meet.

102.18 MARSHALS — Shall wear identifying attire and enforce warm-up procedures and maintain order in the swimming venue. The Marshal shall have full authority to warn or order to cease and desist, and, with the concurrence of the Referee, to remove, or have removed from the swimming venue anyone behaving in an unsafe manner or using profane or abusive language, or whose actions are disrupting the orderly conduct of the meet.

102.19 CLERK OF COURSE — The Clerk of Course shall be provided with a list of the names of all swimmers in all events including relay swimmers in the order in which they will swim. If manual seeding is used, the Clerk of Course shall assign heats and lanes. A Clerk of Course may be used to organize swimmers and escort them to the blocks for their assigned heats.

102.20 ANNOUNCER — The announcer shall make any announcements requested by the Referee, the Clerk of Course, or meet management.

102.21 DISQUALIFICATIONS

1. A disqualification can be made only by the official within whose jurisdiction the infraction has been committed. Except for the Relay Take-off Judges when dual confirmation relay take-off judging, as provided in 102.13.6B, is used, the Referee, Stroke, Turn, or Relay Take-off Judge upon observing an infraction, shall immediately raise one hand overhead. If the official does not do so, there shall be no disqualification unless the meet is being conducted under World Aquatics procedures.
2. The Referee or designated official making a disqualification shall make every reasonable effort to seek out the swimmer or his/her coach and inform him/her as to the reason for the disqualification. Failure to notify does not negate the disqualification.
3. For swimwear disqualifications, refer to 102.8.
4. Any swimmer who acts in an unsportsmanlike or unsafe manner within the swimming venue may be considered for appropriate action or penalty by the Referee.
5. A swimmer must start and finish the race in the same lane.
6. Standing on the bottom during a freestyle race shall not disqualify a swimmer, but a swimmer must not leave the pool, or walk, or spring from the bottom. Standing on the bottom during any other stroke shall result in disqualification.
7. Obstructing or otherwise interfering with another swimmer shall disqualify the offender, subject to the discretion of the Referee.
8. Any swimmer not entered in a race who enters the pool or course in the area in which said race is being conducted before all swimmers therein have completed the race shall be barred from the next individual event in which that swimmer is entered on that day or the next meet day, whichever is first.
9. Dipping goggles in the water or splashing water on the swimmer's face or body prior to an event shall not be considered as entering the pool unless the Referee finds that such action is interfering with the competition.
10. Should a foul endanger the chance of success of a swimmer(s), the Referee may allow the affected swimmer(s) to reswim the event. In case of collusion to foul another swimmer, the Referee may, at his/her discretion, disqualify the swimmer for whose aid the foul was committed, as well as the swimmer committing the foul.

- .11 Grasping lane dividers to assist forward motion is not permitted.
- .12 For relay disqualifications, refer to 101.7.4.
- .13 The time and/or place of any swimmer or relay team disqualified either during or following an event shall not be recorded in the results of that event. If awards have been made prior to the decision to disqualify, they shall be returned and made to the proper recipient(s) and if points have been scored by those disqualified, the event shall be rescored.
- .14 Time and/or place officially recorded for a swimmer shall not be nullified for violations occurring subsequent to such performance.
- .15 Video replay footage from cameras approved in writing in advance of the competition by the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) may be used to ensure that the rules related to the style of swimming designated for the event are being observed, and to observe the starts, turns and finishes.

102.22 PROTESTS

- .1 Protests against the judgment decisions of starters, stroke, turn, place and relay take-off judges can only be considered by the Referee and the Referee's decision shall be final.
- .2 For consideration of all other protests lodged at the meet, the Referee may appoint a meet jury. The jury shall consist of not fewer than three (3) and not more than five (5) persons, at least one of whom shall be a coach and one an athlete.
- .3 Protests made prior to the race contesting the eligibility of a swimmer to compete or to represent an organization shall be made to the Referee in writing. If a protest is not resolved, the Referee or the meet jury shall allow the swimmer to compete under protest and it shall be so announced before the race.
- .4 All other competition-related protests, including protests concerning eligibility and representation, must be made to the Referee and submitted in writing within thirty (30) minutes after the race in which the alleged infraction occurred.
- .5 Except as provided in 102.22.1, the Referee's or the meet jury's ruling may be appealed as follows:
 - A Protests concerning interpretation of the rules in Part One and Part Seven of the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations shall be submitted in writing within ten (10) days to the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair who shall issue a ruling within five (5) days from the date of the receipt of such protest. This ruling shall be final and binding on all parties.
 - B All other protests, together with the Referee's or the jury's written decision, shall be submitted to the National Board of Review, in accordance with Policy 26.0 of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual.
- .6 The official results of any protested race shall not be announced, the affected awards shall not be given, and points scored shall not be allocated until the protest is resolved or is withdrawn in writing.

102.23 TIMING RULES

- .1 **Requirements for Official Time**
 - A **Performance Requirements**
 - (1) An official time can be achieved only in USA Swimming sanctioned or USA Swim-

ming approved competition, or in an observed swim in accordance with all applicable rules. It may be achieved in:

- (a) Any heat.
 - (b) A swim-off.
 - (c) A lead-off leg in a relay swum by four eligible relay members; the lead-off swimmer's time shall not be nullified by a subsequent disqualification of his/her team members.
 - (d) A split time recorded from the official start to the completion of an initial distance with a legal finish within a longer event, provided the swimmer completes the event or the lead-off portion of the relay in compliance with applicable rules.
 - (e) A time trial or a record attempt.
- (2) An official time for an event or a stroke can be achieved only in that event or stroke, or in an initial distance of such event or stroke (e.g., a backstroke time must be achieved in a backstroke event or the backstroke leg of a medley relay). Regardless of the stroke(s) used, times achieved in freestyle events can be recorded only as freestyle times.
- B Timing Resolution** — All timing systems, including manual watches, shall have a resolution of one one-hundredth of a second (0.01 second). Times from all systems shall be recorded to hundredths of a second. The digits representing thousandths shall be dropped with no rounding.
- C System Requirements for Specific Purposes**
- (1) Official times achieved using a timing system in accordance with 102.23.3 are valid for all entry time and recognition program purposes with the following exception: World, American, and U.S. Open Records can be established only when timed by an automatic timing system, a backup camera system, or semiautomatic system if the automatic system fails.
 - (2) A backup time adjusted as described in 102.23.4 may be used as an official time.
- D Backup Timing System Requirement** — Except when the primary system consists of watches, backup timing shall be provided for all competitors. No swimmer shall be required to re-swim a race due to equipment failure which results in unrecorded or inaccurate time or place. It is the Meet Director's responsibility to provide the proper timing systems so that swimmers can expect to achieve official times that will satisfy the requirements of 102.23.1C.
- E Use of Secondary and Tertiary Times** — Secondary and tertiary times shall be recorded but shall not be used except to corroborate or correct missing or inaccurate primary/secondary results.
- .2 Timing Systems** — Every race in a swimming competition shall be timed with one or more of the following systems, listed in their preferred order of use:
- A Automatic** — A timing system activated by a starting device and stopped at the finish by the swimmer touching the touchpad.
 - B Semi-Automatic** — A timing system activated by a starting device and stopped by buttons pushed by timers at the finish touch of the swimmer.

- C **Manual** — A timing system consisting of individual lane timers, each operating a manual watch that is both started and stopped by the timer as described in 102.16.3. Only hand-held, battery-powered, digital read-out type watches designed for timing purposes shall be used.

.3 **Timing System Designation** — Timing systems shall be designated in the order in which results are used as follows:

- A **Primary System** — The primary system shall determine the official time of each swimmer unless a comparison of the primary with secondary and/or tertiary system times indicates a malfunction of the primary system. A primary system shall always be in place and shall consist of one of the following, listed in their preferred order of use:

- (1) Automatic Timing.
- (2) Semi-Automatic, with three (3) or two (2) buttons per lane, each operated by a separate timer.
- (3) Manual, with three (3) watches per lane, each operated by a separate timer.

- B **Secondary System** — If manually operated watches are not the primary system, a secondary system of precedence equal to or lower than the primary system must be used. The secondary system may be:

- (1) Stationary overhead video cameras recording 100 images per second. The cameras must be fully integrated with the primary timing system.
- (2) Semi-Automatic with one (1), two (2), or three (3) buttons, each operated by a separate timer.
- (3) Manual with one (1), two (2) or three (3) watches per lane, each operated by a separate timer.

- C **Tertiary System** — Unless the primary system consists of manual watches or the secondary system is a fully integrated video system or includes at least one (1) manual watch per lane, a tertiary system of at least one (1) manual watch per lane shall be provided.

.4 **Determining Official Time**

- A **Automatic Timing** — When recorded by properly operating automatic timing equipment, the pad time shall be the official time.

- B **Semi-Automatic and Manual Timing** — Whenever semi-automatic or manual timing is used, only valid times shall be used in calculating the official time. The times shall be determined as follows:

- (1) If two of the three valid button or watch times agree, that shall be the time for that timing system.
- (2) If three valid buttons or watches disagree, the time of the intermediate button or watch shall be the time for that timing system.
- (3) If only two valid button or watch times are available, the time shall be the average of those two buttons or the average of the two watch times. The digits representing thousandths of a second shall be dropped with no rounding.
- (4) If only one button or watch time is available, the time of that button or watch shall be the time for that timing system unless that time conflicts with other information. If such a conflict exists, the Administrative Official shall gather as much data as possible and determine the time.

- C Primary Timing System Malfunction** — A malfunction may have occurred if:
- (1) The difference between the time obtained by the primary system and the back-up system(s) is approximately .30 second or greater; or
 - (2) The place judge(s) reports a different order of finish; or
 - (3) It is reported the swimmer missed the touchpad or had a soft touch.
- D Adjustment for Malfunction on a Lane** — When a malfunction is confirmed on a lane, the back-up times for that lane shall be calculated in accordance with 102.23.4B and integrated with the accurate primary times in establishing the official time and determining the results.
- E Adjustment for Malfunction Equally Affecting an Entire Heat** — When, because of an early or late start, or other equipment or operator malfunction, the time of the automatic or semi-automatic primary timing system is equally incorrect for all the lanes in a heat, but the order of finish and thus the absolute difference of time between the swimmers is accurate, the times of the primary system shall be adjusted by calculating the average difference between the primary times and the valid back-up times and adding, or subtracting when appropriate, that difference to the primary times of every lane in that heat. (See Appendix 1 on page 46)

.5 Determining Results

- A Place and Ranking** — The results shall be by integration of official times including those times adjusted in accordance with 102.23.4.
- B Ties** — Official times identical to the hundredths shall be ties, with swim-offs as required to determine qualifiers or alternates for semi-final, consolation or final heats.
- C Judging** — Judging shall only be used to change the results produced by ranking the Official Times if:
- (1) The swimmers competed in the same heat;
 - (2) Times obtained from properly operating automatic timing equipment are not available; and
 - (3) The Place Judges both observed a different relative order of finish and made a written record of their observation immediately following the conclusion of that heat.
- Note:** A different relative order of finish means there is agreement that a different swimmer finished ahead of another swimmer; there need not be agreement on their exact placement within the heat.
- D Impact of Judging on Order of Finish** — If judging changes the results:
- (1) In timed finals meets and the finals of preliminaries and finals meets, such placement by judges decision (JD) shall be indicated in the meet results.
 - (2) In the preliminaries of preliminaries and finals meets, in no case may a swimmer with a faster time displace a swimmer who was judged to have placed ahead of him within a heat according to 102.23.5C. If this should result in disputed qualifications, all swimmers having times tied or within the disputed times shall swim-off for the disputed places in accordance with 102.5.2.

102.24 SCORING

.1 Dual Meets

Individual events: 5-3-1-0

Relays: 7-0

.2 Triangular meets

Individual events: 6-4-3-2-1-0

Relays: 8-4-0

.3 All other meets — Individual events (Individual point values shall be doubled for relays):

4-lane pools: 5-3-2-1

8-lane pools: 9-7-6-5-4-3-2-1

5-lane pools: 6-4-3-2-1

9-lane pools: 10-8-7-6-5-4-3-2-1

6-lane pools: 7-5-4-3-2-1

10-lane pools: 11-9-8-7-6-5-4-3-2-1

7-lane pools: 8-6-5-4-3-2-1

When consolation and championship finals are swum, scoring shall be as follows for individual events (Individual point values shall be doubled for relays, even when relays are swum as timed finals):

6-lane pools (12 places):

A (final): 16-13-12-11-10-9

B (consolation): 7-5-4-3-2-1

7-lane pools (14 places):

A (final): 18-15-14-13-12-11-10

B (consolation): 8-6-5-4-3-2-1

9-lane pools (18 places):

A (final): 22-19-18-17-16-15-14-13-12

B (consolation): 10-8-7-6-5-4-3-2-1

10-lane pools (20 places):

A (final): 24-21-20-19-18-17-16-15-14-13

B (consolation): 11-9-8-7-6-5-4-3-2-1

8-lane pools (16 places):

A (final): 20-17-16-15-14-13-12-11

B (consolation): 9-7-6-5-4-3-2-1

.4 LSC Options — For mixed classification meets, non-standard events, or when an additional (bonus) heat or only a single championship final heat is swum in some or all of the events, the LSC sanctioning the meet shall establish the scoring point values to suit the format of the meet. These point values shall be stated in the meet announcement.**.5 Ties** — Where two or more swimmers tie for any place in any event, the points credited to such place or places, if any, next in order shall be equally divided between such swimmers; i.e., if two tie for first place, the points to be credited to first place and the points to be credited to second place shall be added and divided one-half and one-half. If three tie for first place, the points credited to first, second and third places shall be added and divided one-third, one-third and one-third, and so on for four or more tying for first place. The same is true for those tying for second place, third place, and whatever places there may be.**.6 Disqualifications** — When a relay team or individual swimmer is disqualified, the subsequent places will move up accordingly and points shall be awarded to conform to the new places. Consolation finalists shall not receive championship final placing. Alternates shall not receive consolation final placing.

102.25 AWARDS — When two or more swimmers tie for any place, duplicate awards shall be given to each of such tied swimmers. In such cases, no awards shall be given for the place or places immediately following the tied positions. If two tie for 1st place, no award for 2nd place; if three tie for 1st place, no awards for 2nd or 3rd, and so on.

102.26 MEET RESULTS — Meet results shall be provided, as directed by the LSC, within fourteen (14) days after the meet. The results may also be provided in an electronic format or posted to a website. Meet results shall include the following information:

.1 Meet name, date, location, sanction number, and the pool length (25y, 25m or 50m) must appear on every page and the pages must be numbered.

- .2 Any scores, team or individual, if kept.
- .3 For each individual event, the order of finish in preliminaries, finals and swim-offs, when applicable, listing the swimmer's first and last name, age, club affiliation and official time; disqualified swimmers shall be listed last and indicated "DQ," with no times listed. Time Trial results shall be provided in the above format, when applicable. If the meet is computerized and connected directly to or interfaced with the automatic timing system, then all available initial distance times satisfying the requirements listed in 102.23.1A shall be provided upon request.
- .4 For relays, in addition to the order of finish, affiliation, and official time, the swimmers' first and last names, ages, the order in which they swam, and, if available, lead-off swimmer's time, shall be included.

Note: First names may be abbreviated within the limitations of the printing or computer program.

APPENDIX 1

EXAMPLE OF HEAT MALFUNCTION

Primary - Automatic (Late manual start confirmed);
Secondary - Semi-automatic, three buttons (button time not valid);
Tertiary - Manual, one watch

*Adjustment calculation:

▼ Add the differences between the pad and watch times; total = 24.50; ▼ Divide 24.50 by the number of lanes to determine an average: 24.50 divided by 8 = 3.0625; the digits after hundredths are dropped, leaving a heat adjustment of 3.06; ▼ Add the adjustment factor of 3.06 seconds for late start of the primary system to each pad time to obtain the official time for that lane.

LANE	PRIMARY PAD TIME	WATCH TIME	WATCH TIME LESS PAD TIME	HEAT ADJUSTMENT*	OFFICIAL TIME
1	52.12	55.14	3.02	+3.06	55.18
2	51.56	54.61	3.05	+3.06	54.62
3	51.09	54.18	3.09	+3.06	54.15
4	50.12	53.18	3.06	+3.06	53.18
5	49.78	52.90	3.12	+3.06	52.84
6	49.06	52.06	3.00	+3.06	52.12
7	52.21	55.30	3.09	+3.06	55.27
8	52.92	55.99	3.07	+3.06	55.98
			24.50 total		

ARTICLE 103 FACILITIES STANDARDS

1

103.1 DEFINITIONS

- .1 /M/ = Indicates mandatory requirement for all competition.
- .2 /NC/ = Except as noted otherwise, indicates mandatory requirement for USA Swimming Championships and International Competition.
- .3 /LSC/ = Predicated on facility availability, LSCs may waive strict compliance with these requirements in sanctioning local competition.
- .4 Where dimensions are given, the dimension listed first shall govern, and dimensions given in parenthesis are for reference only.

103.2 WATER DEPTH

- .1 **/NC/ 2 meters (6 feet 7 inches) deep throughout the course.**
- .2 **/M/ Teaching Racing Starts** — Minimum water depth for teaching all racing starts, prior to certification, in any setting from any height starting blocks, from backstroke ledges or from the deck shall be 6 feet (1.84 meters) measured for a distance of 3 feet 3-1/2 inches (1.0 meter) to 16 feet 5 inches (5.0 meters) from the end wall. Teaching racing starts shall only take place under the direct supervision of a USA Swimming member coach and shall include:
 - A All racing start instruction until a swimmer has been certified by his or her USA Swimming member coach as proficient in performing a racing start; and
 - B Subsequent to certification, instruction which seeks to alter a swimmer's basic technique in performing a racing start.

Prior to certification, all racing starts must take place from a position in the water, and without use of the backstroke ledge, regardless of pool depth. Subsequent to certification, practicing of racing starts may take place in water depth of four (4) feet (1.22 meters) and deeper.

- .3 **/M/ Racing Starts** — Minimum water depth for racing starts during practice and competition shall be measured for a distance 3 feet 3-1/2 inches (1.0 meter) to 16 feet 5 inches (5.0 meters) from the end wall. Starting requirements and height of starting block shall be:
 - A In pools with water depth less than 4 feet (1.22 meters) at the starting end;
 - (1) The swimmer must start in the water;
 - (2) Backstroke starting ledges are not permitted.
 - B In pools with water depth 4 feet (1.22 meters) or more at the starting end, starting platforms shall meet the height requirements of 103.14.1.

Note: Local, state and municipal statutes, ordinances, rules and regulations, may have depth limitations in conflict with this section. The LSC and all Member Clubs should check for this at all times.

103.3 RACING COURSE DIMENSIONS

.1 /M/ Length.

- A **Long Course:** 50.00 meters (164 feet and 1/2 inch).
- B **Short Course:** 25.00 yards or 25.00 meters (82 feet and 1/4 inch).
- C **Dimensional Tolerance:** Against the required length, a tolerance of minus (-) 0.000 meters in a vertical plane extending 0.3 meters (12 inches) above and 0.8 meters (2 feet 7-1/2 inches) below the surface of the water at all points of both end walls. The plus tolerances apply for National, Trials Class, World Aquatics and international competition. See the current Operating Policy Manual and World Aquatics Facilities Rules FR2 for details.
- D When automatic officiating equipment touch pads are used at one or both ends, the course shall be of such length that ensures the required distance between the two touch pads or between either pad and the opposite end of the course.
- E When the racing course is fixed by the use of movable bulkheads, such bulkheads shall be designed to resist lateral deflection due to tension exerted by the attachment of the lane dividers to ensure the required course distance in all lanes.
- F See Article 104, Rules for Swimming Records, for course measurements requirements.

.2 Width.

- A /NC/ Eight or ten lanes, minimum width of 2.5 meters (8 feet 2-1/2 inches), from center line to center line of the lane dividers, with approximately 0.45 meters (1 foot 6 inches) of additional open water outside lanes 1 and 8 (or 10). The Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) may waive this requirement for National Championships.
- B /LSC/ Minimum lane width for competitive swimming shall be 7 feet (2.13 meters).

103.4 /M/ RACING COURSE WALLS

- .1 **Permanent Course Walls** — Walls enclosing the racing course shall be parallel and vertical. The end walls shall be at a right angle to the water surface and shall be constructed of solid material with non-slip surface that extends no less than 0.8 meters (2 feet 7-1/2 inches) below the water surface.
- .2 **Movable Bulkhead Course Walls** — If a continuous recessed hand grip is provided at or near the water surface in a movable bulkhead, the horizontal dimension of the recess perpendicular to the bulkhead should be not less than six inches (.15 meters) and designed in a manner to prevent the swimmer's fingers from contacting the back surface of the recess.

103.5 /LSC/ POOL AND BULKHEAD MARKINGS

- .1 **Pool bottom lane markers:** Minimum 10-inch (25-centimeter) wide lines of a dark contrasting color (preferably black) shall be provided in the middle of each racing lane on the bottom of the pool. The lines should be uninterrupted the length of the course and shall end with a distinctive cross line 1.0 meters (3 feet 4 inches) long and the same width as the bottom marker. The line, including the cross line, shall terminate 2.00 meters (6 feet 7 inches) from each end wall.
- .2 **End wall targets:** Flush, non-slip targets in a shape of a "T" or a cross and the same width as the lane bottom markers shall be provided in the center of each lane on each end wall of the course and shall extend at least 3 feet 4 inches (1.0 meters) below the level of the water surface. It is recommended that the top edge of the deck be of a contrasting color to provide a visual target above water at the end of the course.

- .3 **/M/ 15-Meter Markings:** Fixed distinctive marks shall be placed on either the pool wall or deck surface adjacent to any outside lane at a distance of 15 meters from each end wall of the course. These marks should also be used to correctly align the distinctive floats on the lane dividers, but the fixed marks on the deck or walls take precedence for judging.

.4 **Lane Numbers**

- A The lanes shall be numbered from right to left as the swimmers stand facing the course.
- B Lane numbers shall clearly identify the lanes to officials stationed on each side of the course.

103.6 /M/ OVERFLOW RECIRCULATION SYSTEM — The pool water recirculation and overflow system shall maintain water level in line with the overflow rim of the pool gutters without creating appreciable current or water turbulence and shall maintain smooth and calm water surface during competition.

103.7 WATER AND AIR TEMPERATURE

- .1 /LSC/ Water temperature between 25 to 28 degrees Celsius (77 to 82.4 degrees Fahrenheit) shall be maintained for competition.
- .2 Air temperature within 8 feet above deck level in indoor facilities shall be not lower than 76 degrees Fahrenheit, with relative humidity maintained at about 60% and air velocity at about 25 feet per minute.

103.8 /M/ LADDERS — All ladders, steps or stairs within the racing course shall be recessed in the pool side walls or shall be removed during competition.

103.9 OTHER DECK EQUIPMENT

- .1 /LSC/ Use of portable lifeguard chair stands and other deck fixtures is recommended and they should be removed from the competition area to allow free passage and unobstructed view for competitors and officials along all sides of the course.
- .2 /M/ 1-meter diving boards which overhang the racing course shall be hinged out of the way or removed during competition.

103.10 /M/ LIGHTING

- .1 /LSC/ A minimum of one hundred (100) foot candle illumination level is required at the water surface over the entire course. Overhead light fixtures shall be located to avoid the casting of shadows by the pool walls over the racing course.
- .2 /NC/ At National Championships, the same type and level of illumination that will be used for finals must be provided and maintained during the warm-up period and preliminaries.

103.11 /M/ TOBACCO PRODUCTS — Smoking and use of other tobacco products is prohibited in all areas of the venue.

103.12 /M/ ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES — Alcoholic beverages or the recognition of alcohol sponsors are prohibited in all areas of the venue. Exceptions to this provision include USA Swimming National Championships, Trials Class meets, U.S. Open Championships, USA Swimming Open Water National Championships and the Pro Series events or other events approved by the USA Swimming Chief Commercial Officer.

103.13

103.13 /M/ DRONES — Operation of a drone, or any other flying apparatus, is prohibited over the venue (pools, athlete/coach areas, spectator areas and open-ceiling locker rooms) any time athletes, coaches, officials and/or spectators are present.

Exceptions may be granted with prior written approval by the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee).

103.14 /M/ STARTING PLATFORMS

.1 Height:

- A **Long course and short course meters:** The front edge of the starting platform shall be no less than 0.50 meters (1 foot 8 inches) nor more than 0.75 meters (2 feet 5-1/2 inches) above the surface of the water.
 - B **Short course yards:** The front edge of the starting platform shall be not higher than 2 feet 6 inches (0.762 meters) above the surface of the water.
- .2 The front edge of the starting platform shall be flush with the face of the end walls.
 - .3 The top surface of the starting platform shall be not less than 0.50 by 0.50 meters (1 foot 8 inches square) and shall slope not more than 10 degrees from the horizontal. It may have an adjustable setting back plate. The entire surface of the platform shall be faced with permanent non-slip material. Handgrips for the forward start may be installed on the sides of the starting platforms.
 - .4 **Backstroke starting grips:** Starting platforms shall be equipped with firm starting grips located between 0.3 meters (12 inches) and 0.6 meters (24 inches) above water surface. The front edge of the grips shall be parallel to and flush with the face of the end wall.
 - .5 Starting platforms shall be clearly marked with lane numbers visible to competitors and officials. (See 103.5.3)
 - .6 Starting platforms shall be anchored to the deck or bulkhead to remain stable at all times.

103.15 BACKSTROKE LEDGE — The backstroke ledge shall conform to World Aquatics' specifications when used in competition as follows:

- .1 /M/ The ledge may be adjustable to 4 centimeters above or 4 centimeters below the water level.
- .2 /M/ The ledge shall be a minimum of 65 centimeters in length.
- .3 /M/ The ledge must be 8 centimeters in height, 2 centimeters at the width with 10 degrees of slope.
- .4 /M/ The ledge may not be used in water depth less than 4 feet (1.22 meters).
- .5 /M/ Should backstroke ledges be used, identical ledges shall be provided for all lanes.

103.16 /M/ FLOATING LANE DIVIDERS AND MARKINGS

- .1 Floating lane dividers shall extend the full length of the course and shall be attached at each end wall with recessed anchors so located that the center line of the cable securing the dividers shall be on the surface of the water with the bottom half uniformly submerged for its entire length. They shall:
 - A Separate the racing lanes.
 - B /LSC/ Be outside the outermost lanes being used.
- .2 Dividers shall consist of contiguous floats having a minimum diameter of 5 centimeters (2

inches) to a maximum diameter of 15 centimeters (6 inches). The color of the floats extending from the walls the distance of 5 meters for long course and short course meters and 15 feet for short course yards shall be distinct from the rest of the floats. Distinctive colored floats, or markers extending around the full circumference of the floats, shall be placed at 15 meters (49 feet 2-1/2 inches) from each end wall in both short course and long course pools. Additionally, in long course pools, a distinctive warning line or lane markers may be placed at a distance of 13 meters from each end wall. Damaged or broken floats shall be removed and/or replaced, to the extent possible.

- .3 /LSC/ A single line of dividers between racing lanes shall be used in long course and short course meters competition. Multiple lines may be installed for short course yards competition, provided the width of water between dividers is not reduced to less than 7 feet.
- .4 /NC/ Minimum 11 centimeter diameter floats shall be required for National Championships.

103.17 /M/ BACKSTROKE FLAGS AND LINES

- .1 **Design:** At least three triangular pennants six (6) to twelve (12) inches in width at the base and twelve (12) to eighteen (18) inches in vertical length, of two or more alternating and contrasting colors shall be suspended on a firmly stretched line over each lane during all warm-up periods and during competition for all backstroke, individual medley and medley relay events.
- .2 **Location:**
 - A **Long course and short course meters:** 5 meters (16 feet 5 inches) from each end of the course, and
 - (1) a minimum of 1.8 meters (5 feet 11 inches) to a maximum of 2.5 meters (8 feet 3 inches) above the water surface.
 - (2) /NC/ 1.8 meters (5 feet 11 inches) above the water surface,
 - B **Short course yards:** 15 feet (4.57 meters) from each end of the course, 7 feet (2.13 meters) above the water surface.
 - C Height shall be measured to the horizontal line from which the pennants are suspended.

103.18 /NC/ LOUDSPEAKER START SYSTEM — An electronic sound generating device shall be provided to give the starting and recall signal. Loudspeakers may be mounted underneath or on the side of each starting platform, between every two platforms, on each side of the racing course, or positioned behind the starting platforms in such a manner that equitable dispersion of sound to all lanes is assured. The device shall also activate a strobe light, or similar visual signal, located on the starter's side of the course approximately 15 feet forward from the starting end, to indicate the start to manual timers and swimmers who are deaf or hard of hearing. The start system may include an underwater recall speaker and final lap signal option.

103.19 /M/ RECALL DEVICE — A device to recall swimmers shall be provided. If a recall rope is used, it shall be placed at the mid-point of the course in long course facilities and at the turn end backstroke flags in short course facilities.

103.20 /LSC/ PACE CLOCKS — There shall be at least two large accurate timing devices or clocks, preferably located one on each side of the course, clearly visible to all swimmers in all warm-up/warm-down areas.

103.21 AUTOMATIC OFFICIATING EQUIPMENT

- .1 /NC/ See 102.23 for Automatic and Semi-Automatic Timing equipment types and perfor-

mance requirements. Equipment powered directly from the utility line electrical service shall have the capability to automatically switch to stand-by battery power source in case of line power failure without affecting the continuity and accuracy of the timing system.

- .2 **/M/ Installation and Safety:** Equipment shall be installed so that it will not interfere with swimmers' start, turns, or finish and the normal overflow functions of the pool water recirculation system. All deck-level wiring shall carry no more than 12 volts.
- .3 **/NC/Touch Pads:**
 - A **Size and thickness:** Recommended pad size shall be 6 feet 6 inches (2 meters) wide and not less than 2 feet (0.60 meters) deep. Minimum width of pads shall be 5 feet (1.52 meters). Thickness shall not exceed 3/8 of an inch (1 centimeter).
 - B **Markings:** Panel face markings shall conform and superimpose on pool end wall markings as closely as possible. Perimeter edges of the panel shall have a one-inch wide black border.
 - C **Sensitivity:** Panels shall stop the timing system instantaneously by a light hand touch anywhere on the flat surface facing the racing course and the upper edge but shall not be activated by water turbulence.
 - D Panels shall be installed and firmly anchored in the center of each lane and shall have no sharp edges, corners, or other protrusions on any exposed surfaces.
 - E At the facilities in which competition to select USA Swimming National Teams for the Olympic Games and World Championships is held, the touch pads must be minimum 0.9 meters (2 feet 11-7/16 inches) high, 2.4 meters (7 feet 10-1/2 inches) wide and maximum one centimeter (3/8 of an inch) in thickness. Such pads shall be installed at end of the course and shall extend 0.3 meters each (11-3/16 inches) above and 0.6 meters (1 foot 11-5/8 inches) below the water surface. The Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) may waive this requirement for National Championships.
- .4 **Optional Accessories:** Automatic officiating equipment may provide relay judging capability, automatic lap counting, split times' readouts for all lanes, correction of erroneous touch, and television equipment tie-in. Any corrections or impulses generated by the equipment operators shall be clearly identified on the results printout.
- .5 **Time Display Board (optional):**
 - A An automatic display board visible to all swimmers shall give a digital time read-out to two decimal places, displaying split times, final times, and places for all lanes. In the event of a tie, the place shall be displayed as a tie.
 - B **/NC/** A separate line of display for each lane meeting the above requirements shall be provided for National Championships.

103.22 /M/ ELECTRICAL SAFETY — All permanent or temporary electrical connections to the electronic loudspeaker start system, automatic officiating equipment, and other electrical or electronic devices operating on line voltages in the vicinity of the racing course shall be made only from ground-fault circuit interrupter (GFCI) protected convenience receptacles or circuits. In the event such receptacles or circuits are not available in the facility used for competition, portable U.L. approved self-contained type GFCI outlet fittings shall be provided (furnished and installed) at the non-protected convenience receptacles by the meet management, Meet Director, or the equipment operator(s) whenever such equipment is connected and in use.

ARTICLE 104

RULES FOR SWIMMING RECORDS

1

104.1 WORLD RECORDS

- .1 May be established only in 25-meter and 50-meter pools and shall conform to the recognized distance, stroke and other current governing regulations of World Aquatics.
- .2 All claims shall be sent immediately following the performance to USA Swimming. Supporting evidence must be filed on official World Aquatics World Record application forms, which must be submitted to the Executive Director of World Aquatics within 14 days after the performance. Responsibility for this filing shall rest with the Meet and/or Administrative Referee.

104.2 USA SWIMMING RECORDS

.1 General Requirements and Conditions for Records

- A The official time for establishing specific records must be achieved and determined in accordance with 102.23.
- B Record times registered by automatic equipment shall be in hundredths of a second (two decimal places). If first place times are tied to a hundredth of a second, the results shall be declared to be a tie and the record shall be shared by each swimmer.
- C No record shall be considered that results from a meet sanctioned by a conference, league, LSC, allied member, or organizational member whose rules governing performance do not conform to Parts One, Two and Seven of USA Swimming Rules & Regulations unless such swim is observed in accordance with 202.8.
- D For LSC and local records only, unless prohibited by the LSC, the Referee, if requested, for the purposes of recording record attempts at an initial distance for an individual event or for the lead-off leg of a relay, may for any lane:
 - (1) Permit the use of split times recorded by a fully automatic timing system; or
 - (2) Assign three (3) additional official timers to the lane to time the record attempt.

Note: Performances in this category require the swimmer(s) to complete the full distance of the scheduled event in compliance with applicable rules including a legal finish at the initial distance.
- E Should the first swimmer on a legally composed relay team complete his/her leg in a record time for that stroke/distance, his/her performance shall not be nullified by a subsequent disqualification of his/her team members.
- F To be eligible for a record a swimmer must have won his/her heat. Only the time of the winner is recognized for record purposes even though another swimmer may have a faster time but is displaced by judge's or ballot decision. If the judge's or ballot decision results in a tie, all tied swimmers shall share the faster time of such finish. The requirement to win the heat does not apply:
 - (1) When age or representation is a condition for setting LSC or Age Group records;
 - (2) To a U.S. citizen setting an American record in competition with non-U.S. citizens; or
 - (3) When achieved as the lead-off leg in a relay race or at an initial distance.

.2 American and United States Open Records

A Classification

- (1) **American** — May be established only by United States Citizens who are also U.S. Sports Citizens who achieve an official time in accordance with USA Swimming rules.
- (2) **United States Open** — May be established only within the geographical territory of the United States by any person eligible to compete under and achieving an official time in accordance with USA Swimming rules.

B Recognized Distances and Strokes (Men and Women)

- (1) **Short Course Yards** — Made only over courses 25 yards long

Freestyle	50, 100, 200, 500, 1000, 1650 yards
Backstroke	100, 200 yards
Breaststroke	100, 200 yards
Butterfly	100, 200 yards
Individual Medley	200, 400 yards
Freestyle Relay	200, 400, 800 yards
Mixed Competition Category Freestyle Relay	200, 400, 800 yards
Medley Relay	200, 400 yards
Mixed Competition Category Medley Relay	200, 400 yards
- (2) **Short Course Meters** — Made only over courses 25 meters long

Freestyle	50, 100, 200, 400, 800, 1500 meters
Backstroke	50, 100, 200 meters
Breaststroke	50, 100, 200 meters
Butterfly	50, 100, 200 meters
Individual Medley	100, 200, 400 meters
Freestyle Relay	200, 400, 800 meters
Mixed Competition Category Freestyle Relay	200, 400, 800 meters
Medley Relay	200, 400 meters
Mixed Competition Category Medley Relay	200, 400 meters
- (3) **Long Course** — Made only over courses 55 yards or 50 meters long

Freestyle	50, 100, 200, 400, 800, 1500 meters
Backstroke	50, 100, 200 meters
Breaststroke	50, 100, 200 meters
Butterfly	50, 100, 200 meters
Individual Medley	200, 400 meters
Freestyle Relay	200, 400, 800 meters
Mixed Competition Category Freestyle Relay	200, 400, 800 meters
Medley Relay	200, 400 meters
Mixed Competition Category Medley Relay	200, 400 meters

C Special Requirements and Conditions

- (1) Lead-off legs/initial distances of mixed competition category relays shall not count for American or U.S. Open records.
- (2) American Records established outside of the United States shall be applied for on official record application forms. When an American Record results from a World Record performance outside the United States, it shall be accepted as such upon formal approval by World Aquatics without further certification.
- (3) When a record is claimed, an official record application form shall be filled out, signed by the designated officials, and transmitted to USA Swimming with all supporting data, including official meet results and official measurement of the

lane(s), within 14 days after the performance. Record applications will not be accepted unless certification of course length accompanies them.

(4) **Pool Measurement**

- (a) The length of the course shall be measured and certified by a qualified person in accordance with the standards established by USA Swimming. Such measurements shall be stated in feet and inches and fractions of an inch, or feet and hundredths of a foot for short course yards pools, or in meters for long or short course meters pools.
- (b) A statement of the conditions under which the course was measured must be included.
- (c) Where a moveable bulkhead is used, course measurement of the lane in which the record was set must be confirmed at the conclusion of the session during which the time was achieved and submitted by the meet referee to USA Swimming.
- (5) Pending record claims upon approval by USA Swimming shall be declared effective immediately.
- (6) American and United States Open Records established at the USA Swimming National Championships, the U.S. Open, any World Cup event sponsored by USA Swimming, and at events conducted by World Aquatics, shall, upon receipt of official results, and proper completion of pool certification, be declared effective immediately unless a faster claim is pending.
- (7) Swimmers who establish a record shall be presented with a certificate signed by the Board Chair of USA Swimming and the President/CEO (or his/her designee).

.3 National Age Group Records

A Requirements

- (1) Only USA Swimming members, who are U.S. citizens representing a USA Swimming club or competing unattached, are eligible to establish National Age Group records.
- (2) Times uploaded that are Age Group records must comply with all the requirements of the National Age Group Recognition Program as listed in 205.9.

B Reporting — When an Age Group record is reported, an official Age Group Record Application Form (posted on the USA Swimming website) shall be filled out, signed by the designated officials, and transmitted along with proper completion of pool measurement within thirty (30) days.

C Recognition — Upon confirmation of a National Age Group Record by USA Swimming including receipt of the record application and proper completion of pool measurement, a certificate of record achievement will be sent to all swimmers and members of relays whose time meets or betters the current National Age Group Record.

.4 Zone Age Group Records

A Requirements — Zone records must be achieved in Zone championship meets.

B Reporting — Each Zone shall determine the means of reporting Zone records.

C Recognition — Each Zone shall determine appropriate recognition for Zone records.

.5 **LSC Records****A Requirements**

- (1) LSC Records must be achieved by LSC member swimmers in USA Swimming or World Aquatics sanctioned competition. This competition can be at any level including Senior and international competition.
- (2) LSCs may elect to recognize times achieved by member swimmers in approved competition or in USA Swimming observed swims.
- (3) An LSC may establish All-Star records which would include All-Star relay performances achieved by swimmers representing the LSC in Zone, Regional, or dual meets involving All-Star teams. Individual times including lead-off splits should be recognized by the LSC with the swimmer's LSC club of record (or unattached if appropriate) for any LSC records, National records or NAG Recognition Times.

B Reporting — The LSC shall determine the method of reporting LSC records.

C Recognition — The LSC shall determine appropriate recognition for LSC records.

ARTICLE 105

**GUIDELINES FOR OFFICIATING SWIMMERS WITH A DISABILITY
IN USA SWIMMING MEETS**

105.1 GENERAL

- .1 **Authority** — The USA Swimming Rules & Regulations grant the Referee the authority to modify the rules for the swimmer with a disability. Disability is defined as a permanent physical or cognitive disability that substantially limits one or more major life activities. This section contains guidelines and suggestions for making such modifications. Reference 701.24 for Open Water competitions.

.2 Responsibilities

A Swimmer/Coach — The swimmer (or the swimmer's coach) is responsible for notifying the Referee, prior to the competition, of any swimmer with a disability and of the requested accommodations and/or modifications. The swimmer/coach shall provide a Personal Assistant(s) or any equipment (tappers, deck mats, etc.) if required.

B Meet Referee — The Meet Referee's responsibilities include:

- (1) Determining if the requested accommodations/modifications are appropriate and can be met.
- (2) Instructing the Deck Referee and Starter as to how the accommodations and/or modifications will be made for the swimmer with a disability.
- (3) In communication with the remaining officiating crew, a Meet Referee may:
 - a. Instruct them to observe and report ANY violation of the rules and vet the call against the approved modification(s) and apply Article 105 to overturn the call,
 - b. Or, share the specific modification(s) and instruct them to observe and report any violation except the approved modification(s).

.3 Accommodations/Modifications

- A Accommodations are considerations which allow a swimmer with a disability to access the facility (locker rooms, restrooms, pool deck, warm-up/down pool) and afford the athlete the time, assistance and deck space required to obtain a starting position for each event. Accommodations which the Meet Referee may approve for the swimmer with a disability include but are not limited to:
 - (1) Reassignment of lanes within a heat (e.g., exchanging Lanes 2 and 7).
 - (2) Allowing a swimmer to have a personal assistant(s) for any reason approved by the Meet Referee.
 - (3) Assuring proximity wheelchair access from deck to block.
- B Modifications are any exception to the technical rules approved by the Meet Referee (See 102.11.9) allowing a parallel performance for a swimmer with a disability. Aids to buoyancy or speed are not allowed (See 102.8.1E). Modifications which the Meet Referee may approve for the swimmer with a disability include but are not limited to:
 - (1) Personal Assistant to act as a tapper at the turn and finish walls for a swimmer who is blind or has low vision.
 - (2) Use of visual starting signal(s) (strobe and hand signals) for a swimmer that is deaf or hard of hearing.
 - (3) Inability of the swimmer to turn a foot out in breaststroke during the propulsive part of the kick.
 - (4) Examples of other allowable modifications are further described in this section under the type of disability. Allowable modifications in accordance with Article 105 shall affect the current meet and shall not set a precedent (See 102.11.9).

105.2 BLIND AND VISION LOSS

- .1 **Start** — With an audible starting system, no modification is usually required for a swimmer who is blind or has vision loss. A swimmer may, however, require assistance getting to and on the block. Should the swimmer feel insecure starting from the block or deck, an in-the-water start is allowed.
- .2 **Turns and Finishes** — A swimmer who is blind or has vision loss is permitted to have Personal Assistants ("tappers" who use poles with soft-tipped ends to tap the swimmer as notification of turns and the finish). Sound devices shall not be used. It is the swimmer's responsibility to provide the tapper(s), who shall be positioned within the confines of the swimmer's lane at the ends of the pool.
- .3 **Relay Take-Offs** — A physical touch may be required to signal the relay swimmer when his/her teammate has touched the wall. The specific method may be tailored to the swimmer's preference so long as it does not aid the swimmer's take-off or interfere with the timing.

105.3 DEAF OR HARD OF HEARING



FIGURE 1: FORWARD START
A. Twist hand at chin level — short whistles
B. Arm overhead — long whistle — swimmer steps onto starting block
C. Arm moves to shoulder level — signal to "Take Your Marks"
D. Arm moves to side of body — starting signal
E. Arm raised overhead with palm up (at any time after C. ["Take Your Marks"] and prior to D. [starting signal]) — swimmer released from "Take Your Marks" command)

FIGURE 2: BACKSTROKE START
A. Twist hand at chin level — short whistles
B. Arm overhead — long whistle — swimmer enters water; drop arm to side while swimmer enters water
C. Arm overhead — swimmer returns to backstroke start position
D. Arm moves to shoulder level — signal to "Take Your Marks"
E. Arm moves to side of body — starting signal
F. Arm raised overhead with palm up (at any time after D. ["Take Your Marks"] and prior to E. [starting signal]) — swimmer released from "Take Your Marks" command)

- 1 Swimmers who are deaf or hard of hearing require a visual starting signal, i.e., a strobe light and/or Starter's arm signals. The Referee may reassign lanes within the swimmer's heat, i.e., exchanging one lane for another, so that the strobe light or Starter's arm signal can more readily be seen by the swimmer who is deaf or hard of hearing. Standard Starter's arm signals are shown in Figures 1 and 2. A recall rope is required in the event of a recall, provided the meet host is notified by the entry deadline that a swimmer who is deaf or hard of hearing will be participating.
- 2 **Strobe Light Location** — The Starter shall advise the swimmers about the location of the strobe light and the light shall be located where the swimmers can clearly see it for the start. For backstroke starts, the light should be positioned so that the swimmers don't have to turn their heads to look backwards.

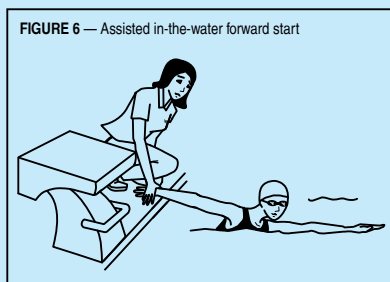
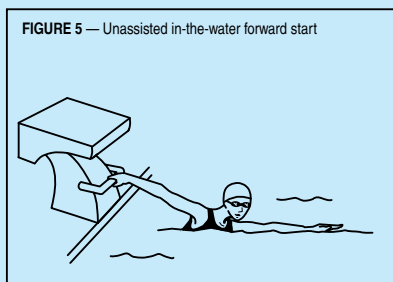
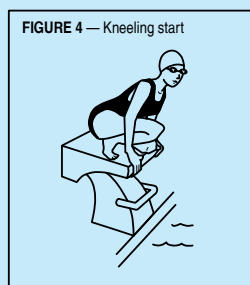
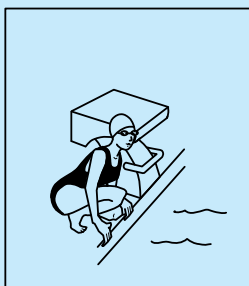
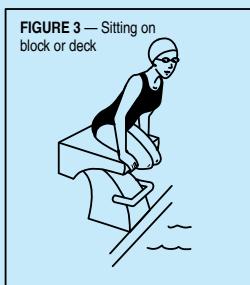
105.4 COGNITIVE DISABILITIES — A swimmer with a cognitive disability may be permitted to have a Personal Assistant on the deck when necessary. Specific circumstances may allow rule modifications as communicated and approved in accordance with Rule 105.1.2 to be granted. Patience and clarity in communication is often required for a swimmer with a cognitive disability.

105.5 PHYSICAL DISABILITIES

.1 **Start** — Swimmers with physical disabilities:

- A May take longer to assume their starting position;
- B May have difficulty holding the starting platform or pool end for a start;
- C May need assistance from someone on the deck to maintain a starting position;
- D May use a modified starting position on the blocks, deck or in the water.
- E Shall use a forward start for freestyle, breaststroke and butterfly. The Referee, however, may allow modifications such as the following:
 - (1) The swimmer may start from a sitting position on the block or on the deck;
 - (2) The swimmer may assume a starting position in the water, with or without assistance;
 - (3) If the swimmer cannot use a hand and/or foot to maintain contact with the wall, some other part of the body may be used.
 - (4) For breaststroke and butterfly, after the start and after each turn, a swimmer who is unable to push off with the leg(s) may perform one arm stroke that need not be simultaneous to attain the breast position.

Examples of modified starting positions are shown in Figures 3 through 7.



- ### .2 **Stroke/Kick** — In judging the stroke or kick of a swimmer with a physical disability, the Referee and Stroke & Turn Judge should follow the general rule that: if a part of the body is absent or cannot be used, it is not judged; if it is used during the stroke or kick, it should be

judged in accordance with the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations.

Judgments should be made based on the actual rule — not on the swimmer's technique. For example, the breaststroke swimmer with one arm or leg shorter than the other, may have a non-symmetrical stroke or kick, but as long as the arm or leg action is simultaneous, it would meet that portion of the rule. No flotation devices should be permitted.

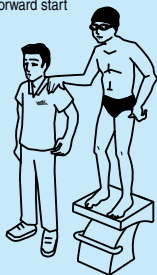
.3 Turn/Finishes

A Touches shall be judged in the same manner as strokes and kicks, i.e., on the basis of the arm(s) and/or hand(s) that the swimmer can use. In breaststroke and butterfly events, the competitor must reach forward as if attempting a simultaneous two-hand touch. When a swimmer has a different arm length, only the longer arm must touch the wall, but both arms must be stretched forward simultaneously. Swimmers with no arms or with upper limbs too short to stretch above the head may touch the wall with any part of the upper body.

B At the turn and finish of the butterfly, an athlete with no leg function is permitted to perform a partial stroke with the arm(s) recovering forward under the surface of the water in order to touch the wall.

.4 **Relays** — Relay swimmers who cannot exit the water immediately may be allowed to remain in the lane until all relays have finished so long as they do not interfere with the other swimmers or the timing equipment.

FIGURE 7 — Assisted on block or deck forward start



PART TWO

ADMINISTRATIVE REGULATIONS OF COMPETITION

ARTICLE 201 CLASSES OF COMPETITION

2

201.1 COMPETITIVE CLASSIFICATIONS — Swimming shall be conducted under the following classifications and participation is open to athletes from any country subject to further pertinent regulations in these rules and elsewhere.

- .1 **Senior** — All athlete members of USA Swimming are eligible for the Senior Class.
- .2 **Age Group** — All athlete members of USA Swimming eighteen (18) years old and younger grouped by ages. Where a program for swimmers ages eight (8) and under is conducted, it shall be for developmental purposes only and shall be subject to LSC procedures.
- .3 **Post Age Group** — All athlete members of USA Swimming older than eighteen (18) years of age whom an LSC elects to include in its Age Group program.
- .4 **Open Water** — All athlete members of USA Swimming are eligible for Open Water Swimming.

ARTICLE 202 SANCTIONS AND APPROVALS

(See page 129 regarding Dual-Sanctioned Events)

202.1 JURISDICTION — As the National Governing Body for competitive swimming in the United States and as a Federation member of World Aquatics, USA Swimming has the sole and exclusive authority to sanction or approve domestic and international swimming competition conducted within its jurisdiction. Each Local Swimming Committee (LSC) has been authorized by USA Swimming to issue the sanction or approval for all swimming competition and benefits, exhibitions, clinics and entertainment involving competitive swimming within its geographical boundaries, except that USA Swimming shall sanction national swimming competitions as defined by the President/CEO (or his/her designee). *Additional requirements/conditions for sanction or approval, other than those listed in Article 202, may be established by a vote of the LSC House of Delegates in accordance with LSC Bylaws.*

202.2 SANCTION AND APPROVAL PROCEDURE

- .1 An LSC shall establish submission deadlines for sanction or approval applications and shall publish such deadlines, along with relevant instructions and forms.
- .2 LSCs shall establish and publish policies regarding applications submitted after published deadlines, citing relevant fees and penalties.
- .3 If an application is denied, the LSC shall provide written notification within ten (10) days to the applicant of the reasons for the denial and of the appeals process.

202.3 PROCEDURE FOR APPEAL — An applicant whose application has been denied by an LSC shall have the right to appeal the denial to the Zone Sanction Appeal Panel.

- .1 Each Zone shall establish a Zone Sanction Appeal Panel.
 - A Each Zone shall designate a group of coaches, referees and athletes available to serve on an Appeal Panel.
 - B A petitioner may file an appeal with the Senior Zone Director within five (5) days of receiving notification of denial by an LSC.
 - C When an appeal is filed, the Zone Director shall notify the LSC and appoint a panel made up of a coach, referee and athlete, each from a different LSC and none from the petitioner's LSC.
- .2 The Zone Sanction Appeal Panel is authorized to require an LSC to issue a sanction or approval except in those instances where the sanction or approval was denied because the application was in conflict with a policy adopted by the LSC House of Delegates or because the application was in conflict with USA Swimming rules or requirements.
- .3 The Zone Sanction Appeal Panel's decision shall be final.

202.4 REQUIREMENTS FOR SANCTION — Sanctions are issued, withheld or withdrawn in accordance with the following regulations:

- .1 Sanctions may be issued only to USA Swimming group members or LSCs and their subdivisions.
- .2 No sanction for domestic competition will be issued to any organization or person whose interest in swimming competition is purely commercial, or where the event is to be promoted solely for the profit or the advertising value to be derived therefrom. Any income derived from sanctioned events must be used for the further promotion of swimming, for an approved charity, or for the general welfare of the promoting organization as a whole.
- .3 Sanctions issued to one organization cannot be transferred to another. Any sanction so transferred shall be void for all purposes, and the LSC is empowered to deny further sanctions to any organization violating this provision.
- .4 No further sanction shall be given to any organization which has failed to satisfy expense obligations to athletes or to award prizes as stated in its meet announcement until the obligations are satisfied or the prizes awarded.
- .5 No sanction will be granted for any event for which the word "Olympic," the word "Paralympic" or any derivative thereof, is used in any manner in connection with said event unless consent is obtained from USA Swimming.
- .6 No sanction shall be granted where unattached status is used as a basis by which a host club or LSC prohibits participation. However, a host club or LSC may require unattached swimmers to arrange for their own coach supervision before allowing them to participate.
- .7 Applicants for sanction of an open water competition shall complete the application provided by USA Swimming.
- .8 The Host Committee of an open water competition shall develop a safety plan for the competition in compliance with all requirements included in the published application for sanction of an open water event.

- .9 All sanctions must be signed by a designated member of the LSC, and a record thereof must be retained.
- .10 The following clause will appear on all sanction application forms and on all forms upon which official sanctions are granted: "In granting this sanction it is understood and agreed that USA Swimming shall be free from any liabilities or claims for damages arising by reason of injuries to anyone during the conduct of the event."
- .11 Application for sanction must be accompanied by a copy of the complete meet announcement which must include the following:
 - A A statement of the nature of prizes to be awarded.
 - B A complete schedule of lanes and times for all warm-up procedures which must be adhered to by all participants.
 - C Information about water depth measured for a distance of 3 feet 3-1/2 inches (1.0 meter) to 16 feet 5 inches (5.0 meters) from both end walls.
 - D The following statement: "Any swimmer entered in the meet must be certified by a USA Swimming member-coach as being proficient in performing a racing start or must start each race from within the water without the use of the backstroke ledge. When unaccompanied by a member-coach, it is the responsibility of the swimmer or the swimmer's legal guardian to ensure compliance with this requirement."
 - E A statement that no swimmer will be permitted to compete unless the swimmer is a member as provided in Article 302.
 - F A statement indicating whether on-deck registration will be permitted and under what conditions.
 - G A statement indicating that the host will ensure the required course dimensions.
 - H The following statement: "Use of audio or visual recording devices, including a cell phone, is not permitted in changing areas, restrooms or locker rooms."
 - I The following statement: "Deck changes are prohibited."
 - J The following statement: "Operation of a drone, or any other flying apparatus, is prohibited over the venue (pools, athlete/coach areas, spectator areas and open-ceiling locker rooms) any time athletes, coaches, officials and/or spectators are present."
Exceptions may be granted with prior written approval by the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee).
 - K The following statement: "Held under the sanction of USA Swimming."
 - L The following statement: "It is understood and agreed that USA Swimming shall be free from any liabilities or claims for damages arising by reason of injuries to anyone during the conduct of the event."
 - M The following statement: "All adults participating in or associated with this meet acknowledge that they are subject to the provisions of the USA Swimming Minor Athlete Abuse Prevention Policy ("MAAPP"), and that they understand that compliance with MAAPP is a condition of participation in the conduct of this competition."
 - N A description of the medical supervision (e.g., lifeguards, EMT, AED device, etc.) available to athletes participating in the meet.

- O For open water competitions, the policy for abandonment, the race timeline, the course map, and a statement whether the race will be an “escorted” or “unescorted” event.
- .12 The issuing LSC shall receive the following information regarding finances from every organization receiving a sanction except for events sponsored by USA Swimming:
 - A The LSC shall require the organization to which a sanction has been granted to file, within 45 days after the event, a financial statement setting forth all receipts and disbursements in connection with the sanctioned event.
 - B The LSC may at any time require the organization to furnish, within 15 days after written request, all receipts and vouchers relating to the sanctioned event.
 - C No sanction to hold any athletic event of any kind shall thereafter be issued to an organization who has failed or refused to file with the LSC any statement or affidavit required under any subdivision of this section, until the statement or affidavit is filed, or until such time as the LSC may determine.
- .13 Sanction fees shall be established by the LSC, except those for national and international meets which shall be established by the President/CEO.
- .14 For the sole purpose of improving competitive swimming, and with the written approval of the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee, USA Swimming or an LSC may sanction events or meets for which waivers of specific provisions of Parts One, Two, or Seven of USA Swimming Rules & Regulations have been granted for limited periods and under specified conditions.
- .15 LSCs may develop special administrative standards and conditions to encourage athletes with disabilities to participate in their meets. Such conditions shall be included in the meet announcement.
- .16 If an event is to be contested in more than one LSC’s or country’s jurisdiction, the application for sanction shall be submitted to the LSC in which the event begins. The sanctioning LSC shall notify the other LSC(s) and/or the governing body of the other country in which the event is being contested of details of the event.

202.5 CONDITIONS OF SANCTION — Any event for which a sanction is required according to 202.1 is subject to the following conditions:

- .1 No swimmer who is not a member as provided in Article 302 will be allowed to compete or participate except as provided under 202.9 or USA Swimming’s “open border” policy included in the Operating Policy Manual.
- .2 Any individual who is banned, currently suspended or ineligible for membership is prohibited from serving as a timer, marshal, or computer operator, or otherwise being on deck at any time in connection with a USA Swimming activity.
- .3 At a sanctioned competitive event, USA Swimming athlete members must be under the supervision of a USA Swimming member coach during warm-up, competition, and warm-down. The Meet Director or Meet Referee may assist the swimmer in making arrangements for such supervision, but it is the swimmer’s responsibility to make such arrangements prior to the start of the meet.
- .4 Swimmers participating under the provisions of 202.9 or USA Swimming’s “open border” policy must be under the supervision of their own coach or a USA Swimming member coach. The Meet Director or Meet Referee may assist the swimmer in making arrangements

for such supervision, but it is the swimmer's responsibility to make such arrangements prior to the start of the meet.

- .5 All referees, starters, administrative officials, chief judges and stroke and turn judges, serving in an official capacity in a sanctioned event, must be non-athlete members of USA Swimming or members of other World Aquatics-member organizations. All meet directors for meets sanctioned by USA Swimming must be members of USA Swimming. Except for coaches accompanying athletes participating under the provisions of 202.9 or USA Swimming's "open border" policy, all persons acting in any coaching capacity in a sanctioned event must be coach members of USA Swimming.
- .6 The membership (registration) number of each swimmer must be presented prior to or at the time of the event, and his/her affiliation must be printed before or after his/her name on the program.
- .7 The official mobile application of USA Swimming is acceptable proof of USA Swimming membership.
- .8 Entry blanks, advertising and the program must bear conspicuously the statement: "Held under the sanction of USA Swimming."
- .9 Conduct of the sanctioned event shall conform in every respect to all technical and administrative rules of USA Swimming.
- .10 Warm-up procedures and schedule must be posted throughout the pool area, announced on a regular basis before and during warm-up, and are to be monitored jointly by the Meet Director and the Meet Referee or their designees.

202.6 REQUIREMENTS FOR APPROVAL — Approval of competition may be issued, withheld or withdrawn by an LSC in accordance with the following regulations:

- .1 Approvals may be issued to non-member clubs/organizations for meets conducted in accordance with USA Swimming technical rules.
- .2 Applicants for approval of an open water competition shall complete the application provided by USA Swimming.
- .3 Approvals may be issued to member clubs for closed competition (such as YMCAs) conducted in accordance with USA Swimming technical rules.
- .4 Approvals may be issued to member clubs or to LSCs for open competition conducted in accordance with USA Swimming technical rules if that competition has been specifically approved by the Registration/Membership Committee staff leader (or his/her designee).
- .5 Both USA Swimming athlete members and non-USA Swimming athlete participants may compete in an approved meet.
- .6 Written application for approval shall be made not later than the period established by the LSC prior to the competition. The LSC may establish a fee for processing such applications. Application for approval shall be accompanied by the meet announcement which shall include the following:
 - A A statement of the nature of prizes to be awarded.
 - B Information about water depth measured for a distance of 3 feet 3-1/2 inches (1.0 meter) to 16 feet 5 inches (5.0 meters) from both end walls.
 - C The following statement: "In granting this approval it is understood and agreed that USA Swimming shall be free and held harmless from any liabilities or claims for damages arising by reason of injuries to anyone during the conduct of the event."

202.6

- ## 2025 Rules & Regulations

- .13 No approval will be granted for any competition if the word "Olympic," "Paralympic," "World," "National," "United States of America" or any derivative thereof is used in any manner in connection with such competition unless consent for such usage is obtained from USA Swimming.
- .14 The following clause will appear on all approval application forms and on all forms upon which official approvals are granted: "In granting this approval it is understood and agreed that USA Swimming shall be free and held harmless from any liabilities or claims for damages arising by reason of injuries to anyone during the conduct of the event."
- .15 Complete meet results shall be submitted to the LSC within a period of time established by the LSC.
- .16 All approvals must be signed by an authorized representative of the LSC and a record thereof kept by the LSC.
- .17 Approval may be withheld or withdrawn by the LSC if the competition was not conducted in accordance with the above requirements.
- .18 If an event is to be contested in more than one LSC's or country's jurisdiction, the application for approval shall be submitted to the LSC in which the event begins. The LSC granting the approval shall notify the other LSC(s) and/or the governing body of the other country in which the event is being contested of details of the event.

202.7 REQUIREMENTS FOR NCAA MEETS

- .1 Times for individual and relay events achieved in NCAA bona fide competition, as defined in the current NCAA Rules, shall be regarded as approved times for USA Swimming purposes.
- .2 Competition results are to be uploaded directly into SWIMS within 72 hours after the meet has ended.

202.8 REQUIREMENTS FOR OBSERVED SWIMS — Swims may be observed by assigned USA Swimming or YMCA officials for conformance with USA Swimming technical rules in a meet conducted under other than USA Swimming rules (NFHS, USMS, USOPC). Official times achieved as observed swims may be submitted for entry into the SWIMS database if all of the following conditions are met:

- .1 The meet must be a season-culminating Championship, e.g., League, Conference, District, Sectional, State, Regional, and be submitted on Local Swim Committee – Form B to the LSC National Times Verification Officer at least 10 days prior to the meet. A time trial held in conjunction with the season-culminating championship meet that is officiated in accordance with the same standard as the championship meet may also be observed if it is authorized by the host association.
- .2 Requests for observers for certification of times from meets not in the championship progression (such as invitationals for 3 or more teams) must be made on Local Swim Committee – Form A in accordance with LSC procedures at least 10 days prior to the meet. A list of all LSC observed meets for the current swim year shall be posted on the LSC website.
- .3 An observer must verify that all swims approved for USA Swimming purposes were in accordance with the following requirements:

202.8

- A Minimum of one referee, one starter and two stroke and turn judge association officials working season-culminating championship meets and invitationals;
 - B 102.23 (Timing Rules);
 - C 103.3 (Racing Course Dimensions); and
 - D 103.14 (Starting Platforms).
- .4 Where the technical rules of the stroke differ from USA Swimming as defined in Article 101, at least two observers from USA Swimming and/or the YMCA, who shall be certified Stroke & Turn Judges assigned or approved by the LSC, must be on deck and in position to observe the strokes where the rules differ, in order to verify compliance of the swim or swims with that part of the USA Swimming rule that differs from the organization's rule. Where the technical rules as listed in Article 101 are identical to those of the organization under whose rules the meet is being conducted, the judgment of the organization officials shall be sufficient. Times for USA Swimming members in good standing at the time of the meet should be entered, upon request, into SWIMS, the National Times Database.

202.9 INTERNATIONAL EVENTS

.1 Within the United States

- A Sanctions for competitions within the United States that will include swimmers with a foreign sport nationality as defined by World Aquatics rule GR2.5, who will be competing representing their sport nationality or other World Aquatics Continental Organization, must be reported to the USA Swimming national office. All invitations to foreign swimmers to compete in the United States must be extended by USA Swimming.
- B Any international swimming competition within the United States as defined in the Amateur Sports Act which is sponsored by a sports organization or person other than USA Swimming must be sanctioned by USA Swimming's national office and such sanction must be granted unless there is clear and convincing evidence that holding or sponsoring the event would be detrimental to the best interest of swimming.
 - (1) Factors to be considered in the determination of whether sponsoring the event would be detrimental to the best interest of swimming shall include, but not be limited to, the following:
 - (a) Review of audited or notarized financial reports of similar events, if any, conducted by the organization or person, including:
 - (i) Financial guarantees of athlete expenses, both U.S. and foreign;
 - (ii) Financial guarantees of any appearance money or prize money for athletes; and
 - (iii) Financial guarantees of acceptable accommodations and travel for athletes.
 - (b) Absence of substantial conflict with: (i) USA Swimming National Team programs, (ii) major USA Swimming competitions, (iii) major international swimming competitions such as the Olympic Games, World Championships, Pan Pacific Championships, Pan American Games and World University Games and (iv) World Aquatics rules and events.

- (2) Upon determination by clear and convincing evidence that sponsoring the event would not be detrimental to the best interest of swimming, the sanction will be issued by USA Swimming upon full compliance by the organization with all the requirements of the Act, as it may be amended from time to time.
 - C Sanction fees for international events established by the Board of Directors of USA Swimming shall be paid to USA Swimming prior to the issuance of a sanction.
- 2 Outside the United States**
- A All invitations for individual swimmers to compete abroad must be extended by the recognized World Aquatics member of the inviting country through USA Swimming.
 - B All invitations for individual swimmers or teams who are members of USA Swimming must be through USA Swimming and in compliance with procedures established by the National Team Steering Committee.
 - C Approval for teams sponsored by a sports organization or person other than USA Swimming is the responsibility of USA Swimming and must be granted unless there is clear and convincing evidence that holding or sponsoring the event would be detrimental to the best interest of swimming. USA Swimming shall advise any such organization or person requesting such foreign travel of the requirements for approval in accordance with Federal Law and the USOPC Constitution.
- 3** No team, individual or organization competing inside or outside the United States may use the letters "U.S.A.," or any other designation that may indicate it as a team or individual representing the United States, on uniforms or competitive equipment or in any other manner, without the express written approval of USA Swimming issued through the office of the President/CEO. (See World Aquatics GR2.4)

202.10 SWIM-A-THONS — All Swim-a-thon events are held under the license of the USA Swimming Foundation and must conform to rules and regulations established by USA Swimming. The participants may or may not be members of USA Swimming. Each LSC is responsible for the monitoring of each Swim-a-thon event held within its geographical boundaries, including the taking of that action pursuant to the provisions of Policy 26.0 of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual as may be necessary to discipline any violation of USA Swimming Rules & Regulations.

ARTICLE 203

REPRESENTATION

203.1 In order for a swimmer to compete in USA Swimming competition as a representative of a club or educational institution, that organization must be a member in good standing of the LSC and USA Swimming or of World Aquatics.

203.2 A swimmer need not reside within the geographical boundaries of the LSC in which the USA Swimming club he/she represents is located, but he/she must be registered in that LSC; a swimmer who has been released by his/her club pursuant to 203.4 to represent a secondary school, college or university, wherever located, during the school season, may retain membership in the LSC in which the swimmer's club is located.

203.3 For a swimmer to represent a USA Swimming club in a competitive event, sixty (60) consecutive days must have elapsed before the swimmer is permitted to represent any other

203.3

USA Swimming club in USA Swimming open competition. The 60-day count shall begin on the day following the last date the athlete represented a USA Swimming club in open competition.

203.4 A swimmer registered with a USA Swimming non-school club who wishes to compete for a secondary school, college or university shall be automatically released without notice by his/her club upon commencement of his/her season to compete for that school in school competition, and upon termination of such school swimming season he/she shall be immediately eligible to represent the same USA Swimming non-school club. Should the swimmer choose to represent a different USA Swimming non-school club, the swimmer is subject to 203.3. It is the swimmer's responsibility to ascertain his/her compliance with scholastic governing bodies' rules and regulations.

203.5 When transferring between LSCs or clubs within the same LSC, the swimmer shall submit a completed transfer request in accordance with USA Swimming/LSC procedures. LSCs may not establish procedures for transfers which effectively deny a swimmer the right to transfer from one LSC or club to another.

203.6 If a member club of an LSC has secured a court judgment against an athlete member (or his/her parents or custodians) for non-payment of club membership dues and fees, that athlete shall be ineligible to represent any USA Swimming member club until the judgment is paid.

203.7 An unattached competitor is a registered swimmer who represents no club, educational institution or other organization.

203.8 All applications for changes of registration must be accompanied by a reasonable fee to be determined by the local registration committee in the LSC in which the swimmer will be registered after the change of registration.

203.9

- .1 A swimmer who is a member of another Federation may compete in USA Swimming sanctioned competition with written permission of his/her Federation to do so. Except as provided in 207.9.7 and the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual, the swimmer may swim for a USA Swimming club or team with the consent of the swimmer's Federation, in which event the swimmer shall remain a member of the swimmer's Federation, under its control and supervision. The swimmer shall register with USA Swimming, and be subject to the Rules & Regulations of USA Swimming (including specifically Article 303 of the Rules & Regulations).
- .2 A swimmer who has competed for an organization within a foreign federation must provide official documentation from that federation confirming his/her last day representing that organization in competition. Sixty (60) consecutive days must elapse after a swimmer represents any organization before he/she can represent a USA Swimming club. If documentation is not provided at the time of registration, the sixty (60) days will commence from the date of registration. Foreign swimmers who are competing for a secondary school, college or university shall be automatically released, in accordance with 203.4.

ARTICLE 204

SENIOR PROGRAM

204.1 OBJECTIVES — Senior Swimming is the program through which USA Swimming provides fair and open competition for its members who are striving to qualify for participation in National Swimming Championships. It is designed to afford maximum opportunity for participation, provide an educational experience, enhance physical and mental conditioning, and develop a pool of talented swimmers for international competition.

Achievement of these goals will be accomplished by drawing upon and cooperating with all agencies conducting organized swimming programs, by encouraging maximum participation by coaches, parents, officials and community groups; and by conducting a motivational entity in the form of an outstanding National Championship program, to include the recognition of achievement in all facets of the program — swimmers, coaches, officials and support staff.

204.2 ELIGIBILITY — All registered swimmers are eligible for the Senior Class.

204.3 EVENTS AND PROGRAMS — Senior events and programs shall be those listed in 102.1.1.

204.4 DUAL MEETS — Dual meets are encouraged between clubs and LSCs. Suggested events in senior dual meets:

50, 100, 200, 400/500 freestyle; 100, 200 backstroke; 100, 200 breaststroke; 100, 200 butterfly; 200, 400 IM; 400 medley relay; 400 freestyle relay.

204.5 ENTRY FEES — Entry fees in senior competition shall be determined by the LSC.

204.6 AWARDS — Meet hosts and swimmers should be aware that high school or college eligibility may be affected by prize cost or value.

204.7 LSC SENIOR CHAMPIONSHIP MEET — LSC Senior Championship meets should be conducted by each LSC. Such meets should be conducted both short course and long course, where such facilities are available, and shall conform to the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations.

204.8 REGIONAL MEETS — The LSCs may make arrangements to compete on a regional basis.

204.9 SECTIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS

- .1 Each Zone shall designate its Sections.
- .2 The Senior Development Committee will set nationwide time standards for Sectionals. Individual Sections may have standards that are slower than these standards, but not faster.
- .3 The goal size for the Sectional meet is 700 athletes. If 800 or more athletes enter a given meet, the Section shall either (a) tighten the time standards (but not faster than the maximum standards established by the Senior Development Committee), or (b) split the meet into two meets for the following year. For meets held in two courses, the goal size of the meet is 800 athletes. If 900 or more athletes enter a given meet, the Section shall either (a) tighten the time standards (but not faster than the maximum standards established by the Senior Development Committee), or (b) limit the out-of-section athletes (this number should be equal to the difference between the entry cap and the number of swimmers entered by in-section teams), or (c) split the meet into two meets for the following year.

204.9

- .4 Sectional meets shall use Online Meet Entry, via USA Swimming. The number of Sectional meets in each Zone is determined by the number of athletes that entered Sectional meets via Online Meet Entry for the meet the previous year.
- .5 USA Swimming shall provide a bid form, financial and operating agreements and all other documents related to the responsibilities of the meet host and conduct of the event. Each Section shall notify the Zone Directors of bid winners for the following year's meets by the close of the annual meeting of USA Swimming's House of Delegates.
- .6 There shall be at least two (2) Spring and one (1) Summer Sectional meets in each Zone.
 - A Summer Sectional
 - (1) The Summer Sectional shall be a Long Course meet.
 - (2) The Summer Sectional meet shall be no more than four (4) days long, and shall conclude at least eight (8) days prior to the U.S. Open or Junior Nationals, whichever comes first.
 - (3) The Summer Sectional meet shall have at least one 18-and-under final heat per individual event.
 - B Spring Sectional
 - (1) The Spring Sectional meet should be no more than 3 1/2 days long. The dates may vary according to the needs of each Zone.
 - (2) The Spring Sectional meet shall have at least one 18-and-under final heat per individual event.
- .7 There shall be not more than sixteen (16) Spring and sixteen (16) Summer meets.
- .8 Sectional Championship dates and sites shall be selected by the Sections and approved by the respective Zone Directors.
- .9 The meet format shall be determined by the Section in accordance with the requirements listed here.
- .10 Sectional Championships shall be scored.

204.10 USA SWIMMING FUTURES CHAMPIONSHIPS — The USA Swimming Futures Championships shall be governed and conducted by USA Swimming.

- .1 The Futures Championships will be swum long course during the summer season. The dates, place of competition and number of competitions to be held will be determined by the Senior Development Committee based on the recommendations of USA Swimming's National Events staff.
- .2 LSCs will be assigned to a specific Futures meet based upon the recommendation from the Senior Development Committee.

ARTICLE 205 AGE GROUP PROGRAM

205.1 AGE GROUP SWIMMING OBJECTIVES — Age Group swimming is the program through which USA Swimming provides fair and open competition for its registered swimmers ages 18 years and younger. It is designed to encourage maximum participation, provide an educational experience, enhance physical and mental conditioning, and develop a rich base of swimming talent.

Achievement of these goals will be enhanced by an environment which encourages participation by the maximum number of competitors, coaches, qualified officials, parents, and school and community groups. By providing recognition for all participants, a healthy motivation for self-improvement and advancement is attained.

205.2 ELIGIBILITY

- .1 Eligibility to compete in a particular age group shall be determined by the swimmer's date (not hour) of birth.
- .2 Age on the first day of the meet shall determine the swimmer's age for the entire meet.
- .3 When an Age Group Meet is scheduled over two weekends the younger age groups must compete on the first weekend.
- .4 In the event a meet is postponed, the provisions in 102.7.4 apply.
- .5 A swimmer must compete in the age group events corresponding to the swimmer's age, except when competing in consolidated events (102.1.5), mixed classification meets (102.2.8), and in events combined by the Referee (102.7.2).
- .6 USA Swimming Group Members may establish their own age group eligibility requirements for seasonal closed competition. Times achieved in competition conducted under different age group eligibility rules shall be recognized as official USA Swimming times only if achieved in conformance with 205.2.1 and .2.

205.3 PROGRAM AND EVENTS

- .1 In order to promote maximum achievement and recognition, competition may be separated by age, gender and level of ability. Meets and/or events shall be structured by the LSC to assure fair competition.
 - A Age Group swimming competition shall be conducted in conformance with the USA Swimming Technical Rules.
 - B USA Swimming shall establish and publish national motivational times for the recognized events in 102.1.2.
 - C An LSC may establish its own age group time standards for use within its jurisdiction or may sanction competition without any entry time requirements.
 - D Only swimmers whose best times correspond to the event's time standard for their age shall be eligible to participate in the particular event.
 - E Age Group meets may be designated by ability classifications.
 - F With the exception of championship and open water meets, the program in all other age group competition shall be planned to allow the events for swimmers twelve (12) years and younger to be completed in four (4) hours or less per session (prelims, finals, timed finals). Events for the same 12 & under swimmers shall be limited to one session per day, except for prelim/final meets where events for 12 & under swimmers may be offered in both prelims and finals.
- .2 Programs for Age Group meets and/or those of mixed classification may be tailored to meet local requirements and conditions. Recommended events are those listed in 102.1.2. An LSC, at its option, may open its oldest Age Group at any competition to Post Age Group swimmers. Dual meets between clubs and LSCs are encouraged.

205.4

205.4 ENTRY FEES — Entry fees in Age Group swimming meets shall be determined by the LSC.

205.5 AWARDS — Official awards for Age Group events shall be established by the LSC. The cost per award to an individual shall not exceed \$25.00. However, meet hosts and swimmers should be aware that high school or college eligibility may be affected by prize cost or value.

205.6 ZONE AGE GROUP PROGRAM — Each zone must conduct at least one Zone Age Group Championship meet, recommended to be long course if only one is conducted.

- .1 The meet shall be restricted to age group competition.
- .2 Those events in 102.1.2 are recommended for use for zone meets. Each zone shall select their events from the list of events in 102.1.2. A zone, at its option, may open its oldest age group at any competition to Post Age Group swimmers, or may include events specifically for those swimmers.
- .3 Time standards or entry requirements shall be set for each zone meet in accordance with the needs of the swimmers of that zone by the zone committee.
- .4 **Eligibility:** Participation in the zone championship meets shall be restricted to registered swimmers of that zone.
- .5 **Awards:** Shall be provided at least 1st through 8th place, and any other as designated by the national sponsor if any.

205.7 ZONE SENIOR PROGRAM — Each Zone may offer at least one Zone Senior Championship meet, recommended to be long course if only one is conducted. The competition will be governed by the Zone.

205.8 LSC AGE GROUP CHAMPIONSHIP MEETS

- .1 LSC Age Group meets shall be in conformance with the contractual obligations of USA Swimming, including the time periods, format and number, sponsorship identification and publicity requirements that may be in effect at the time, and about which the LSC shall be notified.
- .2 Two meets shall be conducted annually, short course and long course where such facilities are available.
- .3 Age group championship meet events shall be selected from the recognized events in 102.1.2.
- .4 An LSC, at its option, may open its oldest age group to Post Age Group swimmers.
- .5 An LSC, at its option, may conduct Open Water Age Group Championships in accordance with Part Seven / Open Water Swimming.

205.9 NATIONAL AGE GROUP RECOGNITION PROGRAM

- .1 Times submitted for recognition shall be achieved in the recognized events in 102.1.2 and in accordance with 102.23.1C. USA Swimming recognized times from any USA Swimming Sanctioned or Approved competition, USA Swimming Observed Swims, or meets sanctioned by World Aquatics or World Aquatics members. Times loaded into SWIMS that are not recognized by USA Swimming cannot be used.
- .2 Meets must be conducted between September 1 of one calendar year and August 31 of the next calendar year.

- .3 If the times are achieved in a meet conducted in a continuous session overlapping the start of a reporting period, the last day of the meet shall be the last day of the reporting period for that meet.
- .4 LSCs may award Top-Ten certificates for both short course yard and long course meter events. The ages for individual events are 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, and 18. Relay age categories are 11-12, 13-14, and 15-18. Top-Ten certificates for LSCs will be made available on the USA Swimming website.
- .5 No club's relay team may be listed more than once, unless that club has an additional relay or relays comprised of four different swimmers. If the club has an additional relay entitled to listing with a change of one, two or three individual swimmers from a higher listed relay, those additional swimmers will be listed after the club's higher ranked team members.

205.10 SWIMWEAR IN AGE GROUP COMPETITION

- .1 For age group competitions, it is permissible for the swimmer to wear a single set of garments underneath his or her competition swimsuit for modesty and/or privacy reasons.

205.11 DEVELOPMENT COMPETITION PROGRAM

- .1 Development competitions are limited to athletes ages 12 and under offering events listed in 102.1.3.
- .2 Development competitions may operate as multi-day, multi-session meets. Sessions shall be planned to allow the events not to exceed two (2) hours in length. Athletes shall only participate in one session per sanctioned competition.
- .3 Development competitions may be offered at the discretion of the LSC, but are not required.

ARTICLE 206 AWARDING USA SWIMMING CHAMPIONSHIPS AND INTERNATIONAL COMPETITIONS

206.1 GENERAL — USA Swimming Championships shall be conducted annually.

- .1 The U.S. Open shall be conducted annually in November or December.
- .2 A long course National Championship meet shall be conducted every summer, except when there is a Trials Class meet in the summer and that Trials Class meet is not in accordance with 206.4.2 (at the traditional time at the end of summer).
- .3 USA Swimming Open Water Individual and Team Championships shall be held in the 10 kilometer distance.

206.2 FACILITIES

- .1 Facilities awarded USA Swimming Championships and International competition must meet the mandatory standards of Article 103 and shall have a separate warm-up pool. Facilities where competition to select USA Swimming National Teams for certain international competition is held shall also conform to the requirements stated in 103.21.3E.

206.2

- .2 Event hosts shall ensure the required course dimensions. For pools with a movable bulkhead, the facilities host shall, prior to each session of competition, examine the bulkhead and shall confirm to the Meet Referee that the bulkhead is stable, straight and properly positioned and anchored.
- .3 Open water venues must meet the mandatory standards of Article 702.

206.3 AWARD OF EVENTS

- .1 USA Swimming National Championships, Trials Class, U.S. Open, Open Water Championships and Disability Championships shall be contracted for by the President/CEO (or his/her designee) in accordance with Article 206 and Article 207, after approval by the Board of Directors.
- .2 The National Team Managing Director may elect not to conduct one or more USA Swimming Championships in any year upon approval by the Board of Directors.

206.4 DATES — Unless otherwise determined and announced by the National Team Managing Director at the previous year's annual meeting, the dates shall be as follows:

- .1 **U.S. Open** — To start in November or December, as decided by the National Team Managing Director in order to best conform to the international calendar.
- .2 **Summer National Championships** — To end no later than the second Saturday in August.
- .3 **Open Water Championships** — Each event to be scheduled annually by the President/CEO (or his/her designee) in conjunction with the National Team Steering Committee.

206.5 METHOD OF GRANTING AWARD

- .1 USA Swimming Championships and meets designated as national meets may be awarded to a USA Swimming member in good standing or to an organization approved by USA Swimming for the purpose of assuming full responsibility to conduct the USA Swimming Championship as agreed to in writing.
- .2 The award process shall be conducted by the President/CEO in accordance with the provisions of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual.

ARTICLE 207

USA SWIMMING CHAMPIONSHIPS

207.1 GENERAL — USA Swimming may conduct USA Swimming National Championships, Trials Class meets, U.S. Open Championships, and Open Water Championships. The designation of each of these championships shall include the name of the national sponsor, if any, for that meet. Additional sponsorship may be requested for the host club or the host LSCs provided the sponsorship is in accordance with the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual and approved in writing by the President/CEO (or his/her designee).

207.2 USA SWIMMING U.S. OPEN CHAMPIONSHIPS — The USA Swimming U.S. Open Championships shall be governed and conducted by USA Swimming. All USA Swimming member athletes who have achieved the qualifying time standards for one or more specific events are eligible to participate. The meet shall be conducted in years designated by the National Team Managing Director.

207.3 USA SWIMMING NATIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS AND OPEN WATER CHAMPIONSHIPS

— The USA Swimming National Championship meets and Open Water Championship meets shall be governed and conducted by USA Swimming. All USA Swimming member-athletes who have achieved the qualifying time standards for one or more specific events are eligible to participate.

If the following USA Swimming team selection trials are held in conjunction with the USA Swimming National Championships, only United States citizens eligible to represent the United States in international competition will be allowed to compete in the A (championship) finals from which team selections are chosen: Pan American Games Trials and Pan Pacific Championship Trials. Foreign swimmers may compete in all relays, but in individual preliminary events and consolation and bonus finals only. When the selection of more than one of the above teams necessitates picking swimmers from beyond eighth (8th) place in a specific event, this rule also applies to the consolation and bonus final(s) in that event. Finals will be seeded accordingly.

207.4 USA SWIMMING JUNIOR NATIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS AND JUNIOR NATIONAL OPEN WATER CHAMPIONSHIPS

— The USA Swimming Junior National Championships and Junior National Open Water Championships meets shall be governed and conducted by USA Swimming.

- .1 The Junior National Championships will be swum long course during the summer season and short course during the winter season. The dates and place of competition will be determined by the Senior Development Committee. The meets should be scheduled to be held after the summer National Championships and U.S. Open, respectively.
- .2 All USA Swimming athlete members eighteen (18) years of age and under who have met the qualifying time standard for a specific event are eligible to participate.
- .3 The Junior National Championships program will be determined annually by the Senior Development Committee.

207.5 TRIALS CLASS MEETS — Trials Class shall be the selection meets for United States teams for the World Championships and Olympic Games and may be held in conjunction with the USA Swimming National Championships. The Trials Class meets shall be governed by the National Team Managing Director and conducted by the Program & Events Coordinator. The event format will be established by the National Team Managing Director and may emulate the Olympic Games or World Championship program. The men's 800 meter freestyle and women's 1500 meter freestyle will be conducted if the Trials are held in conjunction with the National Championships. There shall be no relays or scoring in the Olympic Team Selection Meet. Touch pads shall conform to 103.21.3E. Only United States citizens eligible to represent the United States on the Olympic or World Championship teams may compete in these Trials.

207.6 QUALIFYING TIME STANDARDS

- .1 Other than Trials Class meets, the time standards shall be established by the Senior Development Committee in consultation with the National Team Managing Director. Time standards shall be designed to allow 900-1,000 swimmers in individual events at the U.S. Open and the National Championships.
- .2 The Senior Development Committee shall develop, ten (10) months in advance, the qualifying time standards for all National Championships/U.S. Open Championships, Junior National

Championships, and Future Championships. Once approved by the committee, time standards will be announced and made available to the membership. Qualifying time standards shall be specified in hundredths of a second, with nine one-hundredths being the constant.

207.7 PROOF OF ENTERED TIME — Procedures for obtaining proof of time shall conform to the current edition of the USA Swimming SWIMS Time Module Policy Manual. Official times achieved in accordance with the requirements of 102.23.1 may be used to enter the meet.

- .1 **Individual Events** — All individual entry times must be made during the correct qualifying period and must be proven prior to the scratch deadline for that event through the SWIMS database.
- .2 **Relay Events** — Times for each entered relay team must be submitted with the entry. This entered time must be proven prior to the scratch deadline for each entered relay team, in aggregate or as a team, through the SWIMS database. For the purpose of proving times, a club may name a swimmer on only one of its relay teams in each event. Once the relay team or teams have been proven, any swimmer listed by that organization on the entry form is eligible to compete on that relay team.

.3 **Responsibility Clause**

- A The coach, swimmer, or swimmer representative who enters a USA Swimming championship thereby attests that all times on the entry are true and correct achieved qualifying times for each event entered. He/she assumes all responsibility for false or incorrect times or times which are unacceptable under USA Swimming rules and shall be assessed a \$100 penalty payable to USA Swimming for each such time entered, unless absolved of the fine by the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) or Board of Review. Additional action or penalty may be taken or levied as deemed appropriate by USA Swimming.
- B Such penalty shall also be levied against any USA Swimming verification officer who knowingly entered such a false time(s) into the SWIMS database.
- C Appeal of fines are to be made to the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) and/or Board of Review. Any appeal of the decision of the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) shall be in accordance with the provisions of Policy 26.0 of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual, specifically the following sections: Pre-Hearing Matters, Hearing, Decision, Stay, and Delivery.

207.8 MEET ANNOUNCEMENT

- .1 The meet announcement shall be prepared under joint direction of the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee), the Meet Director, and the President/CEO (or his/her designee).
- .2 The meet announcement shall state qualifying times and procedures necessary for proof of entry times (See 207.6 and 207.7). For a USA Swimming Championship meet, the President/CEO (or his/her designee) may permit bonus events. For each qualifying time achieved in an individual event, additional bonus events may be allowed. Requirements for bonus events will be specified in the meet announcement.

207.9 ENTRIES

- .1 A swimmer and/or relay team will be officially entered when the entries are received by USA Swimming prior to the meet entry deadline. The method and procedure for submission of entries will be stated in the meet announcement.

- .2 An unattached swimmer shall be identified with the LSC in which the swimmer is registered.
- .3 In National Championships, a swimmer may enter and compete, except as provided in 102.2.2, in any number of individual events in which the qualifying time standards have been met.
- .4 Entry times for individual and relay events shall:
 - A Be the best competitive times of swimmers except as otherwise provided in this Article 207 or the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual.
 - B Be achieved in accordance with 102.23.1, Requirements for Official Time.
 - C Be submitted to hundredths of a second.
 - D Swimmers who have qualified for the Olympic Trials within the current quadrennium in a specific event may swim that event in all USA Swimming National Championships and U.S. Open events preceding the next Olympic Trials, even if they have not re-qualified for the USA Swimming National Championships or U.S. Open in that specific event.
- .5 Only swimmers and relay teams entered using the procedures stated in the meet announcement shall be eligible to compete. Submitted times may be updated up to the entry deadline. No corrections or changes of events entered or additional entries will be accepted after the entry deadline. Typographical or transcription errors which can be readily verified by entry data or National Times Database data may be corrected if attested to by the swimmer, coach, or the swimmer's representative prior to the scratch deadline.
- .6 The Program & Events Coordinator has the right to challenge any submitted time.
- .7 In order to score at USA Swimming National Championships, a swimmer must be eligible to represent the United States in international competition.
- .8 **Relay Entries**
 - A A club may enter no more than two relay teams in each relay event.
 - B Only swimmers entered in accordance with the meet announcement shall be eligible to compete for that organization in relay events.

207.10 PROGRAMS

- .1 **Time Trials** — At all USA Swimming National Championships and Trials Class meets, time trials will be conducted on a time-available basis for swimmers participating in the meet.
 - A A swimmer is limited to a maximum of two time trials during the course of the championships.
 - B At the USA Swimming National Championships and Trials Class meets, a swimmer must be entered in the meet with a proven time (individual event or relay) to be eligible to participate in the time trials.
 - C Entry fees for time trials shall be the same as those established for the corresponding National Championships.
- .2 **International Program** — At the discretion of the National Team Managing Director, the USA Swimming National Championships may be conducted in a format with the order of events simulating the World Championship or Olympic program. All relays shall be conducted on a timed finals basis with all heats swum in the finals session.

207.11 ADMINISTRATIVE CONDUCT OF USA SWIMMING CHAMPIONSHIPS — The administrative rules for the conduct of the National Championships and Open Water Championships are specified herein. Additional rules for Open Water Championships are listed in Article 704.

.1 General Meeting

- A A general meeting, chaired by the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee), shall be held at all USA Swimming championship meets prior to the first day's competition. The Meet Referee, all participating coaches, and representatives of each participating club are responsible for all information disseminated at the meeting.
- B Only business pertinent to the administrative conduct of that championship meet and its events may be considered and finalized at this meeting by a vote of those in attendance and no changes shall be made thereafter.
- C It is the obligation of every swimmer entered in the meet to attend or be represented at this meeting and to become acquainted with the changes, if any, and the decisions made at this meeting.

.2 Schedule

- A Except as otherwise stated in the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual, a minimum of two (2) hours must elapse between the end of the last preliminary heat and the start of the first race in the finals on any one day, during which time the pool must be available for warm-up. Starting times for the preliminary and finals sessions shall be published in the meet announcement and reviewed at the general meeting. Starting times shall be as consistent as possible throughout the meet. At the general meeting, a schedule shall be made available for the first day's competition, including starting times for the first race in each preliminary event and for each race in the finals. Each day a schedule shall be made available for the following day's competition including all the same information. No event shall start prior to the time established for that event or race.
- B At the discretion of the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee), the preliminary sessions may be conducted in two courses.

.3 Warm-up Schedule — A schedule of lanes, times and warm-up procedures which must be adhered to shall be established and must be distributed during the general meeting.

.4 Eligibility Protests

- A An Eligibility Jury composed of three persons in attendance at each National Championships shall be appointed by the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) prior to the start of the meet to consider protests pertaining to the eligibility of any swimmer to compete or to represent an organization. The Eligibility Jury shall consist of a swimmer, a coach and an official.
- B All protests made prior to or during the championships shall be submitted to the Eligibility Jury on a form prescribed by USA Swimming and accompanied by a \$50 fee, which shall be returned if the protest is upheld. The \$50 fee shall not be required for protests submitted by the Registration Committee or LSC Registration Chair.
- C Protests shall be heard by the jury and, if possible, decisions rendered before the start of events on the day in which the protested swimmer competes, but not later than the

last night of the championships. The opportunity to be heard shall be given to both the party lodging the protest and the party or parties charged.

- D Until the Eligibility Jury renders a decision, the swimmer may compete under protest. An announcement to this effect shall be made prior to the race. The results of any race conducted under protest shall not be announced, nor prizes awarded, nor points scored until the jury has determined if and how their decision may affect the final scoring or awards.
- E The decision of the jury may be appealed by either party to the National Board of Review, pursuant to Policy 26.0 of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual. Protests submitted after the last day of the championships shall be submitted directly to the National Board of Review.
- F Any such decision of the National Board of Review shall be published on the USA Swimming website.

- .5 **Technical Rules Protests** — Prior to the start of the meet the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) shall appoint a Technical Jury composed of at least one swimmer representative, at least one coach, and at least one, but not more than three other persons. Written protests involving technical rules, except disqualifications due to judgment decisions by the deck officials, shall be made to the Meet Referee within thirty (30) minutes of the protested act or occurrence. Decisions of the Meet Referee regarding these protests may be appealed to the Technical Jury, whose decision must be made the day of the protest and shall be final.

The jury cannot adjudicate judgment decisions, which can only be considered by the Referee under 102.11.

.6 **Scratch Procedures**

- A Swimmers may scratch from an event in which they are entered by following the procedures set forth in the meet announcement.
- B The scratch deadline for the first day's events shall be fifteen (15) minutes after the general meeting is adjourned. The scratch deadline for all subsequent days' events shall be thirty (30) minutes after the time established for the start of the finals sessions.
- C In all events where preliminary heats are necessary or in any timed final event for which the swimmer has been positively checked in, after the heats have been seeded, any swimmer who fails to compete in an individual event heat in which such swimmer entered and has not been scratched in accordance with sub-paragraphs A and B above will be barred from all further individual and relay events of that day. The application of this penalty shall pertain to the order in which the event/heats are swum, not the numerical order of the events. Additionally, that swimmer shall not be seeded in any individual events on succeeding days unless that swimmer declares an intent to swim prior to the close of the scratch box for that day's events.
- D **Scratching from finals:**
 - (1) Any swimmer qualifying for a bonus, consolation or championship final in an individual event who fails to compete in said final shall be barred from further competition for the remainder of the meet, except as noted in paragraph E. A declared

false start under 101.1.3E or deliberate delay of meet under 101.1.5 is not permitted and will be regarded as a failure to compete.

- (2) In the event of withdrawal or barring of a swimmer from competition the Referee shall fill the bonus, consolation or championship final, when possible, with the next qualified swimmer(s). First and second alternates shall be announced along with the final qualifiers. These alternates shall not be penalized if unavailable to compete in the finals.
 - (3) Where bonus and consolation finals have not been swum and a barring or withdrawal is known to the Referee, the Referee shall reseed the bonus, consolation and championship final, if necessary, to insert the alternate(s) in the appropriate lane(s), filling all lanes in the final.
 - (4) If the bonus and consolation finals have already been contested, the championship final shall be swum without reseeding for the empty lane(s).
- E Exceptions for failure to compete** — No penalty shall apply for failure to withdraw or compete in an individual event if:
- (1) The Referee is notified in the event of illness or injury and accepts the proof thereof.
 - (2) A swimmer qualifying for a bonus, consolation or championship final based upon the results of the preliminaries notifies the Referee within thirty (30) minutes after announcement of the qualifiers for that race that they may not intend to compete and further declares their final intentions within thirty (30) minutes following their last individual preliminary event.
 - (3) It is determined by the Referee that failure to compete is caused by circumstances beyond the control of the swimmer.
 - (4) The swimmer pays a re-entry fee for each preliminary event in which he or she failed to compete. The re-entry fee shall be established by the National Team Steering Committee and the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee) and published in the meet announcement.
- F** Notwithstanding the provisions of 207.11.6, the scratch procedures for a selection meet for the United States teams for the Olympic Games, the World Aquatics World Championships, the Pan Pacific Championships, the Pan American Games or the World University Games shall be established by the National Team Steering Committee and the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee).

.7 Seeding

- A** Swimmers in the 1000y/800m and 1650y/1500m freestyle must check in and confirm their intention to compete prior to the scratch deadline in order to be seeded. Seeded heat sheets shall be published at the conclusion of the finals the evening before, except that in the five-day format, seeded heat sheets for the 800m freestyle shall be published two hours prior to the scheduled starting time for that event.
- B** Seeding individual events when using non-conforming and bonus times shall be as follows:
- (1) All conforming times will be arranged in time order.
 - (2) In a long course championship meet, non-conforming short course meter times

will be arranged in time order followed by non-conforming yard times; in a short course meet, non-conforming long course times shall precede non-conforming short course times.

- (3) Conforming bonus times, if permitted, will be arranged in time order after the times that meet the qualifying standards, in the precedence specified in (2) above.
 - (4) Non-conforming bonus times, if permitted, will be arranged in time order after the times that meet the qualifying standard and after conforming bonus times, in the precedence specified in (2) above.
 - (5) After arranging the times as provided above, the event will be seeded in normal fashion.
- .8 **Finals** — The order of final heats for each meet shall be approved by the Program & Events Coordinator (or his/her designee).
- .9 **Scoring** — Except for Trials Class meets, scoring at the USA Swimming National Championships shall be mandatory.
- A Foreign national teams entered in the National Championships will not be scored for team awards.
 - B Foreign swimmers may not score points for a USA Swimming team at the USA Swimming National Championships, but, subject to USA Swimming representation requirements, may represent that team and receive awards.
 - C Scoring at the USA Swimming National Championships will be on a sixteen (16) place basis. Individual events: 20, 17, 16, 15, 14, 13, 12, 11, 9, 7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1. When a 10-lane pool is used for finals at the National Championships, the scoring shall be on a twenty (20) place basis with the values for individual events as follows: 24, 21, 20, 19, 18, 17, 16, 15, 14, 13, 11, 9, 8, 7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1. Relay events receive double these point values.
 - D To be eligible for Combined Men's and Women's Team Awards, a team must have scored points in both the Men's Team and Women's Team Categories.

207.12 AWARDS

.1 Team Awards

Women's Team Champion	<i>(high point women's team)</i>
Women's Team Runner-up Champion	<i>(second highest)</i>
Women's Team Top Ten	<i>(third through tenth)</i>
Men's Team Champion	<i>(high point men's team)</i>
Men's Team Runner-up Champion	<i>(second highest)</i>
Men's Team Top Ten	<i>(third through tenth)</i>
Men's & Women's Team Champion	<i>(high combined points)</i>
Men's & Women's Runner-up Team Champion	<i>(second highest)</i>
Men's & Women's Combined Team Top Ten	<i>(third through tenth)</i>

USA Swimming National Championships only:

Combined Team Champion

.2 Individual and Relay Awards

- A Medals shall be awarded to all place winners in the A (championship) final and to the top eight (8) place winners in timed final events of any USA Swimming National Championships. When ten (10) lanes are used at a USA Swimming Championships, the top ten (10) place winners in timed final events will receive medals.
- B First-place medal to be awarded to the 18 & under swimmer placing highest in each individual event at each USA Swimming National Championships. If no 18 & under swimmer scores in the A, B, or C finals, the highest placing 18 & under swimmer from preliminaries will be recognized as the National 18 & under champion for that event.
- C In each USA Swimming National Championships, the Robert J. Kiphuth High Point Award shall be awarded to the man and woman swimmer scoring the greatest number of points in individual events.
- D The Phillips 66 Performance of the Meet Award shall be presented at each USA Swimming National Championships. The recipient of this award shall be chosen by representatives of the media who are present at the meet.

APPENDIX 2

2025 CHAMPIONSHIP MEET SITES AND DATES

Open Water Nationals

April 4-6

Sarasota, Florida

National Championships

June 3-7

Indianapolis, Indiana

Speedo Junior National Championships

July 30 – August 3

Irvine, California

Toyota U.S. Open

December 3-6

Austin, Texas

Speedo Winter Junior Championships East & West

December 10-13

TBD

2

PART THREE

RIGHTS, PRIVILEGES, CODE OF CONDUCT

ARTICLE 301 MEMBER RIGHTS

3

301.1 Except as provided in 301.2, no individual or organizational member of USA Swimming, nor any organization affiliated with USA Swimming, may deny or threaten to deny any eligible swimmer, coach, trainer, manager, official or administrator the opportunity to participate in any international swimming competition approved by USA Swimming, if selected by USA Swimming or one of its members. In addition, except as provided in 301.2, no individual or organizational member of USA Swimming, nor any organization affiliated with USA Swimming, may censor or otherwise penalize subsequent to the event any swimmer, coach, trainer, manager, official or administrator for having participated in any such international swimming competition approved by USA Swimming.

301.2 An educational institution which a swimmer is attending at the time of such international competition may deny the swimmer the opportunity to participate only if said educational institution reasonably determines that such participation would either:

- .1 Prevent the swimmer from meeting the academic requirements which are applicable to all students who participate in the swimmer's particular course of study.
- .2 Jeopardize the swimmer's or the educational institution's performance in the established program in the particular sport in which the swimmer competes, provided that the international competition occurs during the scheduled competitive season of the educational institution.

301.3 Any swimmer, coach, trainer, manager, official or administrator who alleges that he or she has been denied or is about to be denied, by a person or an organization affiliated with USA Swimming, a right as set forth in 301.1, shall immediately inform the President/CEO, who shall promptly cause an investigation to be made and steps to be taken to settle the controversy without unnecessary delay. Such steps shall include, but shall not be limited to, advising the Secretary General of the U.S. Olympic & Paralympic Committee, and submitting the matter for binding arbitration with an arbitral organization designated by the USOPC.

301.4 Whenever a swimmer, or party acting on a swimmer's behalf, informs the President/CEO of an alleged violation of the swimmer's right to participation as set forth in 301.1, the President/CEO (or his/her designee) shall review all the related evidence of the case and make a report, with a preliminary recommendation, to the National Board of Review within thirty (30) days, or sooner if the situation requires. The Board of Review shall review the case and the preliminary recommendation of the President/CEO (or his/her designee) and take whatever action it deems appropriate. Any of the parties involved in the action who are dissatisfied with the decision of the National Board of Review may appeal said decision under the provisions of Policy 26.0 of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual, specifically the section entitled "Appeal."

ARTICLE 302

ATHLETE REGISTRATION

302.1 REGISTRATION

1. **Athlete Members** — All swimmers practicing with a member club or competing in events sanctioned by USA Swimming must be registered as athlete members of USA Swimming. Athlete members must meet the rules of eligibility contained in Article 303. No swimmer alleged to be ineligible shall be denied the right to register and compete without being afforded the opportunity to refute the allegations relating to possible ineligibility, pursuant to Policy 26.0 of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual.
2. **Competition Category** — At the time of membership registration, an athlete shall state a competition category of male or female for the purpose of athlete swimming eligibility, competition, selection and records. Any athlete wishing to change his or her competition category may apply to do so following the procedures outlined in the current USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual. An athlete's competition category shall be referred to as "gender" within the Rulebook.

302.2 APPLICATION/RENEWAL — Athlete membership applications and payment as set forth in Article 2.7 of the Corporate Bylaws shall be submitted to the Registration Chair of the LSC or USA Swimming. The Registration Chair may designate deputy registrars to accept applications on behalf of the Chair and forward for approval.

302.3 FALSE REGISTRATION — If a swimmer who is not properly registered with USA Swimming competes in a sanctioned competition, the host LSC may impose a fine of up to \$100.00 per event against the individual, member coach or member club submitting the entry.

ARTICLE 303

ELIGIBILITY

303.1 It shall be the responsibility of all USA Swimming members to comply with the rules and regulations of USA Swimming and the Rules, Constitution and Bureau decisions of World Aquatics, as well as to avoid acting in any manner which brings disrepute upon USA Swimming or upon the sport of swimming.

303.2 Except as provided for in 203.9, only athlete members of USA Swimming are eligible to compete.

303.3 As a member National Governing Body of the United States Olympic & Paralympic Committee (USOPC), and as a member Federation of World Aquatics, USA Swimming is obligated to adhere to the anti-doping rules of the USOPC and World Aquatics. In addition, USOPC Bylaw Chapter XXIII, Section 2(G) provides that, as a condition of membership in the USOPC, each National Governing Body shall comply with the procedures pertaining to drug testing and adjudication of related doping offenses of the independent anti-doping organization designated by the USOPC to conduct drug testing. The USOPC has designated the United States Anti-Doping Agency ("USADA") as that organization. The current anti-doping rules of the USOPC, World Aquatics and USADA are available at the offices of USA Swimming or online at the following websites:

WADA	www.wada-ama.org
World Aquatics	www.worldaquatics.com
USOPC	www.teamusa.org
USADA	www.usada.org

As a condition of membership in USA Swimming, it is the duty of each individual member, including athletes, athlete support personnel, and other persons, to comply with all anti-doping rules of the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA), World Aquatics, USOPC, and USADA, including the USOPC National Anti-Doping Policy, the USADA Protocol for Doping Policy, and all other policies and rules adopted by WADA, World Aquatics, the USOPC, and USADA. Athlete members agree to submit, without reservation or condition, to in-competition and out-of-competition doping controls conducted by either World Aquatics or USADA or their designees at any time and understand that the use of methods or substances prohibited by the applicable anti-doping rules make them subject to penalties including, but not limited to, disqualification and suspensions. If it is determined that an individual member may have committed a doping violation, the member agrees to submit to the results management authority and processes of USADA, including arbitration under the USADA Protocol, or to the results management authority of World Aquatics, if applicable or referred by USADA.

303.4 A swimmer shall cease to be eligible to compete in events conducted by USA Swimming or its LSCs, or by any World Aquatics Federation, while under suspension or if expelled by USA Swimming for violations of this Part Three.

303.5 No Individual Member or Group Member of USA Swimming shall coach, train or provide swimming-related advice or service to any swimmer who is serving a period of ineligibility or provisional suspension for an anti-doping rule violation. In accordance with policies and procedures in the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual, Coaches and Group Members are required to report any non-member of USA Swimming ranked in the top 100 in the world who participates in team activities.

303.6 If a swimmer is required to forfeit any medals, points or prizes earned at an event on account of an anti-doping rule violation, then any compensation paid by USA Swimming to the swimmer's coach(es) on account of that swimmer's result shall also be forfeited and shall be returned to USA Swimming.

303.7 A swimmer may be registered for USA Swimming and Masters Swimming at the same time. Membership in U.S. Masters Swimming does not imply or presume membership in USA Swimming.

303.8 A swimmer declared ineligible for any reason may be reinstated pursuant to the provisions of Policy 26.0 of the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual, specifically the section entitled "Authority of the NBOR".

ARTICLE 304 CODE OF CONDUCT

304.1 The mission of USA Swimming is to encourage participation and the pursuit of excellence in all aspects of swimming. USA Swimming grants the privilege of membership to individuals and organizations committed to that mission. The privilege of membership may, therefore, be withdrawn or denied by USA Swimming at any time where USA Swimming determines that a member or prospective member's conduct is inconsistent with the mission of the organization or the best interest of the sport and those who participate in it.

In order to assist all members to better serve the interests of those who participate in swimming, USA Swimming has adopted this Code of Conduct.

304.2 Any member, former member, or prospective member of USA Swimming is subject to the jurisdiction of the Board of Review. Any member, former member, or prospective member of USA Swimming may be denied membership, censured, placed on probation, suspended for a definite or indefinite period of time with or without terms of probation, fined or expelled from USA Swimming for life if such person violates the provisions of the USA Swimming Code of Conduct, set forth in 304.3, or aids, abets or encourages another person to violate any of the provisions of the USA Swimming Code of Conduct. USA Swimming shall initiate an investigation of any former member of USA Swimming when a report required under 306.1 is received.

304.3 The following shall be considered violations of the USA Swimming Code of Conduct:

Measures to be adjudicated by the USA Swimming National Board of Review

- .1 Violation of the right to compete provisions set forth in Article 301.
- .2 Discrimination in violation of the Amateur Sports Act which requires that USA Swimming must provide an equal opportunity to athletes, coaches, trainers, managers, administrators, and officials to participate in the sport of swimming. Athletes must be allowed to participate and compete to the fullest extent allowed by the Rules and Regulations. Discrimination against any member or participant on the basis of age, gender, race, ethnicity, culture, religion, national origin, sexual orientation, gender expression, gender identity, genetics, mental or physical disability, or any other status protected by federal, state or local law, where applicable, is prohibited.
- .3 Repeated violation of any of the Minor Athlete Abuse Prevention Policies [see page 91].
- .4 Any violation of the World Aquatics Rules on the Prevention of Manipulation of Competition as found in the current World Aquatics Manual, including (i) betting; (ii) manipulating competitions; (iii) corrupt conduct; (iv) misuse of inside information; (v) failure to report; and (vi) failure to cooperate.
- .5 The sale or distribution of illegal drugs or the illegal sale or distribution of any substance listed on World Aquatics' recognized list of banned substances.
- .6 The use of illegal drugs in the presence of an athlete, by a coach, official, trainer, or a person who, in the context of swimming, is in a position of authority over that athlete.
- .7 The providing of alcohol to an athlete by a coach, official, trainer, manager or any other person where the athlete is under the legal age allowed to consume or purchase alcohol in the state where the alcohol is provided.
- .8 The abuse of alcohol in the presence of an athlete under the age of eighteen (18), by a coach, official, trainer, or a person who, in the context of swimming, is in a position of authority over that athlete.
- .9 Any act of fraud, deception or dishonesty in connection with any USA Swimming-related activity.
- .10 Any non-consensual physical contact, obscene language or gesture, or other threatening language or conduct directed towards any meet official and which is related to any decision made by such official in connection with a USA Swimming sanctioned competition.
- .11 Action, other than through general advertising, by a coach, owner, officer, volunteer, representative, or employee of a swim club, or a USA Swimming or LSC employee, either through direct contact with an athlete or the encouragement of others, to recruit or other-

wise encourage an athlete who is already a member of a USA Swimming member swim club to leave that club, unless the acting party receives prior written approval to recruit or encourage the athlete to change affiliation from the designated club representative of the athlete's existing USA Swimming-member swim club or contact is initiated by the athlete, the athlete's parent or authorized representative. General advertising includes any information that is:

- A Distributed to an identifiable general population where there is a reasonable expectation that the majority of that population are not current members of USA Swimming; or
- B Placed in or on any item that is sold.

In the event of a violation of this section, a sanction may be imposed against any coach, owner, officer, volunteer, representative or employee of a swim club, or against any such club, or any combination thereof, as appropriate.

- .12 Any other material and intentional act, conduct or omission not provided for above, which is detrimental to USA Swimming, an LSC or the sport of swimming.

Measure to be adjudicated by the U.S. Anti-Doping Agency

- .13 Violation of the anti-doping provisions set forth in 303.3.

Measure to be adjudicated by the U.S. Center for SafeSport

- .14 Violation of the SafeSport Code. [See www.usaswimming.org/code]

ARTICLE 305

MINOR ATHLETE ABUSE PREVENTION POLICIES

305.1 Clubs shall establish their own action plans for implementing the Minor Athlete Abuse Prevention Policies.

305.2 Clubs shall establish their own anti-bullying policy. USA Swimming shall provide a model policy as an example, which shall serve as the default for any club that fails to establish its own policy. Club anti-bullying policies should be reviewed and agreed to annually by all athletes, parents, coaches and other non-athlete members of the club.

305.3 Clubs shall establish their own photography policy. USA Swimming shall provide a model policy as a template, which shall serve as the minimum policy for all clubs. Club photography policies shall be reviewed and agreed to annually by all athletes, parents, coaches and other non-athlete members of the club.

ARTICLE 306

CHILD ABUSE REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

306.1 Pursuant to federal law, it is every member's responsibility to immediately (i.e., within 24 hours) report any incident of child abuse, including physical or sexual abuse, to law enforcement and the U.S. Center for SafeSport. Reporting must occur when an individual has firsthand knowledge of misconduct or where specific and credible information has been received from a victim or

306.1

knowledgeable third party. A report to the U.S. Center for SafeSport may be made via telephone at 720-531-0340 or online at www.uscenterforsafesport.org/report-a-concern. Various state laws may also require reporting to law enforcement or to a designated child protection agency.

306.2 Filing a knowingly false allegation of child abuse and sexual misconduct is prohibited and may violate state criminal law and civil defamation laws. Any person making a knowingly false allegation of sexual misconduct shall be subject to disciplinary action by USA Swimming.

306.3 Neither civil nor criminal statutes of limitation apply to reports of cases of sexual abuse.

ARTICLE 307

PROHIBITIONS AGAINST RETALIATION FOR GOOD FAITH REPORTING OF ABUSE

307.1 No Member shall retaliate against any individual who has made a good faith report under 306.1 or 304.3.14.

307.2 For the purposes of 307.1, there shall be a rebuttable presumption that any adverse action regarding the employment, membership, or other material rights of an individual who has made a good faith report under 306.1 or 304.3.14 within 90 days of a report is retaliatory. An adverse action includes, without limitation: discharge or termination; demotion or reduction in compensation for services; or the removal of or from, or restrictions on, access to facilities, team activities or team membership privileges.

PART FOUR

HEARINGS AND APPEALS

ARTICLE 401

FULL FAITH AND CREDIT

401.1 DECISION FINAL — Except as otherwise provided in Article Nine of the Constitution of the United States Olympic & Paralympic Committee and in its Bylaws with respect to binding arbitration in disputes involving the rights of certain individuals to participate in competition, the final decision of the National Board of Review shall be final in all cases, subject to the right of appeal to the Board of Directors as provided in the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual.

401.2 ENFORCEMENT — Final decisions rendered by the National Board of Review and the U.S. Center for SafeSport shall, when applicable, be recognized and fully enforced in all Zones and LSCs of USA Swimming.

PART FIVE

MATTERS OF THE HOUSE OF DELEGATES

ARTICLE 501 OPERATING COMMITTEES AND COUNCILS

501.1 OPERATING COMMITTEES AND COUNCILS — The following committees and councils shall report to the President/CEO (or his/her designee):

.1 ATHLETES' ADVISORY COUNCIL

- A The USA Swimming Athletes' Advisory Council (AAC) shall consist of nine (9) voting members who meet the requirements of 10-Year Athlete representatives directly elected by athletes who meet the same standards as 10-Year Athletes. The voting members may include the USOPC AAC representative and the USOPC AAC alternate.
- B The Chair shall be elected from among the voting members of the AAC by its voting members.
- C The Athletes' Executive Committee (AEC) Chair shall serve as an ex-officio member with voice but no vote. Up to two (2) additional Actively Engaged Athlete Representatives may be appointed by the AAC Chair, in consultation with the AEC Chair, with voice but no vote.
- D Each AAC voting member shall serve a two (2) year term, staggered so that one-half (1/2) of such members are elected each year. There shall be no term limits, but voting members must be eligible to serve pursuant to the USOPC Bylaws at the time of election.
- E The AAC shall be responsible for: (i) reviewing the programs and services offered by the USA Swimming National Team division; (ii) evaluating and proposing rules and regulations that directly affect the National Team Athletes; (iii) addressing the specific needs of the National Team Athletes in preparation for major international events; (iv) evaluating and developing projects and conducting long term plans in all areas concerning National Team Athletes; (v) reporting to the members of the National Team Steering Committee and Open Water Steering Subcommittee any issues that warrant attention from those groups; and (vi) fulfilling its duties set forth in the USOPC Bylaws, including: selecting athlete representatives to serve on committees and defining sanctioned competition for purposes of athlete representative eligibility.

.2 COACH ADVISORY COUNCIL

- A The Coach Advisory Council (CAC) shall consist of eighteen (18) voting members comprised of the following:
 - (1) Twelve (12) coaches, with no less than three (3) from each gender, who are USA Swimming non-athlete coach members in good standing directly elected by USA Swimming non-athlete coach members in good standing. A minimum of one (1) individual from each zone's geographic area shall be maintained among the members who are elected under this provision; and

- (2) Six (6) 10-Year Athlete representatives and/or 10-Year+ Athlete representatives appointed by the AAC. At least 50% of the athletes must meet the requirements of 10-Year Athlete representatives.
- B The CAC non-athlete coach members shall be elected in accordance with the CAC Policy Manual.
- C The Chair, Vice-Chair, and Secretary shall be elected from among the voting members of the CAC by its voting members.
- D Each CAC non-athlete coach member shall serve a three (3) year term, staggered so that one-third (33.3%) of such members are elected each year.
- E The CAC shall lead, direct, and represent the voice, opinions, and viewpoints of all non-athlete coach members within USA Swimming by:
 - (1) Selecting Coach Representatives to serve on committees and defining qualifications for purposes of coach representative eligibility;
 - (2) Evaluating, developing, and supporting committee projects and legislation; and
 - (3) Conducting long-term planning in all areas concerning non-athlete coach members to ensure long-term coach viability and success.

.3 RULES & REGULATIONS COMMITTEE

- A The Rules & Regulations Committee shall consist of the following:
 - (1) The National Officials Committee Chair (or his/her designee) and the Program & Events Coordinator;
 - (2) Three (3) Actively Engaged Athlete Representatives appointed by the AEC;
 - (3) Seven (7) 10-Year Athlete representatives appointed by the AAC;
 - (4) Five (5) non-athlete members appointed by the President/CEO (or his/her designee);
 - (5) Three (3) coach members appointed by the CAC;
 - (6) The immediate past Rules & Regulations Committee Chair, the USA Swimming representative to the World Aquatics Technical Open Water Swimming Committee, the USA Swimming representative to the World Aquatics Technical Swimming Committee, and one (1) representative (or designee) from each of the following: the USMS, the NCAA, the YMCA, and the National Federation of State High School Associations (NFHS), as ex-officio members with voice but no vote; and
 - (7) The President/CEO and the Secretary & General Counsel, or their respective designees, and others appointed by the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair, as ex-officio members with voice but no vote.
- B Each non-athlete member shall serve a four (4) year term, staggered so that one-fourth (1/4) of such members are appointed each year.
- C The Board Chair shall appoint a Chair, with approval of the House of Delegates, to serve two (2) years. The Chair shall appoint one (1) or more secretaries from among committee members.

- D The Rules & Regulations Committee shall hold at least one (1) meeting of its members each year, at a time and place approved by the Committee, for consideration of amendments and interpretations of the Rules and Regulations.
- E The Rules & Regulations Committee or its designee shall have the sole authority to officially interpret Parts One and Seven, the authority to interpret the remainder of these Rules and Regulations, and shall be responsible for all redistricting procedures for USA Swimming.

.4 NATIONAL TEAM STEERING COMMITTEE

A **Membership:** The National Team Steering Committee shall consist of:

- (1) Nine (9) coaches selected as follows;

Preceding Head Men's Olympic Coach

Preceding Head Women's Olympic Coach

Preceding Head Open Water Olympic Coach

The Head Women's Coach for the two (2) Long Course World Championships preceding the Olympic Games

The Head Men's Coach for the two (2) Long Course World Championships preceding the Olympic Games

Two coaches appointed by the CAC in consultation with the National Team Managing Director

Any vacancies on the committee shall be filled by appointment by the President/CEO (or his/her designee) in consultation with the National Team Managing Director.

- (2) The Chair of the committee shall be elected by its voting members.

- (3) Once the new Head Olympic Coaches are named, they shall become ex-officio members of the National Team Steering Committee, if not already on the Committee.

- (4) A sufficient number of 10-Year Athlete representatives appointed by the AAC so as to satisfy the requirement that such athletes constitute one-third (33.3%) of the voting membership of the Committee; and

- (5) The Chair of the Senior Development Committee (or his/her designee selected from the voting members of the Senior Development Committee), and the Chair of the Sports Medicine Committee shall be ex-officio members of the Committee with voice but no vote. The Committee may name additional ex-officio members

B **Term:** Members of the National Team Steering Committee shall serve a term commencing with appointment and extending until the end of the annual House of Delegates meeting following the next Olympic Games.

C **Responsibility:** The National Team Steering Committee shall operate under the direction of the National Team Managing Director to create a National Team program; expedite decisions regarding that program; and plan for specific needs of the National Team in preparation for international competition.

D **Operation:** The National Team Steering Committee shall operate according to policies adopted and published in the Steering Committee Manual.

.5 SENIOR DEVELOPMENT COMMITTEE

- A The Senior Development Committee shall consist of twelve (12) members. The President/CEO (or his/her designee) shall appoint three (3) members, the CAC shall appoint five (5) coach members, and the AAC shall appoint four (4) athlete members (in consultation with the AEC). The Age Group Development Committee Chair (or his/her designee) shall be an ex-officio member with voice but no vote.
- B Each non-athlete member shall serve a four (4) year term, staggered so that one-fourth (1/4) of such members are appointed each year.
- C The Senior Development Committee shall provide technical input for the structure of championship meets, for developing athletes at the post-age group level, and for the transitioning of athletes from Senior to National Team.

.6 AGE GROUP DEVELOPMENT COMMITTEE

- A The Age Group Development Committee shall consist of twelve (12) members. The President/CEO (or his/her designee) shall appoint three (3) members. The CAC shall appoint five (5) coach members, with at least one (1) coach from each Zone. The AAC shall appoint four (4) athlete members (in consultation with the AEC). The Senior Development Committee Chair (or his/her designee) shall be an ex-officio member with voice but no vote.
- B Each non-athlete member shall serve a four (4) year term, staggered so that one-fourth (1/4) of such members are appointed each year.
- C The Age Group Development Committee shall identify and promote ideas to assist USA Swimming in developing Age Group swimmers and shall provide assistance in transitioning swimmers from Age Group to Senior.

.7 SELECTION PROCEDURE APPROVAL COMMITTEE

- A The Selection Procedure Approval Committee shall consist of the following: (i) the President/CEO; (ii) the National Team Managing Director; and (iii) the AAC Chair, who must meet the requirements of a 10-Year Athlete representative, or their respective designee(s). The AAC Chair's designee must also meet the requirements of a 10-Year Athlete representative.
- B The Selection Procedure Approval Committee shall develop, approve, and implement selection criteria for the selection of athletes, coaches and/or staff for Delegation Event teams and Protected Competition (as defined in the USOPC Bylaws).

ARTICLE 502

AMENDMENTS

502.1 AMENDMENTS — The USA Swimming House of Delegates may amend the Rules and Regulations and certain provisions of the Corporate Bylaws at its annual meeting in accordance with Article 10 of the Corporate Bylaws and this Section 502.1 of the Rules and Regulations.

- .1 The USA Swimming House of Delegates may amend the Rules and Regulations at its annual meeting as follows:
 - A Parts One, Two, Three, Four, Six and Seven: by a majority vote.

B Part Five: by a two-thirds (2/3) vote.

- .2 By a two-thirds (2/3) vote, the House of Delegates may amend the following provisions within the Corporate Bylaws: the number of Board members, their terms, or the number of which are elected by the House of Delegates, the composition of the House of Delegates, and membership fees for membership classes in existence as of the 2017 registration year (See 2.7.1A and B of the Corporate Bylaws).
- .3 Additionally, the Rules & Regulations Committee may alter, amend, or repeal any portion of Part One or Part Seven of the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations at any time to conform to the rules of World Aquatics.

.4 AMENDMENTS PROPOSED

A **By Whom Proposed** — An amendment to the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations may be proposed only by an LSC, a duly constituted committee, a member of the USA Swimming House of Delegates as identified in Article 6 of the Corporate Bylaws, the Board of Directors or any Allied or Affiliate Group Member.

B **Form Required** — Every proposed amendment to the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations shall be in such form as to show the entire section as it will read if adopted, with any changes in existing language single underlined if new and lined out (struck through) if deleted. Each amendment shall be accompanied by a concise, but informative rationale for adoption and for the proposed effective date. In addition, the name, address and telephone number of the proposer must be included (if the proposer is an entity, the name, address and telephone number of an authorized spokesperson with authority to agree to changes in the proposed amendment).

C **Last Date for Proposal** — Every proposed amendment shall be submitted to the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair no later than the May 15 preceding an annual meeting of the USA Swimming House of Delegates.

D **Consideration, Recommendation and Report** — The Rules & Regulations Committee shall consider all proposed amendments and shall present them to the annual meeting of the House of Delegates with the Committee's recommendations.

E **Procedures for Recommendations** — As a part of its consideration, the Rules & Regulations Committee is encouraged to consult with the proposer and any other interested parties and suggest changes (which may be substantive or drafting) to the amendment that would enable the Committee to support adoption. Recommendations under this Article may be for or against adoption, a statement of no recommendation, or a recommendation to commit the proposal to another USA Swimming Committee or the proposer for further consideration. Each recommendation for rejection shall include a concise, but informative rationale for the recommendation.

- .5 **PUBLICATION OF AMENDMENTS** — All proposed amendments to all parts of these Rules & Regulations shall be published and made available on the USA Swimming website not less than seventy-five (75) days prior to the annual meeting of the House of Delegates. Members of the House of Delegates may request a printed copy after the amendments are posted on the website.
- .6 **CHANGES TO AMENDMENTS** — A proposed amendment may be modified in any manner by the House of Delegates while under consideration, but such modification must be ger-

mane to the subject matter of the proposed amendment [which does not require the nine-tenths (9/10) vote as provided in 502.1.7]. If more than one (1) amendment has been proposed on the same subject matter, and there are substantive differences between such amendments, the House of Delegates may adopt a compromise of substance as well as form, and if the adoption of an amendment as proposed or amended or comprised is inconsistent or in conflict with other parts of the Rules & Regulations, the House of Delegates may adopt conforming amendments appropriate to the case.

- .7 **LATE SUBMISSION AND MAJORITY REQUIRED** — After the deadline has expired for submission of legislation to the Rules & Regulations Committee, new and/or additional amendments may be proposed, but they may be adopted only by an affirmative vote of nine-tenths (9/10) of the members of the House of Delegates present and voting. For purposes of this Article, legislation originating within the Rules & Regulations Committee will be considered as being submitted before the deadline as long as it is published in accordance with 502.1.5.
- .8 **EFFECTIVE DATE** — Housekeeping items approved as prescribed shall become effective immediately. All other amendments to Part One of these Rules & Regulations approved as prescribed shall become effective on May 1 of the year following their adoption, unless otherwise specified at the time of adoption. All other amendments to these Rules & Regulations approved as prescribed shall become effective on January 1 of the year following their adoption unless otherwise specified at the time of adoption.

ARTICLE 503

RULEBOOK

503.1 USA Swimming shall annually publish updated Rules & Regulations (Rulebook). It shall be posted on the USA Swimming website by January 1 of each year.

503.2 Each non-athlete member of USA Swimming may annually request a printed copy of the Rulebook as a benefit of membership. Such Rulebooks shall be mailed out as close to January 1 as possible or immediately upon a non-athlete's membership registration received prior to September 1.

PART SIX

LOCAL SWIMMING COMMITTEES, ZONES AND REGIONS

ARTICLE 601 GENERAL

601.1 The Local Swimming Committee (LSC) is a separate and independent corporation to whom USA Swimming has delegated certain governing and supervisory responsibilities within the geographic boundaries designated by USA Swimming. Each LSC shall have jurisdiction over the sport of swimming as delegated to it in the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations to conduct swimming programs consistent with the policies and procedures of USA Swimming and to sanction, approve, observe, oversee and conduct on behalf of USA Swimming competitive swimming events within the LSC boundaries.

601.2 Each LSC qualifies under USA Swimming's group exemption as a tax-exempt organization described in Section 501(c)(3) of the U.S. Internal Revenue Code and as an organization described in Sections 170(c)(2) and 2522(a) of the U.S. Internal Revenue Code that may accept contributions, bequests, and gifts deductible for federal income and estate and gift tax purposes, respectively.

ARTICLE 602 LSC BYLAWS

602.1 USA Swimming House of Delegates has approved and amended Required LSC Bylaws, which each LSC, within the flexibility granted in the Required LSC Bylaws, is required to adopt. USA Swimming House of Delegates shall retain the authority over these Required LSC Bylaws, including the right to amend in accordance with Article 502 of USA Swimming Rules & Regulations. Amendments to the Required LSC Bylaws by the USA Swimming House of Delegates are given automatic effect as of the effective date of legislation with respect to an LSC's Bylaws. LSCs are required to update their bylaws and send a copy to bylaws@usaswimming.org within sixty (60) days of the effective date of any changes to the Required LSC Bylaws adopted by the USA Swimming House of Delegates or the LSC House of Delegates.

602.2 The Required LSC Bylaws are available from the USA Swimming National Office and on the USA Swimming website. Bylaws of the individual LSCs are available directly from the LSC or the USA Swimming National Office.

602.3 The LSC Bylaws shall be construed and all powers and activities of the LSC shall be limited to be consistent with the LSC legal status stated in Article 601.

602.4 The LSC Bylaws shall conform to and include the requirements and shall comply with the laws of the jurisdiction within which the LSC is incorporated.

602.5 See Article 8 of the Corporate Bylaws for LSC financial reporting requirements.

602.6 Current Bylaws of each LSC shall be on file with the USA Swimming National Office.

602.7 USA SWIMMING RULES & REGULATIONS COMMITTEE JURISDICTION OVER LSC BYLAWS — This Article grants jurisdiction to the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee relating to the Required LSC Bylaws.

- .1 **Jurisdiction of the Rules & Regulations Committee** — The USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee is authorized and directed to assume jurisdiction over (a) changes to the mandatory portions of the Required LSC Bylaws, (b) approval of the use of certain alternative provisions set forth in Required LSC Bylaws, (c) review and approval of all Bylaws adopted by the LSCs and (d) review and approval of all subsequent amendments to the Bylaws by an LSC and related matters. The USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee may adopt rules and procedures to govern the invocation and exercise of this jurisdiction which may be appropriate and helpful and in the best interests of the sport of swimming.
- .2 **Request for Approval** — An LSC may request permission to change mandatory provisions of the Required LSC Bylaws or request an approval as required in Required LSC Bylaws in a written application conforming to the rules and procedures adopted by the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee. The request shall be addressed to the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair. The approval power of the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee over requested changes to mandatory parts of the Bylaws shall be applied generously where an LSC demonstrates a need for the changes.
- .3 **Action by Committee** — The changes may be approved or disapproved in their entirety, or the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee may modify the requested change as appears to be in the best interests of swimming. The USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee may adopt reasonable rules and procedures regarding the form and content of the application for permission, its deliberations and decisions.
- .4 **Deadline for Decision** — The USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee shall make its determination within forty-five (45) days of receipt by its Chair of the request; failing which, the request shall be deemed to have been approved unless the Chair shall certify that more than ten (10) approvals are pending at the end of that period.
- .5 **Appeal of Decisions** — An LSC may appeal a decision of any USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Subcommittee to the full Rules & Regulations Committee. An LSC may appeal a decision of the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee to the USA Swimming Board of Directors.

602.8 Amendments to the LSC Bylaws must be submitted to the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee in accordance with this Article 602. Once the amendments have been approved, the LSC shall forward the amended Bylaws to the USA Swimming National Office.

ARTICLE 603

NAMES AND JURISDICTIONAL BOUNDARIES

603.1 Each LSC shall include in its name the designation which appears below in boldfaced type followed by the word "Swimming" and the appropriate indicator of corporate status as set forth in the respective Articles/Certificate of Incorporation.

603.2 The geographical areas or boundaries for the Local Swimming Committees shall be as indicated below. The two-letter Registration Codes are shown in parenthesis:

ADIRONDACK (AD) — That portion of New York State east of the counties of Oswego, Onondaga, Cortland and Broome; and north of the counties of Sullivan, Orange and Dutchess.

ALASKA (AK) — State of Alaska.

ALLEGHENY MOUNTAIN (AM) — That portion of the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania west of the counties of Potter, Clinton, Centre, Huntingdon and Bedford; the counties of Hancock, Brook, Ohio and Marshall in the State of West Virginia; and the counties of Columbiana, Jefferson and Belmont in the State of Ohio.

ARKANSAS (AR) — State of Arkansas, and Bowie County in the State of Texas.

ARIZONA (AZ) — State of Arizona.

BORDER (BD) — In the State of Texas, the counties of El Paso, Hudspeth, Culberson, Jeff Davis, Presidio, Brewster, Terrell and Crockett.

CENTRAL CALIFORNIA (CC) — In the State of California, the counties of Merced, Mariposa, Mono, Madera, Fresno, Kings, Tulare, Kern and Inyo; excluding the City of Bishop and the community of Mammoth Lakes.

COLORADO (CO) — State of Colorado.

CONNECTICUT (CT) — State of Connecticut.

FLORIDA (FL) — That portion of the State of Florida east of the Apalachicola River and including Gulf County, except for the counties of Palm Beach, Broward, Miami-Dade, Monroe, and the part of Hendry east of Route 833.

FLORIDA GOLD COAST (FG) — In the State of Florida, the counties of Palm Beach, Broward, Miami-Dade, Monroe, and the part of Hendry east of Route 833.

GEORGIA (GA) — State of Georgia, and Chambers and Russell counties in the State of Alabama.

GULF (GU) — That portion of the State of Texas bounded on the north by and including the counties of Shelby, Nacogdoches, Angelina, Houston, Leon and Robertson; and on the west by and including the counties of Brazos, Grimes, Waller, Fort Bend, Wharton, Colorado and Matagorda.

HAWAIIAN (HI) — State of Hawaii.

ILLINOIS (IL) — State of Illinois, except the counties of Calhoun, Greene, Jersey, Madison, St. Clair, Monroe, Jackson and Vermilion.

INDIANA (IN) — State of Indiana, except Floyd and Clark counties, and including Vermilion County in the State of Illinois.

INLAND EMPIRE (IE) — That portion of the State of Idaho north of and including Idaho County; the counties of Umatilla, Union, Wallowa and Baker in the State of Oregon; and that portion of the State of Washington east of and including the counties of Okanogan, Chelan, Kittitas, Yakima, and the part of Klickitat east of Highway 97 and including the City of Goldendale.

IOWA (IA) — State of Iowa, except the counties of Lyon, Osceola, Sioux, O'Brien, Plymouth, Cherokee, Woodbury, Ida, Monona, Crawford, Harrison, Shelby, Pottawattamie, Mills, Montgomery, Freemont and Page.

KENTUCKY (KY) — Commonwealth of Kentucky except the counties of Campbell and Boone; and including Floyd and Clark counties in the State of Indiana.

LAKE ERIE (LE) — In the State of Ohio, the counties of Seneca, Crawford, Erie, Huron, Richland, Lorain, Ashland, Cuyahoga, Medina, Wayne, Summit, Lake, Geauga, Portage, Stark, Tuscarawas, Ashtabula, Trumbull and Mahoning.

LOUISIANA (LA) — State of Louisiana.

MAINE (ME) — That portion of the State of Maine, including the counties of Knox, Kennebec, Hancock, Aroostook, Sagadahoc, Oxford, Lincoln, Washington, and Waldo. The portion of Cumberland County including the towns of Bridgton, Harrison, Freeport, Harpswell, and Brunswick. The portion of Penobscot County (ME) not including the towns of Dexter, Garland, Charleston, Bradford, Alton, Argyle Township, Greenbush, Old Town, Indian Island, Orono, Bradley, and Milford. The portion of Franklin County (ME) not including the towns of Jay, Chesterville, and New Sharon. The portion of Franklin County (ME) not including the towns of Jay, Chesterville, and New Sharon. The portion of Piscataquis County (ME) not including the towns of Wellington, Parkman, Sangerville, Guilford, Dover-Foxcroft, Sebec, and Atkinson. The portion of Somerset County not including the towns of Starks, Mercer, Anson, Emden, Concord Township, Bingham, and Brighton Plantation.

MARYLAND (MD) — State of Maryland, except Montgomery and Prince George's counties.

METROPOLITAN (MR) — That portion of New York State south of and including the counties of Sullivan, Orange and Dutchess.

MICHIGAN (MI) — State of Michigan.

MIDDLE ATLANTIC (MA) — That portion of the State of New Jersey south of Mercer and Monmouth counties; the State of Delaware; and that portion of the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania east of and including the counties of Potter, Clinton, Centre, Huntingdon and Bedford.

MIDWESTERN (MW) — State of Nebraska except the counties of Sioux, Scotts Bluff, Banner, Kimball, Dawes, Box Butte, Morrill, Cheyenne, Sheridan, Garden and Deuel; and including the counties of Lyon, Osceola, Sioux, O'Brien, Plymouth, Cherokee, Woodbury, Ida, Monona, Crawford, Harrison, Shelby, Pottawattamie, Mills, Montgomery, Freemont and Page in the State of Iowa.

MINNESOTA (MN) — State of Minnesota, except for Polk and Pennington counties; and including the counties of Polk, St. Croix, Dunn, and Pierce in the State of Wisconsin.

MISSISSIPPI (MS) — State of Mississippi.

MISSOURI VALLEY (MV) — In the State of Missouri, the counties west of and including Schuyler, Adair, Macon, Randolph, Audrain, Callaway, Cole, Moniteau, Morgan, Benton, Hickory, Polk, Greene, Christian and Taney; the State of Kansas; Texas County in the State of Oklahoma; and Hansford County in the State of Texas.

MONTANA (MT) — State of Montana, except Dawson and Wibaux counties.

NEW ENGLAND (NE) — The states of New Hampshire, Vermont, Massachusetts and Rhode Island. That portion of the State of Maine, including the counties of York, Androscoggin, and Cumberland, including towns of Baldwin, Cape Elizabeth, Casco, Chebeague Island, Cumberland, Falmouth, Frye Island, Gorham, Gray, Long Island, Naples, New Gloucester, North Yarmouth, Portland, Pownal, Raymond, Scarborough, Sebago, South Portland, Standish, Westbrook, Windham, and Yarmouth. The portion of Penobscot County (ME) including the towns of Dexter, Garland, Charleston, Bradford, Alton, Argyle Township, Greenbush, Old Town, Indian Island, Orono, Bradley, and Milford. The portion of Franklin County (ME) including the towns of

Jay, Chesterville, and New Sharon. The portion of Piscataquis County (ME) including the towns of Wellington, Parkman, Sangerville, Guilford, Dover-Foxcroft, Sebec, and Atkinson. The portion of Somerset County including the towns of Starks, Mercer, Anson, Embden, Concord Township, Bingham, and Brighton Plantation.

NEW JERSEY (NJ) — That portion of the State of New Jersey north of and including Mercer and Monmouth counties.

NEW MEXICO (NM) — State of New Mexico.

NIAGARA (NI) — That portion of New York State west of and including the counties of Oswego, Onondaga, Cortland and Broome.

NORTH CAROLINA (NC) — State of North Carolina, except the counties of Pasquotank, Camden and Currituck.

NORTH DAKOTA (ND) — State of North Dakota, Dawson and Wibaux counties in the State of Montana, and Polk and Pennington counties in the State of Minnesota.

NORTH TEXAS (NT) — That portion of the State of Texas east of the counties of Hardeman, Foard, Knox, Haskell, Jones, Callahan, Brown, Mills and Lampasas; and north of the counties of Bell, Milam, Robertson, Leon, Houston, Angelina, Nacogdoches and Shelby; and excluding Bowie County.

OHIO (OH) — State of Ohio, except the counties of Seneca, Crawford, Erie, Huron, Richland, Lorain, Ashland, Cuyahoga, Medina, Wayne, Summit, Lake, Geauga, Portage, Stark, Tuscarawas, Ashtabula, Trumbull, Mahoning, Columbiana, Jefferson, Belmont, Washington and Lawrence; and including the counties of Campbell and Boone in the Commonwealth of Kentucky.

OKLAHOMA (OK) — State of Oklahoma, except Texas County.

OREGON (OR) — State of Oregon, except for the counties of Umatilla, Union, Wallowa, Baker and Malheur; and in the State of Washington, the counties of Cowlitz, Clark, Skamania, and the part of Klickitat west of Highway 97, excluding the City of Goldendale.

OZARK (OZ) — That portion of the State of Missouri east of and including the counties of Scotland, Knox, Shelby, Monroe, Ralls, Pike, Montgomery, Osage, Miller, Camden, Dallas, Webster, Douglas and Ozark; and the counties of Calhoun, Greene, Jersey, Madison, St. Clair, Monroe and Jackson in the State of Illinois.

PACIFIC (PC) — In the State of Nevada, the counties of Lyon, Douglas, Carson City, Storey, and the part of Washoe lying south of the northerly boundary of the Pyramid Lake Indian Reservation; and in the State of California, the counties of Del Norte, Humboldt, Mendocino, Lake, Sonoma, Napa, Marin, Contra Costa, San Francisco, Alameda, San Mateo, Santa Clara, Santa Cruz, San Benito, Monterey, Tuolumne, and Alpine, and the parts of: Solano and Sacramento counties south of Highway 12, including the communities of Vallejo and Benicia and excluding the communities of Fairfield, Suisun City and Rio Vista; San Joaquin County south and west of the line created by Highway 12 to Interstate 5 to Eight Mile Road to Highway 99 to Highway 4, including the City of Stockton; Stanislaus and Calaveras counties south of Highway 4; El Dorado County east of Highway 89; and the City of Bishop in Inyo County and the community of Mammoth Lakes in Mono County.

The Solano Community College pool in Solano County and any pool between Eight Mile Road and Hammer Lane in San Joaquin County shall be available for the use of the Pacific Swimming

and Sierra Nevada Swimming LSCs and their respective member clubs, and both LSCs may sanction swimming events in these pools under their own rules and regulations.

PACIFIC NORTHWEST (PN) — That portion of the State of Washington west of the counties of Okanogan, Chelan, Kittitas and Yakima; north of Skamania County; and north and west of Cowlitz County.

POTOMAC VALLEY (PV) — The District of Columbia; Montgomery and Prince George's counties in the State of Maryland; and Arlington and Fairfax counties and the cities of Alexandria, Fairfax and Falls Church in the Commonwealth of Virginia.

SAN DIEGO-IMPERIAL (SI) — San Diego and Imperial counties in the State of California.

SIERRA NEVADA (SN) — In the State of Nevada, the counties of Humboldt, Pershing, Churchill, Mineral, Lander and the part of Washoe lying north of the northerly boundary of the Pyramid Lake Indian Reservation; and in the State of California, the counties of Siskiyou, Modoc, Trinity, Shasta, Lassen, Tehama, Plumas, Glenn, Butte, Sierra, Colusa, Sutter, Yuba, Nevada, Placer, Yolo and Amador; and the parts of: Solano and Sacramento counties north of Highway 12, including the communities of Fairfield, Suisun City and Rio Vista and excluding the communities of Vallejo and Benicia; San Joaquin County north and east of the line created by Highway 12 to Interstate 5 to Eight Mile Road to Highway 99 to Highway 4, excluding the City of Stockton; Stanislaus and Calaveras counties north of Highway 4; and El Dorado County west of Highway 89.

The Solano Community College pool in Solano County and any pool between Eight Mile Road and Hammer Lane in San Joaquin County shall be available for the use of the Pacific Swimming and Sierra Nevada Swimming LSCs and their respective member clubs, and both LSCs may sanction swimming events in these pools under their own rules and regulations.

SNAKE RIVER (SR) — That portion of the State of Idaho south of Idaho County; the counties of Elko, White Pine and Eureka in the State of Nevada; and Malheur County in the State of Oregon.

SOUTH CAROLINA (SC) — State of South Carolina.

SOUTH DAKOTA (SD) — State of South Dakota.

SOUTH TEXAS (ST) — That portion of the State of Texas bounded on the west by and including the counties of Val Verde, Sutton and Schleicher; on the north by and including the counties of Menard, Mason, Llano, Burnet, Lampasas and Bell; and on the east by and including the counties of Milam, Burleson, Washington, Austin, Fayette, Lavaca, Jackson and Calhoun.

SOUTHEASTERN (SE) — State of Tennessee; the State of Alabama, except Chambers and Russell counties; and that portion of the State of Florida west of the Apalachicola River, excluding Gulf County.

SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA (CA) — In the State of California, the counties of San Luis Obispo, Santa Barbara, Ventura, Los Angeles, San Bernardino, Orange and Riverside; and in the State of Nevada, the counties of Clark, Lincoln, Nye and Esmeralda.

UTAH (UT) — State of Utah.

VIRGINIA (VA) — Commonwealth of Virginia, except Arlington and Fairfax counties and the cities of Alexandria, Fairfax and Falls Church; and including the counties of Pasquotank, Camden and Currituck in the State of North Carolina.

WEST TEXAS (WT) — That portion of the State of Texas bounded on the south by and including the counties of Reeves, Pecos, Crane, Upton, Reagan, Irion, Tom Green, Concho, McCulloch

and San Saba; on the west by the State of New Mexico and by and including Loving and Winkler counties; on the north by Hansford County and the State of Oklahoma; and on the east by the State of Oklahoma, and by and including the counties of Hardeman, Foard, Knox, Haskell, Jones, Callahan, Brown and Mills.

WEST VIRGINIA (WV) — State of West Virginia, except the counties of Hancock, Brook, Ohio and Marshall; and including Lawrence and Washington counties in the State of Ohio.

WISCONSIN (WI) — State of Wisconsin, except the counties of Polk, St. Croix, Dunn and Pierce.

WYOMING (WY) — State of Wyoming; and the counties of Sioux, Scotts Bluff, Banner, Kimball, Dawes, Box Butte, Morrill, Cheyenne, Sheridan, Garden and Deuel in the State of Nebraska.

ARTICLE 604

LSC REDISTRICTING PROCEDURES

604.1 CHANGE IN LSC AFFILIATION BY A CLUB MEMBER — A change of a Member Club from one LSC to another LSC which is contiguous and where no other Member Club geographically (as determined by the club's primary training facility location) intervenes between the changing club and the new LSC boundary must be approved by a majority vote of the members present of each of the LSCs' House of Delegates. Club approval of change in affiliation shall be in accord with the rules of the Member Club and shall be duly certified by the Member Club's president and secretary. Such transfer shall become effective ninety (90) days after receipt of a written notice of approval from the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair who shall notify the USA Swimming National Office.

604.2 CHANGE IN LSC TERRITORY — If two-thirds (2/3) of the number of clubs in a contiguous area within an LSC wish to affiliate with a neighboring and contiguous LSC, and should the House of Delegates of each LSC by a majority vote of the members present approve the change, the change in territorial jurisdiction shall include all Club Members in the contiguous area and shall become effective no sooner than sixty (60) days following the receipt by the Chair of the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee of satisfactory evidence of the various votes required. Club Member approval of change in affiliation shall be in accord with the rules of the Club Member and shall be duly certified by the Club Member's president and secretary.

604.3 FORMATION OF A NEW LSC

- .1 If two-thirds (2/3) of the number of Club Members in a contiguous area within an LSC wish to form a new and independent LSC, and should the House of Delegates of the LSC, by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the members present approve the change, the proposed formation of the new LSC shall be submitted to the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair. Such request must be received by the Chair prior to April 1.
- .2 The USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee shall make a recommendation to the USA Swimming House of Delegates at the next annual meeting for its approval or disapproval. Should approval be granted, the formation of the new LSC shall become effective as of the first day of the fiscal year of the old LSC following such approval, unless an earlier date is agreed to by the Board of Directors of the existing LSC. Club Member approval of the creation of the new LSC shall be in accordance with the rules of the Club Member and shall be duly certified by the Club Member's president and secretary. The change shall include all clubs in the specified contiguous area.

- .3 At the time of the effective date the net assets of the existing LSC (after payment of or provision for all debts) shall be divided with the new LSC in proportion to the number of registered athletes within each LSC as of the August 31 closest to the effective date.
- .4 During the period of time between the date on which the new LSC is approved by the USA Swimming House of Delegates and the effective date of the new LSC, the USA Swimming Board Chair shall promptly appoint a governing ad hoc committee of no fewer than seven (7) members from among USA Swimming members of the new LSC, including one athlete and one coach, to be charged with the responsibility of:
 - A notifying all clubs within the new LSC to elect at least one delegate and alternate to the new LSC House of Delegates;
 - B scheduling and notifying in writing about the place, date and time of a meeting of the new LSC House of Delegates as soon as conveniently possible after the effective date;
 - C providing an agenda for the first meeting to permit the orderly election of officers and directors, adoption of Bylaws, appointment of committees and their respective chairs; and
 - D attending to such other matters as may be necessary to permit the new LSC to become a fully functioning administrative unit of USA Swimming.

604.4 MERGING TWO LSCs — If the Boards of Directors of two (2) LSCs that share a common geographical border agree in principle to merge their two LSCs into a single LSC, and should the House of Delegates of each LSC by a majority vote of the members present approve the merger, then the merger shall become effective no sooner than sixty (60) days following the receipt by the Rules & Regulations Committee Chair of satisfactory evidence of the various votes required.

ARTICLE 605

ZONES

605.1 For administrative purposes, USA Swimming has grouped the LSCs into the following zones:

Eastern Zone — Adirondack, Allegheny Mountain, Connecticut, Maine, Maryland, Metropolitan, Middle Atlantic, New England, New Jersey, Niagara, Potomac Valley, Virginia.

Southern Zone — Border, Florida, Florida Gold Coast, Georgia, Gulf, Kentucky, Louisiana, Mississippi, North Carolina, North Texas, South Carolina, South Texas, Southeastern, West Texas, West Virginia.

Central Zone — Arkansas, Illinois, Indiana, Iowa, Lake Erie, Michigan, Midwestern, Minnesota, Missouri Valley, North Dakota, Ohio, Oklahoma, Ozark, South Dakota, Wisconsin.

Western Zone — Alaska, Arizona, Central California, Colorado, Hawaii, Inland Empire, Montana, New Mexico, Oregon, Pacific, Pacific Northwest, San Diego-Imperial, Sierra Nevada, Snake River, Southern California, Utah, Wyoming.

605.2 ZONE ADMINISTRATIVE PROCEDURES, ELECTIONS OF DIRECTORS AND VOTING

- .1 Each Zone shall adopt Administrative Procedures which shall govern its affairs and shall be approved by the USA Swimming Secretary & General Counsel (or his/her designee).

- .2 Zone Directors shall be elected in accordance with Zone Administrative Procedures.
- .3 On all voting matters, each LSC is entitled to five votes, of which at least one vote must be designated to the LSC Athlete Representative(s). If no Athlete Representative is present, the LSC shall cast only four votes.

605.3 ZONE MEET ADMINISTRATION — Zone Age Group Championships, meets delegated to the Zone in the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations and any other meets scheduled by the Zone shall be conducted and administered by the Zone.

605.4 CHANGE IN ZONE ALIGNMENT — If an LSC by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the members present at a meeting of the LSC House of Delegates approves a change moving the LSC from one Zone to another, and if both Zones approve of the change by majority vote of the LSCs in each Zone, that change shall become effective at the close of the next USA Swimming annual meeting at which the USA Swimming House of Delegates shall approve the change. Prior to the vote of the House of Delegates, the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee shall make a recommendation as to approval or disapproval of the proposed change.

ARTICLE 606

REGIONAL COMPETITION

In order to reduce travel distances for athletes and to provide equitable quality competition the LSCs may make arrangements to compete on a regional basis.

ARTICLE 607

APPEALS AND REVIEW

607.1 PETITION TO THE USA SWIMMING RULES & REGULATIONS COMMITTEE — Any House of Delegates of any LSC or any member of USA Swimming may petition the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee with respect to any proposed changes referenced in Articles 604 and 605 above. Such appeal must be submitted at least one hundred (100) days prior to the next regular or special meeting of the USA Swimming House of Delegates.

607.2 In any case in which an LSC House of Delegates or a Zone fails to approve or agree to a requested change, the proponents of the change may petition the USA Swimming Rules & Regulations Committee to investigate and determine whether the change should be allowed notwithstanding the failure of the LSC or Zone to approve. Such appeal must be submitted at least one hundred (100) days prior to the next regular or special meeting of the USA Swimming House of Delegates.

607.3 Submission to the Committee shall be in writing; shall contain the name of the proponent(s), the name(s) of the club(s) involved, a record of vote(s) taken at any level certified in writing by an appropriate officer; and shall contain a summary of the rationale for the proposed change(s).

607.4 The Rules & Regulations Committee shall investigate the matter and hold a public hearing thereon at the time of the next annual meeting of the USA Swimming House of Delegates. The Committee shall then make recommendations to the House for its final determination.

PART SEVEN

OPEN WATER SWIMMING

Parts One through Six of the USA Swimming Rules and Regulations apply to open water competition, unless specifically indicated otherwise in Part Seven.

ARTICLE 701

CONDUCT AND OFFICIATING OF THE COMPETITION

701.1 EVENTS

- .1 Recommended individual events are listed in 102.1.4.
- .2 **Wetsuit Events**
 - A At Junior National and National Championships and any sanctioned open water competition with a race distance of 5k and greater, World Aquatics rules regarding use of wetsuits shall apply.
 - B For all open water competitions with water temperature below 18.0°C (64.4°F), participants must use wetsuits (refer to 701.4.5).
 - C Meet Directors may also designate a wetsuit competition category at any event other than Junior National Championships, National Championships, and Zone Open Water Championships.
- .3 **Team Events** — Team events may be conducted in various formats concurrently with individual events, with the results achieved in the individual event used to compute the team scoring as announced in the meet announcement.

701.2 RULES

- .1 All open water competitions shall be freestyle events.
- .2 **The Start**
 - A Events may be started either:
 - (1) In-water — swimmers stand or tread water in a depth sufficient for them to commence swimming on the start signal;
 - (2) From the beach — swimmers line up and run into the water from the shore on the Starter's signal; or
 - (3) From a fixed platform — swimmers' positions on the platform are determined by random draw and they commence racing on the start signal (See 103.2.3 — Water Depth).
 - B In all starts, the start signal shall be both audible and visible. For fixed platform starts, the Starter shall give the command, "Take your marks," at which time the swimmers will assume a starting position with at least one foot at the front of the starting platform. When all swimmers are stationary, the Starter shall give the starting signal.
 - C When the start for Men's and Women's competitions is staggered, the Men's events shall always start before the Women's events.

701.2

- D If, in the opinion of the Referee, an unfair advantage has been gained by someone at the start, that swimmer may be disqualified.
- E Prior to the start, all escort safety crafts shall be stationed so as to avoid interference with any competitor. If catching up to their swimmers from behind, the craft shall navigate in such a way as to avoid maneuvering through the field of swimmers.

.3 The Finish

- A Where in-water finish apparatus is not available, an on-shore finish where contestants run from the water to a finish point is permitted.
- B The finish should be filmed and recorded by a video system.
 - (1) The video recording system should be positioned in line with the finish where a clear, unobstructed view can be maintained. The recording system is from each side and above with a clear, unobstructed view.
 - (2) The video recording system shall have both slow motion and recall capability, including timing equipment.

.4 Escort Safety Craft

- A Escort safety craft shall maintain a constant position at the sides of their swimmers and shall maneuver so as to avoid obstructing or placing themselves directly in front of another swimmer.
- B Each escort safety craft shall contain a race judge, a person of the swimmer's choosing, and the minimum crew required to operate the escort safety craft.
- C Coaching and the giving of instructions by a swimmer's representative on escort safety craft or platforms is permitted. No whistles may be used by coaches.

.5 Time Limits — In all Open Water events, time limits shall be published in the meet announcement and shall apply as follows from the finish time of the first swimmer. Events with age group divisions will have the time applied by age group.

- A Events under 25k not less than 30 minutes
- B Events of 25k not less than 60 minutes
- C Events of over 25k not less than 120 minutes

.6 In events where feed poles are permitted, feed poles are not to exceed 5m (16 feet 5 inches) in length when extended. No objects, rope or wire may hang off of feed poles except banners or flags not to exceed 20 cm x 30 cm (8 inches x 12 inches).

701.3 MARKING — Prior to the start, swimmers shall be marked with their race numbers on both upper arms and their upper backs. The swimmers shall be numbered vertically down the arms and horizontally across the upper backs. Swimmers shall be marked with their race numbers on both hands and/or their swim caps when competing in wetsuits. Depending on the finish system used, the Referee may also require numbering elsewhere on the body (hands or thighs). Paddlers and escort boats for escorted swimmers shall also be marked on both sides with the swimmer's race number so it is easily seen from either side.

701.4 SWIMWEAR

- .1 No swimmer shall be allowed to use or wear any device that may be an aid to his/her speed, endurance, or buoyancy. A maximum of two (2) caps may be used.

- .2 Except as provided in 701.1.2, wetsuits, flotation aids or any similar items, and anything used to maintain body heat, except a reasonable application of body grease, are not allowed.
- .3 Only swimsuits complying with World Aquatics Open Water swimsuit specifications may be worn in any USA Swimming sanctioned or approved open water competition.
- .4 Swimsuits for both men and women shall not cover the neck, extend past the shoulder, nor extend below the ankle.
- .5 **Wetsuits at Championships Events (701.1.2 A)** — Wetsuits (for both men and women) shall completely cover the torso, back, shoulders and knees. Wetsuits shall not extend beyond the neck, wrists and ankles..
- .6 **Wetsuits at non-Championships Events (701.1.2 C)** — Wetsuits (for both men and women) shall not extend beyond the neck, wrists, and ankles. The thickness of material(s) used shall be maximum 5 mm.

701.5 DISQUALIFICATIONS

- .1 **Red Flag** — A swimmer shall receive a Red Flag and be disqualified from further competition for:
 - A Accumulating two Yellow Flag infractions for any combination of rules violations. The Red Flag will be issued at the time of the second infraction;
 - B Failing to swim or complete the prescribed course. Swimmers who do not finish the course within the time limit shall be removed from the water except that the Referee may allow a swimmer outside the time limit to complete the course but not participate in any points or prizes awarded;
 - C Receiving assistance by pulling on the cables, line markers, buoys, or buoy lines (Note: Incidental contact shall not be a basis for disqualification.);
 - D Receiving propulsive aid from anyone in boats or other escort craft of any kind;
 - E Walking or pushing off the bottom or objects thereon (Note: Pushing off at the start or walking at the finish where an on-shore finish is employed is permitted.);
 - F Receiving support from any fixed or floating object or touching or being touched by his/her escort safety craft or the crew. (Standing on the bottom during the race shall not disqualify the swimmer. Incidental physical contact while giving food or liquid to a swimmer shall not result in disqualification.) Being touched by water safety personnel will not necessarily result in disqualification;
 - G Unsportsmanlike conduct. Swimmers will be disqualified if they, their support craft, or support personnel, commit an act that is deemed unsportsmanlike by the Referee. Examples of unsportsmanlike conduct include intentionally striking another swimmer, refusing to re-round a turn mark and intentional interference with another swimmer while approaching the finish; or
 - H Violating the swimwear rules. No swimmer shall be permitted to use or wear any device which may be an aid to his/her speed, endurance, or buoyancy. Goggles, a maximum of two (2) caps, nose clip and earplugs may be used.
- .2 **Yellow Flag** — A swimmer shall receive a Yellow Flag for:
 - A Gaining an unfair advantage at the start. If in the opinion of the Referee, an unfair advantage has been gained at the start, the offending swimmer will be given a Yellow Flag or a Red Flag as determined by the Referee;

701.5

- B Receiving aid from a non-competing person in the form of pacing;
- C Taking an unfair advantage by slipstreaming an escort safety craft (Race judges shall instruct swimmers who are taking unfair advantage by pacing, or slipstreaming with escort safety craft to move clear.);
- D Actions of his/her escort craft that interfere with another swimmer's progress or for failure of his/her craft or coach to heed the instruction of an assigned official; or
- E Intentional contact with another swimmer or contact which causes interference.

701.6 DISQUALIFICATION PROCEDURE

- .1 **Yellow Flag** — A swimmer who commits an infraction listed in 701.5.2 shall receive a Yellow Flag. The Referee will display a Yellow Flag and a card bearing the number of the swimmer being charged with the infraction. The Referee may use a whistle to attempt to get the swimmer's attention in order to notify the swimmer being charged with an infraction. There is no requirement for the swimmer to acknowledge the infraction.
- .2 **Red Flag** — A swimmer who commits an infraction as listed in 701.5.1 shall receive a Red Flag. The Referee will display a Red Flag and a card bearing the number of the swimmer being charged with the infraction. The Referee may use a whistle to get the swimmer's attention in order to notify the swimmer of the disqualification. The disqualified swimmer must leave the water immediately.

701.7 THE MEET DIRECTOR shall

- .1 have no other position at the event;
- .2 determine the course for an open water event;
- .3 have the authority to withdraw the sanction on race day if adequate safety precautions are not in place and shall notify all race participants prior to the beginning of the race of the revocation should the race organizer proceed with the competition; and
- .4 have the authority to stop a race at any time should conditions change and safety become a concern.

701.8 THE INDEPENDENT SAFETY MONITOR shall

- .1 be independent of the race organizing committee, approved by an LSC sanction officer, and have no direct responsibility for athletes entered in the competition (e.g., coach, Personal Assistant, or team manager);
- .2 be present at the race to assure the approved safety plan is implemented;
- .3 assure that adequate safety precautions are in place to deal with race-day conditions;
- .4 have the authority to withdraw the sanction on race day if adequate safety precautions are not in place and shall notify all race participants of the revocation prior to the beginning of the race should the race organizer proceed with the competition; and
- .5 have the authority to stop a race at any time should conditions change and safety becomes a concern.

701.9 OFFICIALS — The Referee, Administrative Referee, and Starter must have passed the USA Swimming Open Water Referee online test prior to officiating a sanctioned open water competition.

- .1 The following positions are required for all open water competitions:

Referee*
 Administrative Referee* or Administrative Official*
 Finish Judge
 Meet Director*
 Independent Safety Monitor*
 Medical Officer*
 Turn Judge (one at each change in the direction of the course)
 Starter

Note: All positions noted with an asterisk (*) above shall not be combined with any other role.

- .2 The following additional positions are recommended for all open water competitions, and are required for championship meets at or above the Zone level:

Recorder
 Race Judge (one per competitor in escorted races)
 Timer
 Announcer
 Course Officer
 Clerk Of Course
 Assistant Referee

701.10 THE REFEREE shall

- .1 ensure that all participants, coaches, and event support personnel are briefed about the course, safety procedures and any site-specific rules applying to the event;
- .2 have the authority to withdraw the sanction on race day if adequate safety precautions are not in place and shall notify all race participants of the revocation prior to the beginning of the race should the race organizer proceed with the competition;
- .3 have the authority to stop the race or to change the distance and/or race course due to safety concerns or unforeseen circumstances;
- .4 have the authority to use any video or electronic or mechanical judging devices in judging the finish order or in making other rulings.
- .5 conduct a random draw for assignment of the Race Judges in escorted swims.
- .6 signal by a raised flag and a series of short blasts on a whistle that the start is imminent and when satisfied that the swimmers are ready, indicate by pointing the flag at the Starter that the competition may commence;
- .7 have the authority to start the race in waves whereby each wave (heat) is separated at the start from the previous wave by a set time interval. Swimmers' times shall be adjusted by the starting time interval and their order of finish shall be determined on the basis of the adjusted time; and
- .8 have the authority to segregate competitors into the men's and women's or other classifications (e.g., by age group), either by the position at the starting line or by separate time of start.

701.11

701.11 THE ASSISTANT REFEREE shall perform all duties assigned by the Referee.

701.12 THE ADMINISTRATIVE REFEREE OR ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICIAL shall be responsible for all administrative matters assigned by the Referee.

701.13 THE INDEPENDENT SAFETY OFFICER shall

- .1 be responsible to the Referee for all aspects of safety related to the conduct of the competition;
- .2 ensure that each escort craft is suitable;
- .3 check that the entire course and especially the start and finish areas are safe and free of all obstructions;
- .4 ensure that a sufficient number of powered craft are available during the competition to provide safety backup for the escort boats;
- .5 when applicable, provide to all swimmers a tide and/or current charts indicating the time of tide changes on the course and showing the relationship between tides or current and swimmers' progress along the course; and
- .6 in conjunction with the Medical Officer, advise the Referee if conditions are unsuitable for staging the competition and/or make recommendations for the modification of the course or the manner in which the competition is conducted.

701.14 THE MEDICAL OFFICER shall

- .1 be responsible to the Referee for all medical aspects related to the competition and swimmers;
- .2 inform the local medical facilities of the nature of the competition and ensure that all casualties can be evacuated to them at the earliest opportunity; and
- .3 advise the Referee, in conjunction with the Safety Officer, if conditions are unsuitable for staging the competition and/or make recommendations for the modification of the course or the manner in which the competition is conducted.

701.15 THE COURSE OFFICER shall

- .1 be responsible for the accuracy of the survey establishing the distance of the course;
- .2 prior to the commencement of competition, inspect with the Referee and Safety Officer the course to ensure that all points are correctly marked and all equipment has been correctly installed and is in working order;
- .3 ensure that Turn Judges are in position prior to the start of the competition and report this to the Assistant Referee; and
- .4 serve as pilot in the lead boat when one is used.

701.16 THE CLERK OF COURSE shall

- .1 assemble and instruct the competitors prior to the competition and ensure proper reception for the competitors at the finish;
- .2 ensure that each competitor is correctly marked with his/her race number and that all swimmers have trimmed fingernails and are not wearing any jewelry including watches;
- .3 be certain all swimmers are present, in the assembly area, at the required time prior to the start; and

- .4 keep competitors and officials informed of the time remaining before the start at suitable intervals and at one-minute intervals for the last five minutes.

701.17 THE STARTER shall

- .1 assume a position clearly visible to all competitors;
- .2 on a signal from the Referee, raise a distinctive flag to a vertical position;
- .3 holding the arm straight, simultaneously bring the arm holding the flag down and shall activate an audible signal to signify the start; and
- .4 when swimmers are starting from a fixed platform, give the command, "Take your marks," at which time the swimmers will assume a starting position with at least one foot at the front of the starting platform. When all swimmers are stationary, the Starter shall give the starting signal.

701.18 THE RACE JUDGE shall

- .1 be positioned in the escort boat so as to be able to observe his or her appointed swimmer at all times to ensure compliance with the rules of competition and that any violations are recorded and reported to the Referee;
- .2 have the authority to order a swimmer from the water upon expiration of the time limit or when so ordered by the Referee;
- .3 ensure that the assigned swimmer does not take unfair advantage or commit unsportsmanlike impedance of another swimmer and, if the situation requires, instruct the swimmer to maintain clearance from any other swimmer;
- .4 immediately inform the Referee if the assigned swimmer withdraws from the event and shall record the completed distance and the time of the withdrawal; and
- .5 report observation of rules violations to the Referee immediately. In unescorted races, the Referee may assign Race Judges to monitor specific areas of the competition such as the feed station.

701.19 THE TURN JUDGE shall

- .1 be positioned so as to ensure that all swimmers comply with the turn and other change-of-course procedures; and
- .2 record any violation of the turn procedures and indicate to the Referee any infraction at the time it is observed.

701.20 THE CHIEFTIMER shall

- .1 assign at least three Timers to their positions for the start and finish;
- .2 brief the Timers on their duties and the details of their assignment;
- .3 ensure that a time check is made to allow all persons to synchronize their watches with the official race clock, if applicable, at least fifteen (15) minutes before start time; and
- .4 arrange for the use of automatic or semi-automatic timing devices in addition to watches, if desired.

701.21 THE CHIEF FINISH JUDGE shall

- .1 assign each Finish Judge to a position;

701.21

- .2 brief Finish Judges on their duties and the details of their assignment; and
- .3 after the race, collect the signed results sheets from each Finish Judge, determine the order of finish and deliver the results to the Referee (or his/her designee).

701.22 THE FINISH JUDGE shall

- .1 be positioned in line with the finish where there is a clear and unobstructed view of the finish; and
- .2 record the finish place of each swimmer.

701.23 THE RECORDER shall record withdrawals from the competition, enter results on official forms, and maintain the record for team awards as appropriate.

701.24 SWIMMERS WITH DISABILITIES

- .1 **Authority** — The USA Swimming Rules & Regulations grant the Referee authority to modify any rule or race management procedure for a swimmer with a disability. Disability is defined as a permanent physical or cognitive disability that substantially limits one or more major life activities. Any such modification shall affect only the current event and does not set precedent.

.2 Responsibilities

- A **Swimmer** — The swimmer (or the swimmer's coach) is responsible for notifying the Referee, prior to the competition, of any disability of the swimmer and of the requested modification. The swimmer/coach shall provide a Personal Assistant(s) or any equipment (tappers, deck mats, etc.) if required.
- B **Referee** — The Referee's responsibilities include:
 - (1) Determining if the requested modifications are appropriate and conform to safety requirements. No modifications shall be granted which give a swimmer a competitive advantage.
 - (2) Instructing the Starter and all Judges as to the accommodations to be made for that swimmer.
- C **Coaches** — Coaches and teams entering swimmers with disabilities that require any accommodations shall provide advance notice in writing to the meet director by the entry deadline. Failure to provide advance notice may limit the host's ability to accommodate all requests.

ARTICLE 702

VENUE STANDARDS

702.1 THE COURSE

- .1 The course shall be measured as accurately as possible with the available navigational or survey equipment.
- .2 The course shall be in water that is subject to only minor currents or tide and may be salt or fresh water.
- .3 With the exception of beach starts and beach finishes, the minimum depth of water at any point on the course shall be 1.4 meters.

- .4 **Guide Buoy** — A distinctively marked colored float in the water, anchored to provide navigational guidance for swimmers, may be used. Guide buoys shall be non-directional in nature and swimmers may pass on either side of the buoy. Guide buoys must be colored differently from turn buoys.

702.2 WATER/AIR TEMPERATURE — The race shall not begin if the following conditions are not satisfied:

- .1 The water temperature shall not be less than 16.0° C (60.8° F).
- .2 For races of 5k and above, the water temperature shall not exceed 29.45° C (85° F).
- .3 The air temperature and water temperature when added together shall not be less than 47.8° C (118° F) nor greater than 80.8° C (177.4° F).
- .4 The water temperature shall be checked the day of the race, two (2) hours before the start, on the course at a depth of 40 cm (15.75 inches).

702.3 WATER QUALITY

- .1 If water quality meets the standards of the local testing authority, the water quality will be deemed acceptable unless otherwise determined by the Safety Officer or Independent Safety Monitor.
- .2 If an exceptional event such as heavy rain or flooding affects the water quality, the Referee, the Meet Director, or the Independent Safety Monitor shall have the authority to postpone or cancel the race.

702.4 THE START

- .1 The start line shall be clearly defined by either overhead apparatus or by removable equipment at water level.
- .2 If the race is started from a fixed platform, the water depth requirements of 103.2.3 must be met. Additionally, the Course Officer and Referee shall have the start area inspected for hidden underwater obstacles or obstructions. If there is any doubt as to the condition of the start area, an in-water or beach start shall be used.

702.5 TURNS/CHANGES IN COURSE

- .1 **Turn Buoys** — All turns and other changes in direction on the course shall be clearly indicated by turn buoys which shall be distinctively marked colored floats, anchored to mark the course for swimmers. Turn buoys shall be directional in nature and must be passed with a right shoulder turn or left shoulder turn, as stated in the pre-race instructions.
- .2 A clearly marked craft or platform for a turn judge shall be securely fixed in position at all locations where alterations in direction on the course occur and in such a manner as not to obstruct the swimmers' view or negotiation of the turn, while providing a clear view of the swimmers' turns for the officials.

702.6 THE FINISH

- .1 The final approach to the finish shall be clearly defined with markers of a distinctive color. The area leading to the finish apparatus should be clearly marked by rows of buoys which narrow as they get closer to the finish wall – this is considered part of the course and the swimmers shall remain within the rows of buoys throughout their approach to the finish.

702.6

Escort safety craft should be stationed at the approach to and entrance of the finish lane to ensure that only the escort craft authorized to do so enter or cross this entrance.

- .2 The finish line shall be clearly defined and marked by a vertical surface at least five meters wide. The finish apparatus, where possible, should be a stationary panel securely fastened in place so as to not be moved by wind, tide, or force of the swimmer striking it.
- .3 When Automatic Officiating Equipment (microchip technology) is used for timing of the race, the official time for the finish shall be recorded in tenths of seconds. Actual finish placement shall be determined by manual finish judging and/or video replay of the finish.

702.7 FEEDING STATIONS

- .1 Feeding stations shall be securely fixed in position and shall not be subject to tidal, wind, or other movements, and shall safely accommodate the number of feeders consistent with the number of entries.
- .2 Feeding stations shall be located on the inner or outer boundary of the course, in line with the turn buoy.
- .3 Number of feeding stations required:
 - A No feeding station is required for an event 5k or shorter.
 - B At least one feeding station is required for an event that is longer than 5k but shorter than 10k.
 - C For an event 10k or longer, there shall be at least one feeding station every 2k.

ARTICLE 703 RECORDS

703.1 Because of differences in courses, currents and other physical factors, records for open water events are not maintained. For long distance events swum in a pool, records are maintained as U.S. Open Records.

703.2 Open Water and Long Distance U.S. Open individual and team records for men and women may only be achieved in a sanctioned or approved event and will be maintained as indicated below:

- .1 **Time/Distance Events:**
 - A One-Hour Swim (25 yard pool)
 - B 12- and 24-Hour Swim (50 meter pool)
- .2 **Set Distances:**
 - A Five-mile increments (5, 10, 15 miles, etc.) (25 yard pool)
 - B Five kilometer increments (5, 10, 15...50...100 kilometers) (50 meter pool)
 - C Age Group 1000-2000-3000 yard (25 yard pool)
 - D Senior 5000 yard (25 yard pool)

ARTICLE 704

ZONE OPEN WATER CHAMPIONSHIPS

704.1 EVENTS — A 5k shall be a required event for all Zone Open Water Championships and designated as the qualifying event for the Open Water Junior National and National Championships. All other events for Zone Open Water Championships shall be determined by the Zone.

704.2 ELIGIBILITY — Age for Open Water Zone Championships shall be determined by the swimmer's age as of December 31 in the year of competition.

ARTICLE 705

USA SWIMMING OPEN WATER NATIONAL AND JUNIOR NATIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS

**See sections 207.1, 207.3, 207.5, 207.7, 207.9, 207.11 for additional rules
pertaining to Open Water National Championships.**

705.1 START AND FINISH

- .1 An in-water start and an in-water finish are required.
- .2 Videotaping of the finish shall be provided for meets from which National Teams are selected.

705.2 ABANDONMENT — Where emergency conditions require a race to be halted before it is completed, the following shall apply:

- .1 Races of 10k or shorter: In the event of abandonment, the race shall be restarted from the beginning at the earliest possible time and the full distance completed.
- .2 Races longer than 10k: If the race is abandoned prior to the lead swimmer completing three-fourths of the distance of the event, the race shall be restarted from the beginning at the most appropriate time, as decided by the meet committee, and the full distance completed. If the race is abandoned when the lead swimmer has completed at least three-fourths of the race, the race shall be considered complete. The final placings of all swimmers shall be determined by the Meet Referee.
- .3 Situations not covered above shall be determined by the Meet Committee.

705.3 EVENTS — In conjunction with the Managing Director, National Team, or designee, the Open Water Committee may designate additional events as qualifying competitions for the Open Water Junior National and National Championships, including the 5K at Zone Open Water Championships.

705.4 ENTRY FEES — The entry fees shall be determined by the Meet Director with the concurrence of the President/CEO (or his/her designee).

705.5 ENTRY PROCESS AND MEET ANNOUNCEMENT — The entry procedure shall be stated in the meet announcement. The meet announcement shall be prepared under joint direction of and approved by the Open Water Committee, the Meet Director, Program & Events Coordinator, and the President/CEO (or his/her designee).

705.6 RESULTS — Results shall be submitted to the Open Water Committee, USA Swimming, and posted on the USA Swimming website.

705.7 TEAM EVENT ENTRIES

- .1 Clubs may enter more than one team in each category. Prior to the start of the competition coaches shall designate the category (men's, women's, mixed) and the team (A, B, C, etc.) in which their swimmers will compete.
- .2 When participating concurrently in individual and team events, no participant shall compete in more than two team events, one of which may be as a member of his/her gender-specific team and the other as a member of a mixed-competition category team.

705.8 SCORING — Scoring of individual events will be on a sixteen (16)-place basis: 20, 17, 16, 15, 14, 13, 12, 11, 9, 7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1.

- .1 **Team Events** — team events shall be scored in men's, women's and mixed-competition categories.
- .2 **National Event Club Championship**
 - A A club champion shall be determined by totaling the scores of individual club members in the event. Club champions will be named in the following categories: Women's, Men's and Combined.
 - B To be eligible for the Combined Men's and Women's Club Championship, a club must have scored points in both the men's and women's events.

705.9 AWARDS

- .1 Individual champions shall be determined and awarded in women's and men's competitions. Medals shall be awarded to all first through eighth place finishers in each individual event.
- .2 The male and female swimmers eighteen (18) years of age and younger attaining the highest finish position shall be designated as the USA Swimming 18 and under Open Water Swimming Champion in the 10K and 5K National Championships and shall receive the appropriate USA Swimming Championship medals.
- .3 Team Event medals shall be awarded to team event members placing first through third.
- .4 Awards shall be given to the top three clubs: men's, women's and combined where the following criteria are met:
 - A Men's or Women's — In order for awards to be given within a specific gender, that gender shall have a minimum of sixteen (16) competitors from at least three clubs starting the race.
 - B Combined — To be eligible for this award, a club must have scored points in both the men's and women's races, and there must have been a minimum of three clubs participating in each gender's race.
- .5 The Meet Host may present additional individual and team awards with approval from the President/CEO (or his/her designee).

705.10 ELIGIBILITY — Qualifying times and/or qualifying criteria may be established by the Meet Director with the concurrence of the Open Water Committee.

705.11 PROOF OF TIME — A swimmer entered in any USA Swimming National Championships shall be required to show proof of having met the qualification standards as set forth in the meet announcement.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN USA SWIMMING AND USMS RULES

The following summary is presented for information only for the benefit of officials, meet directors, swimmers, and coaches. The USMS rule citation shall be used for official rulings.

The USMS Rules of Competition and Code of Regulations should be consulted for a complete list of administrative requirements for sanctioned and recognized meets.

The U.S. Masters Swimming Rulebook is available at a cost of \$12.00 (mini-rulebook is \$8.00) from the USMS National Office, 8388 South Tamiami Trail, Suite 221, Sarasota, FL 34238 / 941-256-8767, or it can be ordered online at usms@usms.org.

Forward Start

The forward start may be taken from the starting block, the pool deck, or a push from the wall. The forward start or the backstroke start shall be used for freestyle events. The referee's long whistle indicates that the swimmer may take and maintain a position with at least one foot at the front of the platform or the deck (prior to "take your marks"). On the command, "Take your marks," the swimmer shall immediately assume the starting position that maintains at least one foot at the front of the platform or the deck.

In-the-Water Starts

A swimmer starting in the water must have one hand on the wall or starting platform and one foot on the wall and may face any direction. The backstroke start may be used as the in-the-water start during freestyle events and for freestyle relays, but not for the freestyle leg of medley relay events. A backstroke starting ledge may be used in freestyle events.

Racing Starts

USMS has no requirement for certification of racing starts in order to use starting platforms or backstroke starting ledges.

Butterfly

The breaststroke kick may be used exclusively or interchangeably with the dolphin kick while doing the butterfly stroke at any time during the race. Only one breaststroke kick is permitted per arm pull, except that a single breaststroke kick is permitted prior to the turn and the finish without an arm pull. After the start and after each turn, a single breaststroke kick is permitted prior to the first arm pull.

Relays

- Mixed relays shall consist of two male and two female swimmers who may swim in any order.
- Relay swimmers who cannot exit the water quickly enough to prevent interference with automatic officiating equipment may hold on to the lane line until all relays have finished, allowing them to exit the pool more slowly or via the ladders at the conclusion of the race.
- In relay races involving in-the-water starts, a relay will be disqualified if the feet of the outgoing swimmer lose touch with the end of the course before the preceding teammate touches the wall. Inadvertent

loss of contact is not grounds for disqualification if the outgoing swimmer corrects the foot position prior to the incoming swimmer touching the end of the course.

- The relay team shall be disqualified even if the swimmer in default returns to the original starting point at the wall after the preceding teammate has touched the wall.

Age Determining Date

For short course meters and long course meters meets, the swimmer's age is determined as of December 31 of the year of competition.

For short course yards meets, the swimmer's age is determined as of the last day of the meet (regardless of postponement).

Warm-Up and Warm-Down

- In pools of five lanes or more, a separate warm-up area must be made available to swimmers during the competition.
- If there is no other warm-up/warm-down area available in pools of five lanes or more, one lane shall be set aside for warm-up/warm-down during the conduct of the meet.
- In pools of four or fewer lanes, swimmers shall be allowed to swim to the other end of the pool at the end of each heat and a warm-up/warm-down period must be offered at least once during each half hour of competition.
- A swimmer who completes a race may warm down in the assigned lane while the rest of the swimmers complete the heat and shall not be disqualified if such action does not delay the start of the next event.
- If the meet is a dual-sanctioned meet with USA Swimming, the requirements for continuous warm-up may be adjusted depending on availability of warm-up space at the venue by agreement between the LMSC and LSC host clubs.
- Once the entry information is published, changes which further restrict the availability of continuous warm-up/warm-down space are not permitted.

Gender

USMS policy guidelines govern eligibility of athletes to compete in the male and female gender categories. Protests of eligibility shall be referred to the USMS Rules Committee chair. Athletes shall be permitted to compete in the gender that corresponds to their USMS registration pending resolution of any protest.

Scratch Procedures

There is no penalty for failure to report for or compete in an event, except that a swimmer may not be permitted to swim if the swimmer does not comply with check-in procedures listed in the meet announcement. There are no "declared false starts" in USMS sanctioned or recognized meets.

Dual-Sanctioned Meets	If a USMS-sanctioned meet is held in conjunction with a USA Swimming-sanctioned meet (swimmers competing together in the same sessions), swimmers with dual membership must select only one organization with which to compete for the entire meet.
Relay Names	First and last names of eligible swimmers, their ages, and order of swimming shall be submitted to the clerk of course or to the head lane timer.
Counters	A swimmer in any individual event of 16 lengths or longer, except the individual medley, may appoint one counter to call lengths or indicate lengths by visual sign.
Seeding	Seeding at meets other than national championships may be either fast-to-slow or slow-to-fast. Seeding may differ for sprint and distance events (400 yards or longer) within a meet. Two-to-a-lane seeding may be used for individual freestyle events longer than 200 meters. Seeding must be specified in the meet announcement.
Change in Program or Postponement	At the meet referee's discretion, events may be combined by distance and/or stroke. Should a meet or event have commenced, and in the judgement of the referee cannot safely and effectively continue because of weather conditions or some other compelling reason, the meet or event may be suspended at the referee's sole discretion.
Swimwear	Medical identification items may be worn. Modesty wear is prohibited unless a medical or religious exemption has been granted by USMS. Only swimwear exemptions granted by the USMS Rules Committee chair shall be eligible for consideration at USMS competitions.
Swimwear 102.12.2	USMS does not prohibit wearing the insignia or name of another club, does not regulate the number of logos on swimsuits/caps/goggles, does not prohibit body advertising such as temporary tattoos, and does not prohibit the advertising of political statements. Products involving tobacco, psychoactive cannabinoids, alcohol, or pharmaceuticals containing substances banned under IOC or World Aquatics rules may not be advertised, but the advertiser's name only may be used. Offenders may be barred from competition until they comply with this rule.
Video Replay Footage	Video replay footage may only be used when approved in writing by the chair of the USMS Officials Committee prior to the meet.
Personnel	USMS does not use a meet jury. A protest committee is used at national championships. At LMSC-sanctioned meets, the meet director and meet referee are responsible for ensuring that the provisions of article 102.14 for protests are followed.
Place Judges	One or two place judges may be positioned at the side of the course near the finish to judge the order of finish of all swimmers. However, judging may not be used to change the results produced by ranking the official times.

Split Requests

- If swimmers want their initial splits as part of a longer individual event to be submitted for records or Top 10 consideration, they must notify the referee in writing.
- Split requests for backstroke individual events must be submitted prior to the event.
- Split requests for all other individual events must be submitted prior to the conclusion of the meet, unless the meet referee has approved the automatic recording of splits, in which case no written request is required.
- Requests for relay leadoff splits must be submitted prior to the event.
- Relay leadoff splits may not be recorded for official purposes if the second swimmer starts in the water and automatic timing is used or if the second swimmer stands on an active pad while starting from the deck.

Records and Top 10

- World and USMS records may only be established when timed with automatic timing.
- In the event of an individual lane malfunction, World and USMS records may be established using a semiautomatic (automatic start and manual finish) secondary system with three, two, or one button(s).
- USMS records may be established using a tertiary backup system with a minimum of two valid watches if both the automatic and semi-automatic systems fail.
- Winning the heat or event is not required to establish a record.
- USMS Top 10 times may be established using an automatic primary timing system, a semiautomatic primary system with a minimum of two buttons, or a manual primary system with a minimum of two watches.
- Top 10 times may be established if the automatic primary system fails and the secondary semiautomatic system fails using a manual tertiary system with a minimum of one watch.
- Top 10 times may be established if the semiautomatic primary system fails using a manual secondary system consisting of a minimum of one watch.
- Only results from events conducted in pools officially certified for length in conformance with USMS 106.2.1 will be accepted for records and Top 10 (see USMS 105.1.7) times.

Records and Top 10 from Leadoff and Initial Splits

Relay leadoff splits or initial splits may be considered for World records, USMS records, or USMS Top 10 times when timed with automatic timing. Relay leadoff splits or initial splits may be considered for World records or USMS Top 10 times if the touchpad fails and the times are recorded with a semiautomatic secondary system using three, two, or one button(s), but not for USMS records.

Record Documentation	Required documentation for USMS records includes the referee's signature on the record application, the printout from the automatic timing system (in the event of a lane malfunction, also the printout from the semiautomatic timing equipment), and a copy of the heat sheet showing the swimmer's name, heat number, and the lane number in which the record was achieved.
Fresh Water	USMS records and Top 10 times may only be established in fresh water. No records or Top 10 times will be recognized in any kind of sea or ocean water.
Water Depth	In pools with water depth of 3 feet 6 inches to less than 4 feet at the starting end, swimmers must start from the deck or within the water. USMS does not have a rule for teaching racing starts or certifying racing start proficiency.
Lane Numbers	The lanes shall be numbered from right to left as the swimmers face the course from the starting end of the pool except when the event starts at the turn end of the course (no change in lane numbering so the lanes are numbered the same at both ends); predicated upon facility availability, LMSCs may waive strict compliance with these requirements when sanctioning local competition.
Water Temperature	Water temperature from 25 to 28 degrees Celsius (77 to 82 degrees Fahrenheit) shall be maintained for competition. USMS does not address air temperature.
Athlete Protection and Other Policies	USMS does not address deck changing. USMS does not address shaving in the venue.
Use of Cameras, Video Equipment, and Drones	USMS does not allow cameras or other recording devices behind the starting platform during the start of the race and during intermediate relay exchanges. The sanctioning LMSC, meet host, and the referee may further impose restrictions. Operation of a drone is not permitted over open areas of the venue unless credentialed by USMS media policies.
Protests of Eligibility	Protests affecting the eligibility of any swimmer to compete or to represent an organization in any race shall be made in writing to the meet director or referee before the race is held, and if the meet director deems it advisable, the swimmer may compete under protest and it shall be so announced before the race. The meet director shall immediately refer such protest to the LMSC officers (local meets) or championship meet protest committee (national championship meets) having jurisdiction for adjudication at the earliest possible time.

Protests Arising from the Competition	Protests arising from the competition itself shall be made within 30 minutes after the race in which the alleged infraction took place. If the protest is not resolved immediately, the protester shall at that time file a written protest with the chair of the Local Masters Swimming Committee (LMSC) or the chair's representative having jurisdiction over the event. If the LMSC does not satisfactorily resolve the protest within 10 days, the protester may appeal in writing to the USMS Rules Committee chair within the next five days for final adjudication, whose decision shall then be binding on all parties.
Protests of Interpretations	Protests concerning interpretation of Part 1 rules shall be submitted in writing to the chair of the USMS Rules Committee within 10 days.

COMBINED, PARALLEL, AND INTERWOVEN MEETS

(DUAL-SANCTIONED EVENTS)

The number of inquiries as to what mechanisms are available for combining USA Swimming and USMS swimming meets has been increasing. The reasons for combining these meets are many, ranging from the limited availability of pool time and officials to the desire to promote the sport as a lifelong activity. There are several ways of accomplishing this goal within the rules and insurance policies of each organization. This document outlines these options.

It is assumed that all competitors are a member of USA Swimming, USMS, or both. Those that are members of both must select one organization with which to compete for the entire meet. Dual membership cannot be used to exceed the daily event limits imposed by either organization. Automatic recognition of times achieved by a USMS swimmer competing in the USA-S portion is still available.

Any of the joint meets described below must have sanctions from both USA Swimming and USMS. Both sanctions must be held by the host organization. The host organization cannot be required to accept a participant from either USMS or USA Swimming that would otherwise be barred from participation by their respective organizations.

USMS Record and Top Ten submissions must comply with all USMS documentation requirements.

Combined Meets

With the consent of all (co-)hosting teams and the LSC and LMSC, a combined meet may be sanctioned by both USA Swimming and USMS and all swimmers competing according to USA Swimming rules for individual strokes, relays, and the conduct and officiating of the competition with the exception that USMS rules and regulations governing events, eligibility, protests of USMS applicable rules, and meet results shall apply to USMS members. Otherwise, each organization's rules and administrative regulations apply to their members. This mechanism allows the meet host(s) to seed the event as they normally would, based upon times, with USA Swimming and USMS members combined in heats without specific lanes allocated to one organization or the other. Relay teams must consist of members of the same USMS or USA Swimming club. Note that all USMS events held in 25-meter and 50-meter pools must be conducted as timed finals, but USMS members may compete in preliminary heats if they are not competing for slots in the final session(s). USMS does not permit time trials in 25-meter and 50-meter pools.

Parallel Meets

The two meets may be swum in parallel by assigning some number of lanes to USMS competitors and a different set to USA Swimming competitors. If possible, separate stroke and turn officials for each set is preferred. It is permissible to adjust, for example, the makeup of the USMS heats so that competitors in a given heat have approximately the same seed times. Each organization's rules would apply to their members.

Interwoven Meets

The two meets may be swum with complete heats of swimmers from both organizations alternating. There would be no need for separate stroke and turn officials. Each organization's rules would apply to their members.

Meet announcements for dual-sanctioned meets or open water events must contain information for USMS and USA Swimming athletes in accordance with each organization's rules and administrative regulations. The safety plan for an open water event must be approved by both organizations.

CORPORATE BYLAWS OF USA SWIMMING

Please note that these Bylaws are subject to change at any time by the Board of Directors. The most current version can be found on the USA Swimming website.

All capitalized terms used but not defined herein shall have the meanings set forth in the USA Swimming Rulebook Official Glossary.



This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



**Have a breakthrough season with
SwimOutlet Custom Team Stores.**

**A *free* and *efficient* solution to
outfit your entire team.**

Check us out at
www.swimoutlet.com/teams

Contact us at
teams@swimoutlet.com
(800) 469-7132

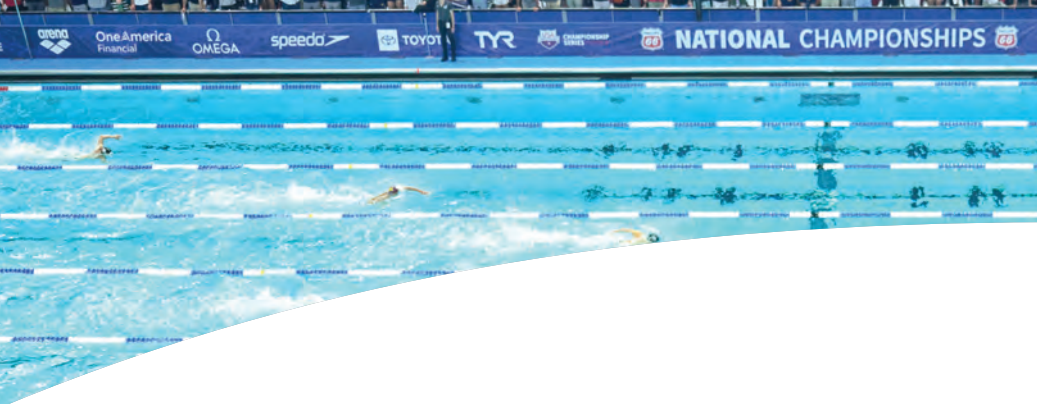
SWIMOUTLET
TEAM SALES



SPECIAL OFFER FOR USA SWIMMING TEAMS!

Publish a New Custom Team Store by October 31, 2025 and receive \$50 store credit in your account!*

*Team store must be published on a registered swim team website for a minimum of 30 days with at least one custom item. Must be a new team store account to earn credit. One credit per team. Credit will be given to a team's registered account admin. Credit expires March 31, 2026. Credit cannot be redeemed for cash.



Proud Sponsor of USA Swimming

USA Swimming builds world-class teams into champions. OneAmerica Financial helps people champion their financial futures.

To learn more visit OneAmerica.com

OneAmerica[®]
Financial

Life Insurance Retirement Employee Benefits Long-Term Care

OneAmerica.com